

**A Practical Book
of
Business Communication**

Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam

A Practical Book of Business Communication

Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam

Associate Professor

&

Head, Department of Business Administration

BGMEA University of Fashion and Technology (BUFT)

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Part 1: Understanding Business Communication

Chapter 1: Business Communication:

A Comprehensive Discussion

1.1 Definition of Communication

Communication may be defined as: Giving, receiving or exchanging information, opinions, or ideas by writing, speech, or visual means, so that the message communicated is completely understood by the recipients. It is an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons. Louis A. Allen defines communication as the sum of all the things one person does when he wants to create understanding in the mind of another. It is a bridge of meaning. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding.

1.2 Types of Communication

Communication can be broadly divided into categories.

1.2.1 Internal Communication

- a. Downward, Upward, Horizontal
- b. Formal or Informal
- c. Oral, Written, Nonverbal
- d. Manual or Mechanical

1.2.2 External Communication

- a. Inward or outward
- b. Formal or Informal
- c. Oral or Written
- d. Manual or Mechanical

1.2.1 Internal Communication

An exchange of information within an organization is called internal communication. Each organization has its own approach to transmit information through the organization. Internal communication includes Letters, Memo, Notices, Instructions, Orders, Circulars, Reports, Announcements, Opinions, Suggestions, Complaints, Magazine, and Manuals.

Internal Communication may be-

- a. Downward and Upward, Horizontal, Diagonal**

Downward: It is internal communication from superior to subordinate. It includes Order, Instructions, Notices, and Announcements etc.

Upward: It is a communication from subordinate to superior. Usually it covers Suggestions, Complaints, and Report etc.

Horizontal: It is a communication at same level. It covers Consultation, Advice, Discussion, Meetings etc.

Diagonal communication: Diagonal communication takes place between people who work in different departments and at different levels within an organization. Very often diagonal communication involves committees, teams or task forces that are created to solve problems or complete special projects. Diagonal communication often relies largely on cooperation, goodwill and respect between the parties concerned.

b. Formal or Informal

Formal Communication: It refers to official communication. It follows the channels of formal relationships of authority.

Informal Communication: It is unofficial in nature and also described as Grapevine.

c. Oral, Written or Non verbal

Oral: It includes face to face talks or conversations on intercom instrument.

Written: It is transiting in writing.

Nonverbal: All the cues, gestures, vocal qualities, special relationships, attitudes toward time that allow us to communicate without words.

d. Manual or Mechanical

Manual: When messages are communicated in person it is manual in nature. (For instance, sending a letter or notice through messenger or by post, face to face conversation)

Mechanical: Transmitting message with the help of mechanical aids like telephone, television etc.

1.2.2 External Communication

Companies constantly exchange messages with customers, vendors, distributors, competitors, investors, journalists, government and community representatives. External communication links the organization with the outside world of customers, suppliers, competitors, and investors. External Communication includes: Acknowledgements, Enquires, Quotations, Tenders, Placement of orders, follow up and reminders, Meeting, Greeting, Conferences, and Notices etc. External Communication may be -

a. Inward or outward

Inward: It is a communication from outside. It includes inward mail, incoming telephone call etc.

Outward: It is communication from organization to outsiders. Such communication includes quotation, tenders, Acknowledgements.

b. Formal or Informal

Formal: It refers to official communication and such communication is sent through proper channels according to rules and customs.

Informal: It is unofficial in nature and also described as Grapevine. Informal communication travels along the organization's unofficial lines of activity and power. As people go about their work, they have casual conversations with their friends in the office. They joke around and discuss their apartments, their families, restaurants, movies, sports and other people in the company. The grapevine is a vehicle for distortions of the truth, rumor and gossip.

c. Oral or Written

Oral communication: Communication through personal visit and telephone are oral in nature.

Written Communication: When communication is sent through correspondence it is written communication. For instance, Quotations, tenders, orders, etc. are made in writing.

d. Manual or Mechanical

Manual: When messages are communicated in person, it is manual in nature. (For instance, sending a letter or notice through messenger or by post, face to face conversation)

Mechanical: Transmitting message with the help of mechanical aids like telephone, television etc.

1.3 The Communication Process

The communication is a chain of event. The communication process consists of six phases linking sender and receiver.

Figure-1.1: Communication process

The sender has an idea: You conceive an idea and want to share it.

The sender encodes the idea as a message

When you put your idea into a message that your receiver will understand, you are encoding, deciding on the message's form (word, facial expression), length, organization, tone and style- all of which depend on your idea, your audience, and your personal style and mood.

The sender produces the message in a transmittable medium.

The medium is the form a message takes (telephone, computer, letter, memo, report etc.). To update you're your boss, you might have a dozen or more media choices, from a phone call to a slideshow presentation.

The sender transmits the message through a channel

To physically transmit your message to your receiver, you select a communication channel. The medium as the form a message takes (such as twitter update) and the channel as the system used to deliver the messages (such as the Internet). The channel and medium you choose depend on your message, the location of your audience, your need for speed, and formality of the situation.

The audience receives the message

For communication to occur, your receiver must first get the message. If the channel functions properly, the message reaches, its intend audience.

The audience decodes the message

Your receiver must cooperate by decoding your message (the receiver needs to extract the idea from the message), absorbing and understanding it. Then the decoded message has to be stored in the receiver's mind. If all goes well, the message is interpreted correctly; that is, the receiver assigns the same basic meaning to the words as the sender intended and responds in the desired way. It is always important to consider carefully the tone used in your communication so that the correct message is received.

The receiver reaction and feedback

Feedback is your receiver's response, the final link in the communication chain. Feedback is the key element in the communication process because it enables you to evaluate the effectiveness of your message. If your audience does not understand what you mean, you can tell by the response and refine your message.

1.4 The Basic Forms of Communication

1.4.1 Nonverbal communication

The most basic form of communication is Nonverbal communication, all the cues, gestures, vocal qualities, special relationships, attitudes toward time that allow us to communicate without words. The meaning of nonverbal communication lies with the observer, who both reads specific signals and interprets them in the context of a particular situation and a particular culture.

The types of nonverbal communication:

Facial expression and eye behavior: Your face is the primary site for expressing your emotions; both the type and the intensity of your feelings. Your eyes are especially effective for indicating attention and interest, influencing others, regulating interaction and establishing dominance.

Gestures and postures: by moving your body, you can express both specific and general message, some voluntary and some involuntary. A wave of hand, for example, has a specific and intentional meaning.

Vocal characteristics: Your voice carries both intentional and unintentional message. Your choice can create various impressions. The tone and volume of your voice, your accent and

speaking pace and all the little um's and ah's that creep into your speech say a lot about you, your emotions and your relationship with the audience.

Personal appearance: Your appearance helps establish your social identity. People respond to us on the basis of our physical attractiveness. Our grooming, our clothing, our accessories, and our style- all modify our appearance.

Touching behavior: Touch is an important vehicle for conveying warmth, comfort, and reassurance. The accepted norms of touching vary, depending on the gender, age, relative status and cultural background of the persons involved. In business situations, touching suggests dominance, so a higher status person is more likely to touch a lower status person than the other way around. Touching has become controversial, however, because it can sometimes be interpreted as sexual harassment.

Use of time and space: Like touch, time and space can be asserting authority. In many cultures, people demonstrate their importance by making other people wait; they show respect by being on time. People can also assert their status by occupying the best space. In US companies, the chief executive usually has the corner office and prettiest view.

Nonverbal Communication Skills Development

Nonverbal communication can be different for men and women. To improve nonverbal skills, pay more attention to nonverbal cues, engage in more eye contact and probe for more information when verbal and nonverbal cues conflict. Try to be as honest as possible when communicating your emotions. Moreover, following guidelines can be followed:

- i. Be honest, especially when communicating emotions.
- ii. Use a firm, friendly handshake when meeting new people.
- iii. Maintain eye contact with your entire audience.
- iv. Reinforce your words with tones and gestures.
- v. Be aware of your posture.
- vi. Use appropriate gestures to support your point.
- vii. Imitate the posture and appearance of people you want to impress.
- viii. Show respect for speakers and listener.
- ix. Touch people only when appropriate and acceptable.
- x. Smile genuinely, as a fake one will be obvious.

1.4.2 Verbal communication

Verbal communication consists of words arranged in meaningful patterns.

Speaking:

Business people rely more heavily on oral than on written communication channels for sharing information. We have discussed on oral presentation in a separate chapter.

Writing: We have discussed the writing skill development in another chapter.

Listening:

Listening is a process of receiving, interpreting and reacting to the messages received from the communication sender.

Listening process:

Sensation- Sensation involves a physiological process. With this process our ears hear sound waves and send it to our brain.

Interpretation- Interpretation denotes attaching meaning to the message heard.

Evaluation- Evaluation refers to the task of taking decision whether to accept or reject, agree or disagree and the like with the message.

Reaction- This stage of listening refers to the response, which is generated by the message you have heard. This response may take the form of direct response.

Techniques for effective listening:

- i. Prepare to listen. Clear your mind so that your attention is assured.
- ii. Avoid pre- judgment. Do not prejudge the speaker because of appearance or occupation and do not jump to any conclusions before hearing what is said.
- iii. Be open minded: Appreciate the speaker's point of view and accept that it may not necessarily agree with your own.
- iv. Establish eye contact: This shows that you are listening, as does your posture and your facial expressions.
- v. Don't interrupt: Try to keep emotions out of it and hold any counter-arguments until the speaker has finished.
- vi. Watch for signals: Pick up aspects that the speaker considers important by watching, posture and gestures, as well as listening to intonation in the speaker's voice.
- vii. Judge content, not delivery; Appraise the content instead of the speaker.
- viii. Extract key points: Pick out and repeat to yourself some key words or phrases. This will help to fix in your mind what is being said.

- ix. Give feedback: Learn to give positive feedback non -verbally, perhaps by nodding or smiling to let the speaker know you are following what is being said.
- x. Block out distractions: You may need to close doors turn off a television or radio or move closer to the speaker.

Reading:

Some guidelines are given below for development of reading skill.

- Read out loud to make sure that you are concentrating properly and reading every word.
- While most people disagree with this, most things you need to know are in books. Therefore it is wise, when you are comfortable reading general material, to increase your reading speed as soon as possible.
- Standing while reading works better for some people. Some read while walking on a treadmill or a track, exercising both the body and mind!
- To get the most comprehension, avoid lying down while reading. While reading in bed can help you relax and fall asleep, you can retain more information by having a good posture while reading. For example, sitting straight up and keeping your feet flat on the floor can increase your alertness.
- Don't stress while reading. People usually stress about not being able to remember what they last read and don't focus on what they are reading at the moment. So take a deep breath and don't stress!
- Don't try to get every word in the sentence. Just take it easy and read. Also, find a good place for you to relax while reading. To make yourself more comfortable and concentrate on your reading. You could bring yourself something to eat and drink so you won't be hungry or feeling bored while you're reading.
- Try including yourself in the scenario that you are reading. This makes you feel even more interested in reading.
- Try to read in noise free environment. It will give you better focus and good remember to words. While take break listen songs and started reading again.

1.5 The Barriers to Communication and Overcoming Barriers

The fact is that innumerable barriers to communication can block any face of the communication process. Noise is any interference in the communication process that

distorts or obscures the sender's meaning and such communication barriers can exist between people and within organization.

1.5.1 Communication Barriers between People

Differences in Perception

Perception is our individual interpretation of the world around us. The world constantly bombards us with information: sight, sounds, scents and so on. Our minds organize this stream sensation into a mental map that represents our perception of reality. In no case is the map in a person's mind the same as the world itself and no two maps are exactly alike. As you view the world, your mind absorbs your experiences in a unique and personal way.

Overcoming perceptual barriers can be difficult. Try to predict how your message will be received, anticipate your receiver's reactions and shape the message according – constantly adjusting to correct any misunderstanding.

Incorrect Filtering

Filtering is screening out or abbreviating information before a message is passed on to someone else. In business, the filters between you and your receiver are many: secretaries, assistants, receptionists, and answering machines.

To overcome filtering barriers, try to establish more than one communication channels, eliminate as many intermediaries as possible, and decrease distortion by condensing message information to the bare essentials.

Language Problems

When you choose the words for your message, they impose their own barriers on it. For example, the language of a lawyer differs from that of an accountant or a doctor, and the difference in their vocabularies affects their ability to recognize and express ideas.

To overcome language barriers, use the most specific and accurate words possible. Always try to use words your audience will understand. Increase the accuracy of your message by using language that describes rather than evaluates and by presenting observable facts, events and circumstances.

Poor Listening

Perhaps the most common barrier to reception is simply a lack of attention on the receiver's part. We all let our minds wander now and then, regardless of how hard we try to concentrate.

To overcome listening barriers, verify your interpretation of what's been said. Empathize with speakers and resist jumping to conclusions. Clarify meaning by asking nonthreatening questions, and listen without interrupting.

Differing Emotional States

Every message contains both a content meaning, which deals with the subject of the message and a relationship meaning, which suggests the nature of the interaction between sender and receiver. Communication can break down when the receiver reacts negatively to either of these meanings.

To overcome emotional barriers, be aware of the feelings that arise in you and in others as you communicate and attempt to control them. For example, choose neutral words to avoid arousing strong feelings unduly. Avoid attitudes, blame, and other subjective concepts.

Differing Backgrounds

Differences in background can be one of the hardest communication barriers to overcome. When your receiver's life experience differs substantially from yours, communication becomes more difficult. Age, education, gender, social status, economic position, cultural background, temperament, health, beauty, popularity, religion, political belief, even a passing mood can all separate one person from another and make understanding difficult.

1.5.2 Communication Barriers within Organization

Information Overload

Too much information is as bad as too little because it reduces the audience's ability to concentrate effectively on the most important messages. People facing information overload sometimes try to cope by ignoring some of the messages, by delaying responses to messages they deem unimportant, by answering only parts of some messages by responding inaccurately to certain messages, by taking less time with each message or by reacting only superficially to all messages.

To overcome information overload, realize that some information is not necessary, and make necessary information easily available. Give information meaning, rather than just passing it on and set priorities for dealing with information flow.

Message Complexity

Business messages deal with subject matter that can be technical or difficult to express. Imagine trying to write interesting insurance policies, guidelines for checking credit references. These topics are dry, and making them interesting is a real challenge.

To overcome the barriers of complex messages, keep them clear and easy to understand. Be sure to ask for feedback so that you can clarify and improve your message.

Message Competition

Communicators are often faced with messages that compete for attention. If you are talking on the phone while scanning a report, both messages are apt to get short shrift. Even your own messages may have to compete with a variety of interruptions: The phone rings every five minutes, people intrude, meetings are called, and crises arise.

To overcome competition barriers, avoid making demands on a receiver who does not have the time to pay careful attention to your message. Be sure to set aside enough time for important messages that you receive.

Differing Status

Employees of low status may be overly cautious when sending messages to managers and may talk only about subjects they think the manager is interested in. Similarly, higher status people may distort messages by refusing to discuss anything that would tend to undermine their authority in the organization.

To overcome status barriers, keep managers and colleagues well informed. Encourage lower- status employees to keep you informed. When you have information that you are afraid your boss might not like, be brave and convey it any way.

Inadequate Communication Structure

Structural barriers block upward, downward, and horizontal communication. To overcome structural barriers, offer opportunities for communicating upward, downward, and horizontally. Try to reduce hierarchical levels, increase coordination between departments and encourage two-way communication.

Lack of Trust

For communication to be successful, organizations must create an atmosphere of fairness and trust. To overcome trust barriers, be visible and accessible. Do not insulate yourself behind assistants or secretaries./ Share key information with colleagues and employees, communicate honestly, and include employees in decision making.

Incorrect Choice of Medium

If you choose an inappropriate communication medium, your message can be distorted so that the intended meaning is blocked. To overcome media barriers, choose the richest media for non-routine, complex message.

Closed Communication Climate

A directive, authoritarian style blocks the free and open exchange of information. To overcome climate barriers, spend more time listening than issuing orders. Make sure you respond constructively to employees, and encourage employees and colleagues to offer suggestions, help set goals, participate in solving problems, and help make decisions.

Unethical Communication

Ethical messages are crucial to any organization's credibility and success. To overcome ethics barriers, make sure your messages include all the information that ought to be there. Also make sure your message is completely truthful, not deceptive in any way.

Inefficient Communication

Communication can be blocked by inefficiency. Be clear about the writing assignments you accept as well as the ones you assign.

Physical Distortion

Communication barriers are often physical: bad connections, poor acoustics, and illegible copy. Your receiver might also be distracted by an uncomfortable chair, poor lighting or some other irritating condition. The barrier may be related to the receiver's health. Hearing or visual impairment or even a headache can interfere with reception of a message. To overcome physical barriers, exercise as much control as possible over the physical transmission link.

1.6 Using Technological Tools to Improve Communication

Employees who are comfortable using communication technologies have a competitive advantage in today's market place. In today's flexible office settings, communication technology helps people keep in touch and stay productive. When co-workers in different cities need to collaborate, they can meet and share ideas without costly travels.

1.6.1 Communicating in the Office**Redefining the Office:**

Technology makes it easier for people to stay connected with co-workers and retrieve needed information. Some maintain that connection without having a permanent office, a desktop PC, or even a big filing cabinet. For example, a Sun Micro system lets staff members choose to work either at the main office or at remote offices called "drop-in centers". Many sun facilities have specially equipped "iWork" areas that can quickly reconfigure phone and computer connections to meet individual requirements.



Figure-1.2: Communicating in the office

Flexible Workstations: Many Professionals have abandoned desktop PCs for laptops they can carry home, on travel, and to meetings. Back at their desks, a docking station transforms the laptop into a full-featured PC with network connection. Workers without permanent desks sometimes share PCs that automatically reconfigure themselves to access each user's e-mail and files.

Follow-Me Phone Service: To be reachable without juggling multiple forwarding numbers, some people have follow-me phone service. Callers use one number to reach the person anywhere- at the office, a remote site, a home office. The system automatically forwards calls to a list of preprogrammed numbers and transfers unanswered calls to voice mail.

Intranets: Business use internet technologies to create an intranet, a private computer network that simplifies information sharing within the company. Intranets can handle company e-mail, instant messaging (IM), websites, and even internet phone connections. To ensure the security of company communication and information, intranets are shielded from the public internet.

Electronic Presentation: Combining a color projector with a laptop or personal digital assistant (PDA) running the right software lets people give informative business presentations that are enhanced with sound animation, and even website hyperlinks. Having everything in electronic form also makes it easy to customize a presentation or to make last-minute changes.

Wireless Networks: Laptop PCs with wireless access cards let workers stay connected to the network from practically anywhere within the office- any desk, any conference room. This technology offers high-speed Internet access within range of a wireless access point.

1.7.2 Communicating Remotely

Collaborating: Working in teams is essential in almost every business. Teamwork can become complicated, however, when team members work in different parts of the company, in different time zones, or even for different companies. Technology helps bridge the distance by making it possible to brainstorm, attend virtual meetings, and share files from widely separated locations. Communication technology also helps companies save money on costly business travel without losing most of the benefits of face-to-face collaboration.



Figure-1.3: Communicating remotely

Wall Displays: Teams commonly solve problems by brainstorming at a whiteboard. Wall displays take this concept one step further, letting participants transmit words and diagrams to distant colleagues via the corporate intranet. Users can even share the virtual pen to make changes and additions from more than one location.

Shared Workspaces: Online workspaces such as e-Room and Groove make it easy for far-flung team members to access shared files anywhere, anytime. Accessible through a browser, the workspace contains a collection of folders and has built-in intelligence to control which team members can read, edit, and save specific files.

Internet Videophone: person-to-person video calling has long been possible through popular instant messaging programs. Internet videophone services do even more, letting multiple users participate in a videoconference without the expense and complexity of a full-fledged videoconferencing system. Some services are flexible enough to include telecommuters who have broadband internet connection.

Videoconferencing and Tele-presence: Less costly than travel, videoconferencing provides many of the same benefits as an in-person meeting. Advanced systems include

tele-presence and robot surrogates, which use computers to “place” participants in the room virtually, letting them see and hear everyone while being seen and heard themselves. Such realistic interaction makes meetings more productive.

Web-Based Meetings: Workers can actively participate in web-based meetings by logging on from a desktop PC, laptop, or cell phone. Websites such as web Ex help users integrate voice, text, and video and let them share applications such as Microsoft PowerPoint and Microsoft Word in a single browser window.

1.6.2 Communicating about Products and Services

Sharing the latest Information:

Companies use varieties of communication technology to create products and services and to deliver them to customers. The ability to easily access and share the latest information improves the flow and timing of supplies, lowers operating costs, and boosts financial performance. Easy information access also helps companies respond to customer needs by providing them timely, accurate information and service and by delivering the right products to them at the right time.

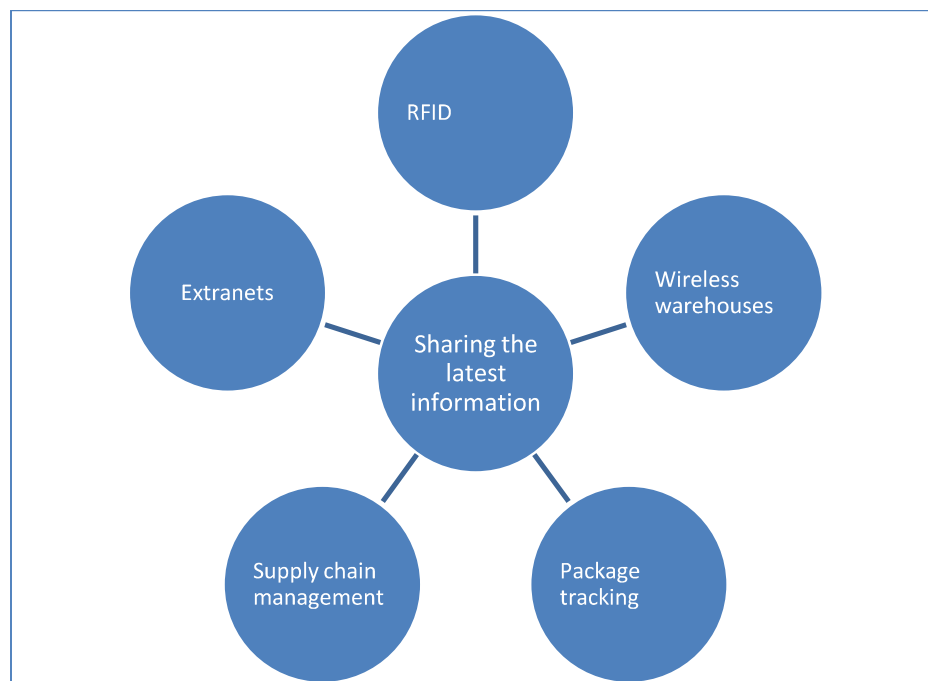


Figure-1.4: communicating about products and services

RFID: Throughout the distribution chain, from factories to ships to warehouses to retail shelves, companies can replace manual tracking and reporting with automated systems that monitor small radio- frequency identification (RFID) tags attached to goods and containers.

Extranets: Extranets are secure, private computer networks that use internet technology to share business information with suppliers, vendors, partners, and customers. Think of an

extranet as an extension of the company intranet that is available to people outside the organization by invitation only.

Supply Chain Management: Advanced software applications let suppliers, manufacturers, and retailers share information-even when they have incompatible computer systems. Improved information flow increases report accuracy and helps each company in the supply chain manage stock levels.

Package Tracking: Senders and receivers often want frequent updates when packages are in transit. Handheld devices such as the FedEx Power Pad enhance customer service by letting delivery personnel instantly upload package data to the FedEx network. The wireless Power Pad also aids drivers by automatically receiving weather advisories.

Wireless Warehouses: Communication technology is a key source of competitive advantage for shipping companies such as FedEx and UPS. Hand-worn scanners use wireless links to help warehouse personnel access instant information that lets them process more packages in less time at transit hubs.

1.7.4 Communicating with Customer

Interacting:

Maintaining an open dialog with customers is a great way to gain a better understanding of their likes and dislikes. Today's communication technologies make it easier for customers to interact with a company whenever, wherever, and however they wish. A well-coordinated approach to phone, web, and in-store communication helps a company build stronger relationships with its existing customers, which increases the chances of doing more business with each one.

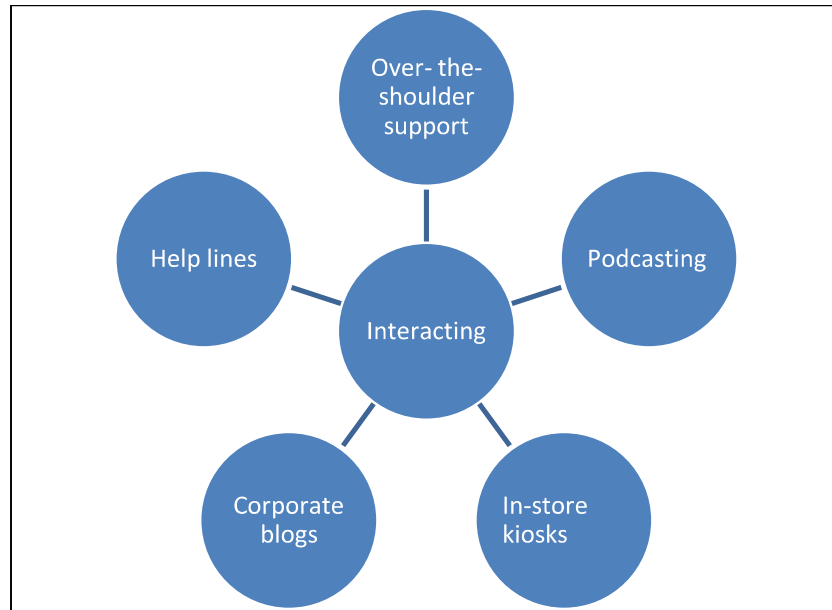


Figure-1.5: Communicating with Customer

Over-the Shoulder-Support: For online shoppers who need instant help, many retail websites make it easy to connect with a live sales rep via phone or instant messaging. The rep can provide quick answers to questions and, with permission, can even control a shopper's browser to help locate particular items.

Help Lines: Some people prefer the personal touch of contact by phone. Moreover, some companies assign preferred customers special ID numbers that let them jump to the front of the calling queue. Many companies are addressing the needs of foreign-language speakers by connecting them with external service providers who offer multilingual support.

Corporate Blogs: Web-based journals let companies offer advice, answer questions, and promote the benefits of their products and services. Elements of a successful blog include frequent updates and the participation of knowledgeable contributors. Adding a subtle mix of useful commentary and marketing messages helps get customers to read or listen to them.

In-Store Kiosks: Staples is among the retailers that let shoppers buy from the web while they're still in the store. Web-connected kiosks were originally used to let shoppers' custom-configure their pcs, but the kiosks also give customers access to roughly 8,000 in-store items as well as to the 50,000 products available online.

Podcasting: With the portability and convenience of download able audio and video recordings, podcasts have quickly become a popular means of delivering everything from college lectures to marketing messages. Podcasts are also used for internal communication, replacing conference calls, newsletters, and other traditional communication vehicles.

1.8 Communication in Diversified Culture

Culture is a shared system of symbols, beliefs, attitudes, values, expectation and behavior norms. Intercultural communication is the process of sending and receiving messages between people whose cultural backgrounds could lead them to interpret verbal and nonverbal signs differently. Every attempt to send and receive message is influenced by culture, so to communicate successfully, you need a basic grasp of the cultural differences you may encounter and how you should handle them.

1.8.1 Cultural Differences

Contextual Differences

Cultural context is the pattern of physical cues, environmental stimuli, and implicit understanding that conveys meaning between members of the same culture. High context cultures rely heavily on nonverbal actions and environmental setting to convey meaning; Low context cultures rely more on explicit verbal communication.

Legal and Ethical differences

Cultural context influences legal and ethical behavior, which in turn can affect communication. Honesty and respect are corner stone's of ethical communication, regardless of culture. You can keep your messages ethical by applying four basic principles: actively seek mutual ground, send and receive message without judgment, send messages that are honest, show respect for cultural differences.

Social Differences

The nature of social behavior varies among cultures. Some behavioral rules are formal where as others are informal and learned over time. Formal rules of etiquette are explicit and well defined but informal rules are learned through observation and imitation. Social norms can vary from culture to culture in the following areas.

- Attitudes toward work and success: Respect and rank are reflected differently from culture to culture in way people are addressed and in their working environment.
- Roles and status:
- Use of Manners: The rules of polite behavior vary from country to country.
- Concepts of time: Attitudes toward time, such as strict adherence to meeting schedules, can vary throughout the world.
- Future orientation
- Openness and inclusiveness: Cultures around the world exhibit varying degrees of openness toward both outsiders and people whose personal identities do not align with prevailing social norms.

Nonverbal Differences

The meaning of nonverbal signals can vary widely from culture to culture, so you cannot rely on assumptions. When you have the opportunity to interact with people in another culture, the best advice is to study the culture in advance and then observe the way people behave in the following areas:

- Greetings: hand shake
- Personal space: close
- Touching:
- Facial expression: Using Head for indicating no or yes
- Eye Contact: frequent eye contact
- Posture: relax in office or not
- Formality: Less or more formal

Age difference

A culture's views on youth and aging affect how people communicate with one another. In US culture, youth is often associated with strength, possibilities and freedom and age is sometimes associated with declining powers and the inability to keep pace.

Gender Differences

Gender influences workplace communication in several important ways. Broadly speaking, men tend to emphasize content in their messages, while women tend to emphasize relationship.

Religious Difference

As one of most personal and influential aspects of life, religion brings potential for controversy and conflict in the workplace setting.

Ability Differences

Assistive technologies help employers create more inclusive workplaces and benefit from the contribution of people with physical or cognitive impairments.

1.8.2 Improving Intercultural Communication Skills

Studying Other Cultures:

- Understand your own culture so that you can recognize its influences on your communication habits
- Study other cultures so that you can appreciate cultural variation

Studying other Languages:

- Study the languages of people with whom you communicate, even if you can learn only a few basic words and phrase
- Help nonnative speakers learn your language

Respecting Preferences for Communication style:

- Respect cultural preferences for communication style

Writing Clearly:

- Write clearly, using brief messages, simple language, and appropriate international conventions
- Avoid slang, humor and references to popular culture

Speaking and listening carefully:

- Speak clearly and slowly, giving listeners time to translate your word
- Ask for feedback to verify that communication was successful
- Listen carefully and ask speakers to repeat anything you do not understand

Using interpreters, translation software:

- For important business communication, use a professional interpreter or translator

Helping others adapt to your Culture:

- Help others adapt to your culture; it will create a more productive workplace and teach you about their cultures as well.

Chapter 2: Developing Writing Skill

2.1 Audience Adaptation

In a communication process, it is important to adapt sender messages to the needs and expectations of audience. If the intended audience members think a message does not apply to them or doesn't meet their needs, they'll be far less inclined to pay attention to it. To successfully adapt a message to the audience, its need to be sensitive to audience needs, build a strong relationship with audience and control definite style to maintain a professional tone.

2.1.1 Audience's Needs Sensitivity

Even a simple message with intended information and using all the right words may fail to be sensitive with audience members and their needs. It can be possible by adopting some easy going ways such as ‘Use the You attitude’, ‘maintaining good standards of etiquette’, ‘emphasizing the positive’ and ‘using bias free language’.

2.1.1.1 ‘You’ attitude

The ‘You attitude’ is best implemented by expressing your message in terms of your audience’s wishes, interests, hopes and preferences. You can adopt the ‘you attitude’ by replacing terms that refer to yourself and your company with terms that refer to audience.

Don’t Do This	Do This
• Use of I, me, mine, we, us and ours.	• Use You and Yours
▪ To help us process this order, we must ask for another copy of the requisition.	• To fill up your order promptly, please send another copy of the requisition.
• We are pleased enough to announce our new flight from Atlanta to New York.	• Now you can take a plane from Atlanta to New York.

2.1.1.2 Etiquette

Another good way to demonstrate interest in audience members and to earn their respect by being courteous to members of your audience, you show consideration for them and foster a more successful environment for communication. Although you may be tempted and frustrated with co-workers, customers or others, try to express the facts in a kind and thoughtful manner by using diplomatic skills. Be tactful when communicating with higher

Don’t Do This	Do This
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level and outside the company.

Don’t Do This	Do This
• Once again, you’ve managed to bring down the entire website through your incompetent programming.	• Let’s review the last website update so that we can find out how to improve the process.

2.1.1.3 Positive mood

• It's impossible to repair your Laptop today.	• Your computer can be ready by Tuesday.
• We apologize for inconveniencing you during our remodeling.	• The renovations now under way will help us serve you better.
• The problem with this department is a failure to control costs.	• The performance of this department can be improved by tightening cost controls.

During your career, you will encounter situations in which unpleasant news can significantly affect the personal and financial well-being of employees, customers and investors. You can communicate negative news without being negative. When the tone of message is negative, it creates unnecessary strain on business relationship, may cause people to distance themselves from you and your ideas. Never try to hide the negative news, but always be on the lookout for positive points that will foster a good relationship with your audience. When you are offering criticism or advice, focus on what the person can do to improve. Show your audience member how they will benefit from complying with your message.

2.1.1.4 Unbiased language

Bias –free language avoid words and phrases that unfairly and even unethically categorize related to gender, race, ethnicity, age or disability that may offend your audience. Language reflects the way we think and what we believe, and biased language may perpetuate the underlying stereotypes and prejudices that it represents. Bias can be occurred as following ways –

Gender Bias

Avoid using words containing ‘man’, female gender words, using special designation (Women doctor, male nurse), using ‘he’ to refer to ‘everyone’, identifying women by marital status. Reword sentences to use ‘they’ or to use no pronoun at all rather than referring to all individuals as ‘he’.

- **Racial and Ethnic Bias**

Avoid language suggesting that members of racial or an ethnic group have stereotypical characteristics. Avoid identifying people by race or ethnicity. For instance, ‘My African –American assistant speaks more articulately than I do.’ ‘Mario M. Cuomo, Italian American politician and ex-governor of New-York’.

- **Age Bias**

Be careful of the context in which you use words that refer to age. Such words carry a variety of positive and negative connotations and not only when referring to people beyond a certain age. Avoid mentioning age when irrelevant. For instance, Mary Kiraz, 58, has just joined our trust department.

- **Disability Bias**

Avoid mentioning a disability unless it is pertinent. If you have to mention, avoid terms such as ‘handicapped’, ‘crippled’, or ‘retarded’. Put the person first and the disability second. Present the whole person by showing the limitations in an unobstructive manner.

2.1.2 Audience’s Relationship Development

Focusing on your audience’s needs is vital to effective communication as well as having your own priorities as a communicator. There are the two ways by which you can address your own needs while building positive relationships with your audience.

2.1.2.1 Credibility

People are more likely to react positively to your message when they have confidence in you. If you want to build credibility with a new audience, and to maintain credibility with an existing audience or even to restore credibility after a mistake, emphasize the following key efforts-

- Honesty
- Objectivity
- Awareness of audience needs
- Credentials, Knowledge and Expertise
- Endorsements’
- Performance
- Confidence
- Communication style
- Sincerity

Don’t Do This	Do This
• We hope this recommendation will be helpful.	• We’re glad to make this recommendation.
• If you’d like to order, mail us the reply card.	• To order, mail the reply card.

2.1.2.2 Company's Image

When it's a matter of communicating with outsiders, on even the most routine matter, you serve as the spokesperson for your Organization which may enhance or damage the reputation of the entire company. The interests and preferred communication style of your company must take precedence over your own views and personal communication style. For Instance, whether you're blogging, updating a website or even just exchanging IM with a customer, you're responsible for protecting your company's preferred image to the outside world.

2.1.3 Style and Tone

Style is the way you use words to achieve a certain tone, or overall impression. You can use different style, your sentence structure and vocabulary, to sound forceful or objective, personal or formal, colorful or dry depends on the nature of your message and your relationship with the reader.

2.1.3.1 Conventional Tone

Most business messages aim for a conversational style that is warm but still businesslike. The tone of your business messages can range from informal to conversational to formal. You can achieve a conversational tone in your messages by following these guidelines:

- Avoid obsolete and pompous language: Business language used to be much more formal than it is today, but some out-of-date phrases still find their way into communication efforts. Avoid using big words, trite expressions, and overly complicated sentences to impress others.
- Avoid preaching and bragging: If you need to remind your audience of something obvious, try to work in the information casually, perhaps in the middle of a paragraph, where it will sound like a secondary comment rather than a major revelation.
- Be careful with intimacy: Most business messages should avoid intimacy, such as sharing personal details or adopting a casual, unprofessional tone. When it's a matter of close relationship with your audience, then a more intimate tone is sometimes appropriate and even expected.
- Be careful with humor: Humor is a tool to inject interest into dry subjects or take the sting out of negative news. The humor must be connected to the point you're trying to make. Never use humor in formal messages or when

you're communicating across cultural boundaries. When in doubt, leave in out.

2.1.3.2 Plain English

Simple English is a way of presenting information in a simple, unadorned style so that your audience can easily grasp your meaning, without struggling through specialized, technical or convoluted language. Audiences can understand and act on plain English without reading it over and over. Simple English can also help you simplify the messages you prepare for audiences who speak English only as a second or third language. Even though readers overwhelmingly appreciate simple English, Some unnecessary complex writing is still more common.

- One reason is that writers are sometimes unsure about their own writing skill and believe that packaging simple ideas in complex writing makes their messages more impressive.
- Another reason is that some writers intentionally try to create themselves and their audience.

Bear in mind that plain English doesn't have to be simplistic, dull or imprecise. The point is to be clear, not lifeless and consider the needs and expectations of your audience.

2.1.3.3 Voice Selection

When you use active sentences, your messages generally sound less formal and make it easier for readers to figure out who performed the action. Active sentences are usually stronger than passive ones. In contrast, using passive voice de-emphasizes the subject and implies that the action was done by something or someone. Use passive sentences to soften bad news, to put your-self in the background, or to create an impersonal tone.

2.2 Message Composition

Composition is much easier if you've already figured out what to say and in what order. As you compose your first order, try to let your creativity flow. Don't try to draft and edit at the same time or worry about getting everything perfect. You'll have time to revise and refine the material later before showing it anyone. Revisit your purpose and confirm project. As you create and refine your messages, learn to view your writing at three levels: Strong Words, effective sentences and Coherent paragraphs.

2.2.1 Strong Words Selection

Effective messages depend on carefully chosen words, whether you select them during your first draft or edit them later. The rules of grammar and usage can be a source of worry for all writers, because many of these rules are complex and can evolve over time. Using

correct grammar enhances your image. If you make grammatical or usage errors, you lose credibility with your audience, even if your message is otherwise correct. Effectiveness is the second consideration when choosing words generally more difficult to achieve than correctness.

2.2.1.1 Functional and Content Words

Functional words express the relationships among content words. Functional words express relationships and have only one unchanging meaning in any given context. Content words are multi-dimensional and frequently subject to various interpretations. In your sentences, content words are the building blocks and functional words are the mortar that holds them together.

2.2.1.2 Communicating Words

By practicing your writing, try to use words that are powerful and familiar and communicate exactly what you want to say.

- **Choose Powerful words:**

Choose words that express your thoughts most clearly, specifically, and dynamically. Verbs are especially powerful because they tell what's happening in the sentence, so make them dynamic and specific. For instance, you could replace fall with plummet, drop, or decline to suggest the magnitude of the decrease.

- **Choose familiar words:**

You'll communicate best with words that are familiar to your readers. Trying to use an unfamiliar word for the first time in an important document can lead to embarrassing mistakes.

- **Avoid clichés and buzzwords:**

Avoid using some terms and phrases that are so common or so trendy and have lost power to communicate strongly. Most people use these phrases not because they think it makes message more vivid and inviting but because they don't invest the energy required for original writing or worry about using with the latest trendy language.

- **Use jargon carefully:**

Using jargon creates an effective way to communicate within specific groups that understand their own special terms. For Instance, when a recording engineer wants to communicate that a particular piece of music is devoid of reverberation and other

sounds effect, it's easier to describe as 'dry' but who aren't familiar with these terms, Jargon is meaningless and intimidating to them.

For improving your business writing skills, make a note of the words you think are effective and keep them in a file when you read business journals, newspapers and even novels. You may be surprised how they can strengthen your writing.

2.2.2 Effective Sentences

2.2.2.1 Sentence Styles

Selecting the optimum type of sentence, then arrange words to emphasize the key point's supports to create powerful message. Choosing from the four types of sentences:

A simple sentence has one main clause with a single subject and a single predicate) may be expanded by nouns and pronouns serving as objects of the action and modifying phrases. For instance, "Profits increased in the last year".

A compound sentence has two main clauses with two or more independent but related thoughts usually joined by and, but, or. For instance, "Wage rates have declined by 6% and Employee turnover rate has been high by 2%".

A complex sentence expresses one main thought and one or more subordinate thoughts related to it. The subordinate clause can't stand alone as a valid sentence. For instance, "although you may question Gerald's conclusions, you must admit that his research is thorough."

A compound complex sentence has two main clauses, at least one of which contains a subordinate clause. For instance, "because the chemical products division is the strongest in the company, its management techniques should be adopted by the other divisions."

If you use too many simple sentences, you won't be able to properly express the relationship among your ideas. On the other hand, an uninterrupted series of complex or compound-complex sentences is hard to follow. To make your writing as effective as possible, strive for variety and balance using all four sentence types.

2.2.2.2 Key Thoughts

In every message, you can emphasize your key ideas through your sentence style. When you want to call attention to a thought, use extra words to describe it. For instance, to emphasize the importance of the chairperson, you must describe him as like: Having considerable experience in corporate takeover battles, the chairperson called for a vote of the shareholders.

2.2.3 Crafting Paragraphs

Paragraphs organize sentences related to the same general topic and readers expect to focus on a single unit of thoughts and to be a logical link in an organized sequence of the thoughts that make up a complete message. Arranging the elements of each paragraph, you help your readers' grasp the main idea of your document.

2.2.3.1 Elements: Most paragraphs consist of-

- A topic sentence that reveals the subject of the paragraph. In formal and creative writing, the topic sentences may be implied and in business writing, it is generally explicit. Topic sentences help you as a writer because they remind you of the purpose of each paragraph and thereby help you stay focused.
- Related sentences that support and expand the topic. These sentences must all have a bearing on the general subject and must provide enough specific details to make the topic clear. A paragraph is well developed when it contains enough information to make the topic sentence convincing and interesting and having no extraneous sentences.
- Transitional elements that help readers move between sentences and paragraphs. Transitions are words or phrases that tie ideas together by showing how one thought is related to another. You begin planning these transitions while you're outlining. Transitional elements include connecting words, repeated words or phrases, pronoun, and words that are frequently paired. Keep in mind that transitional words are necessary, but put your ideas into a strong framework first and then use transitions to link them together even more strongly.

2.2.3.2 Developments

Unification and coherence strongly depend on how you develop your paragraphs. Use a structure that is familiar to your readers, appropriate to the idea you're trying to portray, and suited to your purpose. Five of the most common development techniques are –

- **Illustration:** Giving examples that demonstrate the general idea. For instance, some of our most popular products are available through local distributors. Wilmot food, also a major distributor, now carries our newline of frozen dessert.
- **Comparison or contrast:** Using similarities or differences to develop the topic. For instance, our successful bid on the Owens contract means that we will be doubling our labor force over the next six months. To hire that many people without disrupting our ongoing activities, we will create a separate recruiting group within the HR department.

- **Cause and Effect:** Focusing on the reasons for something. For instance, the heavy duty fabric of your wanderer tent probably broke down due to the fibers gradually because the tent was folded and stored while still wet.
- **Classification:** Showing how a general idea is broken into specific categories. For instance, successful candidates for our supervisor trainee program generally come from one of several groups. One consists of recent graduates and other from within our own company to promote promising workers of greater responsibility.
- **Problem and Solution:** Presenting a problem and then discussing the solution. For instance, selling handmade toys online is a challenge because consumers are accustomed to buying heavily advertised toys from major chain stores or well- known websites. If we develop an appealing website, we can compete on the basis of product novelty and quality at a competitive price.

Chapter 3: Electronic and Social Media Communications

3.1 Message Selection

E-Mail:

Conventional email has long been a vital medium for business communication.

Instant Messaging:

IM offers greater speed than email as well as simple operation and fewer problems with unwanted message or security and privacy problems.

Text Messaging:

Phone based text messaging has a number of applications in business communication.

Web content:

Websites are one of the most important electronic media types from small business sites to large corporate sites.

Podcasting:

You may be familiar with podcasts as the online equivalent of recorded radio or video broadcasts. Business is now using podcasts to replace or supplement some conference calls, newsletters, and training courses.

Social networks:

Social networks have evolved into major business communication technology, from well-known public network to private.

Information and media sharing sites:

In addition to the social networks, a variety of systems have been designed specially for sharing content, including user generated content sites, community Q &A sites.

Wikis:

The collaborative nature of wikis - websites that can be expanded and edited by teams, user communities, or the public at large- make them a natural for aggregating ‘crowded knowledge’.

Blogging and micro blogging:

The ability to update content quickly and easily makes blogs and micro blog (such as Twitter) a natural medium when communicators want to get message out in a hurry.

Online video:

Now that You Tube and similar websites have made online video available to hundreds of millions of web users, video has been transformed from a fairly specialized tool to a mainstream business communication medium.

3.2 Effective E-mail

Guide lines for writing effective E-mail:

Planning

- Make sure every email message you send is necessary.
- Do not cc or bcc anyone who does not really need to see the message.
- Follow the company email policy; understand the restrictions your company places on email usage.
- Follow the chain of command.
- Do not let unread message pileup in your basket.
- Remember that message can be forwarded anywhere and saved forever.
- Make sure your computer has up to date virus protection.

Writing

- Business email is more formal than personal email.
- Recognize that email messages carry the same legal weight as other business documents.
- Pay attention to the quality of your writing and use correct grammar, spelling and punctuation.
- Clearly identifying the purpose of your message.
- Use first few words of the email body to catch the reader's attention.
- Never type in all caps.

Completing

- Revise and proofread carefully to avoid embarrassing mistakes.
- Keep the layout of your messages simple and clean. Avoid sending long, complex messages.
- Use an email signature file to give recipients your contact information.
- Double check your recipient list before sending.

3.3 Instant Messages and Text Messages

Instant messaging, in which users' messages appear on each other's screen instantly, is used extensively for internal and external communication. IM is available in stand-alone system, online meeting system, collaboration systems, social network and other platforms.

IM offers many benefits: Rapid response, low cost, availability to mimic conversation, wide availability

Guidelines for Effective and Efficient IM:

- Be courteous in your use of IM.
- If you are not on a secure system, do not send confidential information.
- Be extremely careful about sending personal messages- they have a tendency to pop up on other people's computers at embarrassing moments.
- Do not use IM for impromptu meetings.
- Unless your system is set up for it, do not use IM for lengthy, complex messages.
- Try to avoid carrying on multiple IM conversations at once.
- Follow all security guidelines designed to keep your company's information and system safe from attack.

3.4 Website Content

To organize a site effectively, follow these tips:

- Brainstorm all the likely usage scenarios-
Who will visit the site?
Where will they be coming from?
What will they be looking for?
What terms will they use to identify the information they need?
- Identify all the likely entry points to the site and the target information for each visitor segment.
- Create a map or other visual tool that shows all the path ways between entry points and target information, then organize the content and links in the simplest, most direct way possible.
- Make sure visitors can always find their way back to the top level of the site, even if a search engine link plunked them onto a page deep within the site.
- Give visitors options for finding what they want. Some will want to search by key terms for example, whereas others will prefer to follow clearly defined paths that drill down into more specific information(such as products>Consumer Products>Tools>).
- Be consistent with labels and link behaviors and use commonly accepted terminology.

3.5 Podcasting

Podcasting is the process of recording audio or video files and distribute them online. For basic podcasts, your computer and smart phone might have the hardware you need and you can download free recording software.

The Podcasting Process:

Install recording software



Connect and Verify microphone



Click the record station and start talking



Review your file and edit if needed



Convert file to MP3 format and save



Create and validate your feed



Upload your file and let RSS alert your subscribers

Guidelines for Effective Podcasts

- If you plan a podcast channel with a regular stream of new content, make sure you have identified a theme or purpose that is rich enough to sustain your effort.
- Pay close attention to previews, transitions and review to help prevent your audience from getting lost.
- Decide whether you want to improvise or speak from a written script.
- If you improvise, do enough planning and organization to avoid floundering and rambling in search of a point.
- Remember that editing is much more difficult to do with audio or video than textual media and plan your content and recording carefully.

3.6 Social Networks

Social Networks, online services that help people and organizations form connections and share information, have become a major force in both internal and external business communication in recent years. Business communications make use of a wide range of specialized and private social networks in addition to public networks such as face book and Google+. These can be grouped into three categories:

- Public, general purpose network: face book, Google+,

- Public, specialized networks: For particular audience e.g. LinkedIn-career and sales-related networking.
- Private network: Some companies have built private social networks for internal use.

Key applications of social networks:

- Integrating company workforce
- Fostering collaboration
- Building communities
- Specializing brand and companies
- Understanding target markets
- Recruiting employees and business partners
- Connecting with sales prospects
- Supporting customers
- Extending the organization

3.7 Information and Media Sharing Sites

You Tube and other user generated content sites are now important business communication channels.

- **User generated content sites**

You Tube, Flickr, Yelp and other user generated content sites, in which users rather than website owners contribute most or all of the content, have a serious business tools. On 'You tube' companies post everything from product demonstrations.

- **Media curation sites**

Media curation is the process of collecting and presenting information on a particular topic in a way that makes it convenient for target readers.
(<http://bchn.businesscommunicationnetwork.com>)

- **Community Q&A sites**

Community Q&A sites offer great opportunities for building your personal brand. (<http://answers.yahoo.com>)

3.8 Blogging

Blogs, online journals that are easier to personalize and update than conventional websites are now a major forces in business communication. Writing in a personal, authentic voice is key to attracting and keeping blog readers. Business bloggers pay close attention to following elements:

- Communicating with personal style and an authentic voice
- Delivering new information quickly

- Choosing topics of peak interest to audience
- Encouraging audiences to join the conversation.

3.9 Wiki

To be a valuable wiki contributor, keeps these points in mind:

- Let go of traditional expectations of authorship, including individual recognition and control.
- Encourage all team members to improve each other's work.
- Use page templates and other formatting options to make sure your content matches the rest of the wiki.
- Many wikis provide both editing and commenting capabilities and participants should use appropriate tools for each.
- Take advantage of the sandbox. Non-published section of the wiki where team members can practice editing and writing.

Part 2: Business Correspondences

Chapter 4: Business Messages Development and Letters Writings

4.1 Developing Routine Requests and Positive Messages

4.1.1 Routine Requests: A routine request in which you ask for information or action from another party. For routine and positive messages-state the request or main idea, give necessary details, close with a cordial request for specific action.

State Request: You can make your request at the beginning of the message. You have to pay attention to tone, assume that your audience will comply, be specific.

Explain and Justify Request:

- Justify the request or explain its importance
- Explain any potential benefits of responding
- Ask the most important questions first
- Break complex requests into individual questions

Courteous Close:

- Make it easy to comply by including appropriate contact information
- Express your gratitude/appreciation
- Clearly state any important deadlines for request

Example of Routine Request: The most common types of routine message are asking for information or action, asking for recommendations, and making claims and requesting adjustments.

Letter: Requesting action

Dear Managers:

At last week's off-site meeting, Mr. Chowdury asked me to coordinate our companywide competitive threat analysis project. In order to devise a comprehensive strategic response that is sensitive to local market valuations. We need your individual insights and advice. To minimize the effort for you and to ensure consistent data collection across all regions, I have attached a template that identifies all the key questions we would like to have answered. I realize this will require several hours of work on your part, but the result will be truly nationwide look at your competitive situation. From this information, we can create a plan for next fiscal year that makes the best use of finite resources while adapting to your local district needs.

To allow sufficient time to compile your inputs before the November 13 board meeting. Please, email your responses to me by November 8. Thanks for your help and timely attention to this important project.

Sincerely,

Mr. Akter Hossain

4.1.2 Routine Reply and Positive Messages

When you are responding positively to a request, sending routine announcements, or sending a positive or goodwill message, you have several goals: to communicate the information or good news, answer all questions, provide all required details and leave your reader with a good impression of you and your firm.

- **Main Idea:** With the direct approach, open with a clear and concise expression of the main idea or good news.
- **Explanation:** Use the body to explain your point completely so that your audience won't be confused or doubtful about your meaning. Maintain a supportive tone throughout. Embed negative statements in positive contexts or balance them with positive alternatives. Talk favorably about the choices the customer has made.
- **Positive Close:** In the close, make sure audience members understand what to do next and how that action will benefit them. Let your readers know you have their personal well-being in mind.

Example of Positive Reply

Most routine and positive messages fall into six main categories: answer to requests for information and action, grants of claims and requests for adjustment, recommendations, routine information, good news announcements and good will messages.

Letter: Responding to claim when the buyer is at fault

Dear Mr. Jamal:¹

Thank you for contacting us about your inline skates. Even though your six month warranty has expired, Skates Run! is sending you a complete wheel assembly replacement free of charge.²

The Eax(model 63) you purchased is our best selling and most reliable skate. However, wheel jam s may occur when fine particles of sand block the smooth rotating actions of the wheels. As noted in the instruction manual, these skates perform best when used on road ways and tracks that are relatively free of sand. We suggest that you remove and clean the wheel assemblies once a month and have been checked by your dealer every six months.³

Give your Dhaka location, you may want to consider our more advanced Glasco(model 107) when you decide to purchase you next pair of skates. The Glasco design protects the wheel assemblies from sand and dirt and should give you years of care free skating.⁴

We love hearing from our skaters, so keep in touch. All of us at Skates Run! Wish you good times and miles of healthy skating.⁵

Sincerely,

Rakib Hasan
Customer service Representative
Skates Run!

¹*personal and respectful salutation*

²*delivers good news*

³*expalin the cause of problem*

⁴*offer a specific suggestion*

⁵*close with forward looking note*

4.2 Developing Negative Messages

Negative messages can have as many as five goals: give the bad news, ensure acceptance of the bad news, maintain reader's goodwill, maintain organization's good image, minimize or eliminate future correspondence on the matter as appropriate.

4.2.1 Direct Approach: Use the direct approach when your negative answer or information will have minimal personal impact.

➤ **Bad News**

Opening with a clear statement of bad news: No matter what the news is, come right out and say it, but maintain a calm, professional tone that keeps the focus on the news and not on individual failures or other personal factors.

➤ **Reasons**

Providing reasons and additional information: You follow the direct opening with an explanation of why the news is negative. The extent of your explanation depends on the nature of the news and your relationship with the reader.

➤ **Positive Close**

Closing on a respectful note: respect the impact the negative news is likely to have on the recipient.

4.2.2 Indirect Approach: Use the indirect approach when some preparation will help your audience accept your bad news.

➤ **Buffer**

Message using the indirect approach open with a buffer: a neutral, noncontroversial statement that establishes common ground with the reader. A good buffer also needs to be relevant and sincere. Poorly written buffers mislead or insult the reader.

➤ **Reasons**

Phrase your reasons to signal the negative news ahead. Do not hide company policy when you deliver bad news, present logical answers instead. Well written reasons are detailed, tactful, individualized, unapologetic, and positive.

➤ **Bad News**

You can use three techniques to convey three negative informations as clearly and as kindly as possible. First: Deemphasize the bad news visually and grammatically.

Second: Use a conditional statement, if appropriate.

Third: Tell what you did do, not what you did not do.

➤ **Positive Close**

A positive close includes- builds goodwill, offers a suggestion for action, provides a look forward the future.

4.2.3 Example of Negative Message

Dear Mr. Masud:

We're happy to learn that you are enjoying the use of the Siko copier you've been leasing for the past ten months. Like our many customers, you have discovered that Siko copiers offer remarkable versatility and reliability¹.

One of the reasons we're able to offer these outstanding copiers at such low leasing rates and equally low purchase prices is that we maintain a slim profit margin. If our program included a provision for applying lease payments toward the purchase price, our overall prices would have to be higher².

Although lease payments cannot be credited toward purchase price, we can offer you other Siko models that are within your price range. The Siko 400 delivers the same reliability with nearly as many features as the Siko 500³.

Please let us demonstrate the Sako 400 to your staff in your office. Our representative, Taher Khan, will call you soon to arrange a time⁴.

Sincerely,

Mr. Mainuddin

¹*Buffer*

²*Reason*

³*Bad News*

⁴*Closing*

4.3 Developing Persuasive Messages

Persuasion is the attempt to change someone's attitudes, beliefs, or actions.

Steps of Persuasive messages:

- **Planning persuasive messages:** having a great idea or a great product is not enough. You need to be able to convince others of its merits.
- **Writing persuasive messages:** encourage a positive response to your persuasive messages by –using positive and polite language, understanding and respecting cultural differences, being sensitive to organizational cultures, taking steps to establish your credibility.
- **Completing persuasive messages:** Careless production undermines your credibility, so revise and proofread with care.

Strategies for Persuasive messages:

- **Structuring Message with AIDA Model**

The AIDA model is useful approach for many persuasive messages which organizes messages into four phases:

- **Get your reader's Attention:** i. Open with an audience benefit, a stimulating question, a problem or an unexpected statement. ii. Establishing common ground by mentioning a point on which you and your audience agree. iii. show that you understand the audience's concern.
- **Build your reader's Interest:** i. Expand and support your opening claim or promise ii. Emphasize the relevance of your message to your audience.
- **Increase your reader's Desire:** i. Make audience members want to change by explaining how the change will benefit them. ii. Backup your claims with relevant evidence
- **Motivate your reader to take Action:** i. Suggest the action you want readers to take ii. Stress the positive results of the action iii. Make the desired action clear and easy.
- **Balancing Emotional and Logical Appeals:** Emotional appeals attempt to connect with the reader's feelings or sympathies. Logical appeals are based on the reader's notions of reason; these appeals can use analogy, induction or deduction.
 - Use emotional appeals to help the audience accept your message.
 - Use logical appeals when presenting facts and evidence for complex ideas or recommendation.

- Avoid faulty logic.
- **Reinforcing Your Position**
 - Provide additional evidence of the benefits of your proposal and your own credibility in offering it.
 - Use abstractions, metaphors and other figures of speech to bring facts and figures to life.
- **Anticipating Objections**
 - Anticipate and answer potential objections.
 - Preset the pros and cons of all options if you anticipate a hostile reaction.

Example of Persuasive Business Message

Mr. Farid Ahmed,
46, Lake Drive Road
Uttara-7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Farid:

Meeting you and touring the building on your property last week was a pleasure. That little building provided me with a fascinating glimpse of the past. You must have found it convenient using the building as a big “attic,” storing all your canned goods and old farm implements over the years.

As the manager of the Home Barbeque in Uttara, I am constantly looking for items to build and display in our restaurants. Our restaurants are constructed of weathered wood to create a genuine rustic atmosphere, which we think complements our “down-home” menu. As I toured your building, I couldn’t help but notice some of the unique items inside and the old weathered boards hanging outside. The wood from the building and its contents would enable us to build and furnish a new restaurant in Kilkate and refurbish our Gulshan location. Mr. Khaleq, owner of Home Barbeque Restaurants, has asked me to extend you the offer explained in the enclosed proposal. Naturally, no amount of money can compensate you for a building that holds so many memories for you. However, we would be happy to purchase the entire contents of the building, excluding any special items of sentimental value that you may want to keep.

Although the thought of selling the building may sadden you, think of the “second life” that the old farm equipment, dishes, washboards, seed bags, and weathered boards would have in our restaurants. People who would otherwise never see such Bangladeshi will have the opportunity to learn a little about its rich past.

After you have reviewed the proposal, please call me at 02-555-3253 to discuss our offer to display your treasures in our restaurants.

Sincerely,

Kamrul Islam,
Manager,
Uttara Store

4.4 Parts of a Business Letter

There are many parts to the business letter — some required, some optional. This section will review those parts and their order. The parts of the business letter follow:

- i. Letterhead(compulsory)
- ii. Date(compulsory)
- iii. File Number
- iv. Addressee notation
- v. Inside Address(compulsory)
- vi. Attention Line
- vii. Salutation(compulsory)
- viii. Subject Line
- ix. Body (compulsory)
- x. Second –page heading:
- xi. Complimentary Close(compulsory)
- xii. Signature(compulsory)
- xiii. Reference Initials
- xiv. Enclosure Notation:
- xv. Copy notation
- xvi. Mailing Instructions
- xvii. Postscript

Letterhead

Most business letters originating from a firm are written on the firm's letterhead. If you are writing a personal business letter or your firm does not use letterhead, then you need to include your firm's address in the heading. Letter head shows the organization's name, full address, telephone number, and e-mail address. Executive letterhead also bears the name of an individual within the organization.

Date

When you are using a heading instead of letterhead, place the date on the first line and the address on the subsequent lines as follows:

September 9, 2017

If you are using letter head, place the date at least one blank line beneath the lowest part of the letter head.

The standard dateline in the U.S. is month/day/year:

(March 15, 2017).

In Europe, however, the most widely used format is day/month/year:

(15 March 2017)

File Number

On occasion, you may wish to include the file number of the project, case or order that the letter refers to. The file number should be physically separated from the date by two spaces and from the part that follows (Confidential or Inside Address) by two spaces.

Addressee notation

Letters that have a restricted readership or that must be handled in a special way should include such addressee notations as *Personal*, *Confidential*, and *Please Forward*. This sort of notation appears a double space above the inside address, in all capital letters.

Inside Address

The inside address identifies the recipient of the letter. This should include the name of the person you are writing to, the person's title (if available), the name of the firm and the firm's address.

Attention Line

This is used when you do not know the name of the person you are writing to and the letter is addressed to the firm. For example, the attention line may say, "Attention: Head of Accounting." It may also be used when you know the name of the person you are writing to but are unsure of the title. The attention line may say, "Attention: Customer Service," thus indicating to the person receiving the letter that the letter also needs to be routed to the

customer service department. Another way of doing this is to use the attention line and send copies of the letter to the appropriate department.

Salutation

The salutation is used in all formats except the Simplified Letter and the Memo. The following are salutations used in American business letters.

- Dear Sir
- Dear Madam (May be followed by title, such as Dear Madam Chairperson.)
- Gentlemen
- Ladies
- Dear Mr. Bryan
- Dear Ms. Gray
- Ladies and Gentlemen
- Dear Personnel Director (a gender-free title)
- To Whom It May Concern or TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN (Use this form as a last resort.)

(Caution: You must determine the appropriate choice, given your reader and the situation. If you are uncertain about your reader's gender, avoid assuming gender in the salutation. Use your reader's name whenever you know it. Researchers discovered that people are more likely to read a letter with their names in the salutation.)

People don't usually get upset if you don't address them with the proper salutation, but they notice and appreciate it when you do. One of the problems you may run into is writing to a person with a name that is not gender specific; for example, the name Terry. The simplest solution in the salutation is to say, "Dear Terry Lucas." If you are addressing a group of people in general, such as the shipping department, do not assume they are all male. The old "Gentlemen" is not acceptable. "Shipping Agents" is preferred.

Subject Line

The subject line tells recipients at a glance what the letter is about. It usually appears below the salutation, either against the left margin, indented or centered. It can be placed above the salutation or at the very top of the page and it can be under scored. Some businesses omit the word *Subject* and some organizations replace it with *Re:* or *In re:*

Subject: Rain master Sprinklers

About your February 2, 2010, order

Reference Order No. 27920

Body of the Letter

The body of the letter is your message.

Second –page heading:

Use a second –page heading whenever an additional page is required. All the following are acceptable forms for second-page headings:

Mr. Habib Ahmed

May 10, 2017

Page 2

Or

Mr. Habib Ahmed, May 10, 2017, Page 2

Or

Mr. Habib Ahmed -2- May 10, 2017

Complimentary Close

This varies in formality and is found in all business letters. The following complimentary closes are in order of decreasing formality:

- Very truly yours,
- Respectfully,
- Sincerely yours,
- Cordially,
- Sincerely,

Signature

There should be four lines between the complimentary close and your typed name so there is room for your signature. The person's title may appear on the same line as the name or on the line below:

Cordially,

Rafiqul Islam

Director of Personnel

If your name could be taken for either a man's or a woman's, a courtesy title indicating gender should be included, with or without parentheses. Also, women who prefer a particular courtesy title should include it:

Mrs. Akhi

(Miss) Jamuna

Reference Initials

When business people keyboard their own letters, reference initials are unnecessary. When one person dictates a letter and another person produces it, reference initials show who helped prepare it.

RSR:SM(writer/preparer)

When the writer and the signer are different people, at least the file copy should bear both their initials as well as the typist's:

JES/ RSR/SM(signer/writer/preparer)

Enclosure Notation

Enclosure notations appear at the bottom of a letter, one or two lines below the reference initials.

Enclosures: Resume

Photograph

Copy notation

Copy notations may follow reference initials or enclosure notations. They indicate who is receiving a courtesy copy (cc). Some companies made on a photocopier (pc or they simply use copy©. Recipients are listed in order of rank in alphabetical order.

Cc: Emdadul Hoque, Vice- president

Pc: Mr.Kamrul Hasan

Copy to: Abdul Hamid

When sending copies to readers without other recipients knowing place bc(blind copy) along with the name and any other information only on the copy not on the original.

Mailing Instructions

You may place a mailing notation (such as Special delivery or Registered Mail) at the bottom of the letter after reference initial or enclosures and before copy notation.

Postscript

A postscript is an afterthought to the letter, a message that requires emphasis or a personal note. It is usually the last thing on any letter and may be preceded by P.S., PS., PS:, or nothing at all. A second afterthought would be designated P.P.S (post postscript)

P.S. See page 68 of our catalog for a great value on our most-ordered product choice

4.5 Example of Business Letter's Part

Business letter formats have changed over the years. If you went to school prior to the 1970s, you probably learned one basic form of business letter now called the Modified Semi-Block. It was the bane of every beginning typist because of its strict rules concerning spacing. Luckily, the movement in business has been to simplify and provide choices. Now you have a choice of six different forms, some extremely simple, others more complex. The six forms of business letters most commonly used are:

• Block • Simplified • Modified Block • Hanging Indented • Modified Semi-Block • Memo
Block

The Block format is by far the simplest. Every part of the letter starts at the left margin, with spaces between each part. It has a professional look to it. The order for the parts of the letter are date, file number, inside address, attention line, salutation, subject line, body, complimentary close, signature, typed name and additional information.

Excellent Agency

23, Jonopath Road, Uttara, Dhaka-1203

(02)695-2864

November 20, 2015

/

/

/

WTA/Admin/2015-101

/

CONFIDENTIAL

/

Manager,

Finance and Accounts,

Lake View Company,

12, Gulshan, Dhaka

/

Attention: Customer Department

/

Dear Mr. Alam:

/

Subject:

/

XX

XXXXXXXXXXXXXX

XX

XXXXXXXXXXXXXX

/

Sincerely,

/

/

/

Habibur Rahman

President

/

Nt

/

Enclosure:

/

cc.

/

Special Delivery

/

PS:

4.6 Collection Letters

The types of collection letters included are:

- Notification
- Reminder
- Inquiry
- Urgency
- Final Notice/Ultimatum
- Thank You for Payment

4.6.1 Method of Writing Collection Letter

The purpose of the collection letter is to get the customer to pay an overdue bill.

Step 1: Check the spelling of the recipient's name. Use a gender-specific courtesy title only if you are certain of the recipient's gender. There is nothing more embarrassing or irritating than getting a collection letter, except getting one that is addressed improperly.

Step 2: The first part of the letter should state the concern and the situation (date purchased, amount owed and date due).

Step 3: The next part of the letter should indicate the deadline for paying the bill and any penalties that may result. You may also wish to indicate your company's policy concerning late payments, grace periods, penalties or alternative payment plans.

Step 4: The third part of the letter should indicate the consequences of not paying the bill. Initially, these may be penalties but, as the bill becomes more delinquent, it may include warnings of ruined credit ratings or involvement of a collection agency.

Step 5: The final part of the letter should encourage the recipient to send full payment or contact you to arrange a payment schedule. End with goodwill and a positive attitude that this situation will be resolved satisfactorily.

4.6.2 Notification: This letter is to notify the recipient that the bill is overdue.

July 5, 2017

Bokul Hasan
515, Lake View,
Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Thank you for shopping with us. You are a valued customer. We appreciate your business and know that you want to keep your account current with us¹.

On May 15, 2017, you purchased merchandise worth tk.3019.04 from our store in Laramie. Your payment of tk.1000 is now overdue².

In the credit agreement you signed, you agreed to pay off your bill in three payments. The first payment of tk.1000 was due June 15, 2017. Please send this amount now.³

Failure to pay on time may affect your ability to charge merchandise at our store. Thank you for your prompt attention.⁴

You may call me at 02-555-9875 if you have any questions or concerns.⁵ Your continued patronage is important to us.⁶

Sincerely,

Mukul Hossain
Credit Manager

¹*State the Concern*

²*State the Situation*

³*Indicate Deadline*

⁴*Indicate Consequences*

⁵*Indicate Contact*

⁶*Indicate Goodwill*

4.6.3 Reminder:

This letter reminds the reader that the bill is overdue and the payment still hasn't been received. Be careful to focus on observable behaviors and to avoid assumptions. Saying, "We have not received payment," is an observable behavior. Saying, "You have not sent payment," is an assumption. Stay positive.

Example:

August 5, 2017

Bokul Hasan
515, Lake View,
Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

We have not yet received your payments. This is to remind you that both your first and second payments of tk.1000 are now overdue. This tk.2000 plus the balance of tk.1019.04 is due on August 15.¹

In the credit agreement you signed, you agreed to pay off your bill in three payments. The first payment of tk1000 was due June 15, 2017, the second payment of tk.1000 was due July 15, 2017, and the final payment of tk.1019.04 is due August 15, 2017. Please send the full amount in 10 days.²

Failure to pay on time will affect your ability to charge merchandise at our store. If you want to discuss your account, call me at 02-555-9875. Perhaps we can arrange a more comfortable payment plan.³

Thank you for your immediate attention.⁴

Sincerely,

Mukul Hossain,
Credit Manager

¹*Remind Recipient of the Situation*

²*Request Payment and Indicate Deadline*

³*Indicate Consequences, Alternative and Contact*

⁴*Indicate Goodwill*

4.6.4 Inquiry

This letter inquires why the bill isn't being paid. It assumes that the bill is overdue. It's a good idea to follow this letter with a personal phone call inquiring about the payment delay. Often an alternative plan can be arranged to suit the recipient's current budget constraints. If another agreement is reached, send a copy of the new payment plan to the recipient. Continue to follow up letters with phone calls to maintain open communication. Keep a log of all calls.

Example

September 5, 2017

Bokul Hasan
515, Lake View,
Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Is there some reason you have not paid your bill of tk.3019.04? ¹In the credit agreement you signed, you agreed to pay off your bill in three payments. Your total bill is now overdue. Please send tk.3019.04 within 10 days.² If you have any questions or concerns regarding this bill, please contact me at 02-555-9875 by September 10³.

Failure to send the full amount by September 15 may mean that your bill is turned over to a collection agency. Your prompt attention is urgent to protect your credit⁴.

Sincerely,

Mukul Hossain
Credit Manager

¹*Inquire*

²*Indicate Deadline*

³*Indicate Contact*

⁴*Indicate Consequences*

4.6.5 Urgency

This letter stresses the urgency of the need for the customer to take some kind of action on the bill. It is a continuing progress report on the recipient's account. If an alternative payment plan has been reached previously, indicate the details of the agreement and the telephone contact dates to keep an accurate record of communications.

Example

November 5, 2017

Bokul Hasan
515, Lake View,
Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Your bill of tk.3019.04 is now overdue 60 days. Send tk.3019.04 within 10 days. If you cannot send the total, please call me at 02-555-9875.^{1&2}

Failure to respond may mean that your bill is turned over to a collection agency. Thank you for your prompt attention³.

Sincerely,

Mukul Hossain

Credit Manager

¹*State the Situation*

²*Indicate Grace Period*

(Indicate alternative, if agreed)

³*Indicate Probable Consequences*

4.6.6 Final Notice/Ultimatum

This letter is the final notice the customer receives. It gives the customer an ultimatum: If you do not respond, this will happen. After this letter, there are no more chances.

Example

December 1, 2017

Bokul Hasan

515, Lake View,

Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Your bill of tk.3019.04 is now 90 days overdue¹. The total amount is due now². If your payment in full is not received by December 10, your file will be turned over to a collection agency³.

Sincerely,

Mukul Hossain

Credit Manager

¹*State the Situation*

²*Indicate Deadline*

³*Indicate Consequences*

4.6.7 Thank You for Payment

A collection letter that is often neglected is the thank-you note. It can provide a reminder of both the account status and the customer's importance.

Example

April 19, 2017

Bokul Hasan
515, Lake View,
Uttara, Dhaka-1063

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Thank you for your payment of tk.5063.89¹. Your current balance is tk.3,0000 — your credit limit. A payment of tk.5000 is due May ².

We appreciate your attention to your account status with us. Your patronage is important to our company³. If we can assist you, please contact us at 02-555-9000⁴.

Sincerely,

Abdur Rahim

Account Executive

¹*Thank You*

²*Caution/Reminder*

³*Appreciation*

⁴*Contact Information*

4.7 Sales and Promotional Letters

4.7.1 Types of Sales Letter

Actually, all letters are sales letters in business. You are selling a service or product as well as your image as a business. These letters intend to initiate or close a sale. The broad categories follow:

- Request for Appointment
- Sales Letters to Clients
- Letter of Introduction

- Follow-Up on Letter Sent
- Delinquent Reply
- Sales Follow-Up
- Confirming Sales Order
- Announcing a Sales Campaign, Promotion or Incentive Program
- Announcing a Price Increase

4.7.2 Guidelines of Sales Letters

Sales and promotional letters are used by salespeople to set up or confirm appointments, announce sales promotions, congratulate salespeople on their successes and introduce new salespeople to their clients. The letter itself is a sales tool. These letters are often more creative in content and composition than other kinds of letters.

Step 1: The first part of the letter states your purpose. Depending on the reason for writing the letter, this may vary from requesting an appointment to introducing a new salesperson. Your purpose is to stimulate the reader's interest. Identify the benefit to your recipient.

Step 2: The second part of the letter gives details or background information. This is the persuasive part of the letter. If you are making a request, then this part would give the reason for the request. For example, in a request for an appointment, the second part would set up the time for the appointment, provide the telephone number where you can be reached and state the location of the appointment. If you are introducing a new salesperson, this part would give his background.

Step 3: The last part of the letter acts as a statement of desired action and as a summary reminding the recipient of the letter's general nature. In many sales and promotional letters, this is a thank you; in others, it is a restatement of what has been said previously. It may also be used to summarize the details of an appointment. Many sales letters include a handwritten postscript to emphasize urgency or a benefit.

4.7.3 Request for Appointment

Request for Appointment: This letter is used by the salesperson to set up appointments and to announce his schedule. Include an added service or an "extra effort" to encourage the recipient to see you later. It is an introductory letter and should be followed up with another letter or phone call.

Example

January 25, 2017

Lima Khan,
Manager,
AAA Cleaners
Uttara, Dhaka

Dear Ms. Khan:

I will be in Dhaka on February 3 and would like to meet with you at your office to discuss cleaning supplies you may need in the second half of the year¹.

I have enclosed our latest catalog. Please note the items in yellow highlight. They are special values or new products that AAA Cleaners will want to take advantage of now².

I will contact you later this week to schedule an appointment³. If you need to get in touch with me, call me at 02-555-9047. I look forward to talking with you. Thank you for your continued business.

Sincerely yours,

Jasim Uddin Khan
Sales Representative

P.S. See page 68 of our catalog for a great value on our most-ordered product choice!

¹*Request for Appointment*

²*Added Service Benefit*

³*Confirmation*

4.7.4 Sales Letter to Client:

A sales letter is used to introduce the contact and generate interest.

Example:

August 15, 2017

Shamim Akter,
Secretary,
The Super Institute
Uttara-3, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Shamim:

Just a note to introduce myself and to let you know of the La Bangla Hotel's interest in the 2017 meeting plans of the Super Institute¹.

The La Bangla Hotel contains 520 newly redecorated guest rooms; this includes 12 double room suites. The hotel is located in the heart of Dhak, only 30 minutes from airport. Our three four-star restaurants offer our guests variety in menu selection and atmosphere. Our 36,000 square feet of meeting and banquet space include the city's largest ballroom and the largest on-site exhibition hall². I have enclosed a complete schedule of our function space dimensions and capacities³.

Please stop by and see us if you are in our area — we would like the opportunity to show off our hotel⁴. In the meantime, however, I will call your office next week to answer any questions you may have on the Super's facilities and to discuss how we may be of service to the Super Institute⁵.

Sincerely,

Moniruzzaman Khan
Director,
Convention Services
Enc.

¹*Reason for Letter*

²*Details*

³*Enclosure*

⁴*States Follow-up Plans*

⁵*Contact Information*

4.7.5 Letter of Introduction

Letter of Introduction: This letter is used to introduce one person to another — such as a new salesperson to an established client. If you address the recipient by first name, you can do likewise with the person being introduced. If a courtesy title and a last name are more appropriate, be consistent with all the names that are mentioned in the salutation, body and closing signature.

Example:

November 22, 2017

Shafiqul Islam
Excellent Lobster Ltd.
Gulshan-1, Dhaka.

Dear Islam:

I am happy to introduce our new sales representative, Tareq Khan, to you¹. Tareq will be in charge of servicing your account².

Tareq is a graduate of the University of Dhaka and holds a degree in Sales and Marketing. For the last five years he has worked as a salesman for Hossain Fisheries and Equipment³. We are proud to have him on our staff and are sure he will be able to give you the kind of service you have come to expect from Sea Lanes⁴.

Please call us if there is anything we can do for you⁵. Tareq will be contacting you within the next two weeks to personally introduce himself, discuss his monthly schedule and answer any questions you might have⁶. Ask Tareq about his family's secret recipe for lobster!

Sincerely yours,

Milton Das,
Director of Sales

¹*Introduction*

²*Reason*

³*Background Information*

⁴*Support*

⁵*Request*

⁶*Contact Information*

4.7.6 Follow-Up on Letter Sent

Follow-Up on Letter Sent: This letter asks the customer if he has received a letter.

Example:

December 1, 2017

Shahinur Rahman
45, Baridhara,

Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Rahman:

On November 10, I sent you a letter describing our newest product. Did you receive the letter?¹

I will be happy to answer any questions you may have and explain the unique features of Vu-More and its benefits to you².

You are a valued customer. If there is any way that I can help you in making a decision, please call me at 02-555-1109³.

Sincerely,

Kaium Hossain
Sales Director

¹*Reference*

²*Purpose*

³*Contact Information*

4.7.7 Delinquent Reply:

Delinquent Reply: This letter is used to remind a customer who has not responded to a recent letter.

Example:

October 2, 2017

Rafiqul Islam,
Sea Gardens,
Uttara-7,
Dhaka-1203.

Dear Mr. Islam:

Just a reminder: I recently sent you a computer printout of a proposal of health insurance for your employees¹.

I have attached another printout for your convenience and hope that you will take the time to review it. As you can see, we offer a competitive package. Plans A and B are especially responsive to your needs².

I will call you next Friday after you have had time to review the proposal. I am eager to do business with you. In the meantime, if you have any questions or concerns, I can be reached at 02-555-1140³.

Sincerely,

Taslim Khan
Sales Manager

Enc.

¹*Reminder*

²*Review*

³*Contact Information*

4.7.8 Sales Follow-Up

Sales Follow-Up: This letter is used to follow up on a sale that has been made. It may be a thank you for the business, a clarification of the sale or a pitch for future sales.

Example :

February 15, 2017

Moin Khan
Director of Sales,
Super Optical,
46, Lake Drive Road,

Uttara-7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Khan:

Congratulations on your outstanding sales during our recent winter campaign. Super-Optical sold 25 percent of our total volume during this program¹. Please commend your sales staff for their impressive efforts. Because of your success, you now qualify for our quantity discount².

Thanks again for your efforts. We look forward to sharing future sales successes with Super-Optical³.

Sincerely,

Badrul Hossain
Sales Representative

¹*Statement of Sales*

²*Request*

³*Goodwill*

4.7.9 Confirming Sales Order

Confirming Sales Order: The following letter confirms sales taken over the telephone. They offer another opportunity to mention the qualities of the product and make contact with the customer.

Example:

June 18, 2017

Hafizur Rahman
Sun Trading Company,
45, Lake Drive Road
Sector 7, Uttara,

Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Rahman:

Thank you for your order of 200 Treasure Trunks from Mom's Magic. I believe you will be very satisfied with the quality of costume pieces included in each. It is this quality which makes my imaginative play apparel so unique¹.

As we discussed, I will be shipping 120 storybook trunks and 75 professional trunks to be received no later than August 1. I will be contacting you the week of October 1 to determine if additional trunks are needed². If you need to place an order before then, please call me at 02-555-6215³.

Thank you again.

Sincerely,

Joynul Abedin

¹*Benefit*

²*Confirmation*

³*Contact Information*

4.7.10 Announcing a Sales Campaign, Promotion or Incentive Program

This type of letter informs clients of upcoming sales promotions, incentive programs or special sales packages that are available. It is followed by a personal call from the salesperson.

Example:

September 15, 2017

Manirul Islam

Director of Sales,

Omni-Optical Co.

41, Gulshan Avenue, Gulshan-1,

Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Islam:

Sun Trading will start its winter sales campaign on November 1¹. In the past, this campaign has enabled Omni-Optical to offer its customers a wide selection of products at very competitive prices². It is an outstanding way to attract new customers and build traffic for your business³. I have enclosed a sheet explaining all of the particulars along with our latest catalog⁴.

I will call you within the next 10 days to answer any questions you have about the program and take your order⁵. All orders have to be in by October 15. As always, it is a pleasure working with Omni-Optical⁶.

Sincerely yours,

Sk. Abdul Aziz

Sales Representative

¹*Announcement*

²*Explanation*

³*Benefits*

⁴*Added Service*

⁵*Deadline*

⁶*Thank You*

4.7.11 Announcing a Price Increase

Announcing a Price Increase: Announce a price increase and soften the blow to the customer

Example :

February 22, 2017

Maruful Hoque,

Hoque Card Distributors, Ltd.

House-11, Road-12, Sector-10

Uttara, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Hoque:

Your satisfaction is important to us. In order to continue to produce a high-quality product, we have recently installed new high-speed, high-definition printing presses¹. This, along with the increased price of paper, has forced us to increase our prices by 10 percent effective March 15². I have enclosed a brochure with the new prices in it for your benefit. Orders received before March 15 will be filled at current prices³.

Thank you for your understanding in this matter⁴. We feel that these increases will still allow you to sell these superb cards at competitive prices. We hope you will let us know immediately if there is any way we can serve you better⁵.

Sincerely,

Assaduzzaman Mollah

President

¹*Goal of Customer Satisfaction*

²*Announcement*

³*Incentive*

⁴*Thank You*

⁵*Goodwill*

4.8 Customer Relations Letters

Letters that improve or maintain good customer relations sell a company's image. The broad categories are as follows:

- General Appreciation
- Acknowledging a Complaint
- Acknowledging an Order — Explaining Shipment Procedures
- Holiday Greetings
- Notification of Complaints

At the side of the page, you will find a brief explanation of each part of the letter. The first letter identifies each section of the letter. Subsequent letters identify only changes to the basic format.

4.8.1 Guidelines of Customer relations Letters

These letters are designed to improve or maintain customer relations. The maxim that the customer is always right should be kept in mind while writing these letters. At times, however, you may have to let the customer think he is right while you are proving him wrong!

Step 1: The first part of the letter states your purpose. This may be anything from acknowledging a complaint to notifying a customer of a move.

Step 2: The second part of the letter explains the purpose. If the first part acknowledges a complaint, then the second part explains what you are going to do about it. If the first part announces a new address to valued customers, then the second part gives the details about the new location's conveniences.

Step 3: The last part is the sugar to leave a good taste in the customer's mouth. It summarizes the letter, thanks the customer and reiterates the customer's value to your organization.

4.8.2 General Appreciation

This letter is used to show appreciation for your customers. It may be used as sales and promotional letter or a thank you for continued patronage.

January 12, 2017

Lokman Hossain

5, S.R Tower, Sector -7,

Uttara, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Hossain:

On behalf of Padma Prints, we wish to express our sincerest appreciation for your continued patronage¹. It is because of valued customers like you that we are able to continue to offer you the finest in fabrics².

Padma Prints has been in business for 25 years. We are dedicated to bringing you the finest in fabrics, particularly those of all-natural materials. Mr. Adnan Ahmed, our founding father, loved to say, “The customer wants the best at the lowest price,” and that is the motto we use as our guiding principle³.

Please stop in and see us soon. Our new spring fabrics will be in the showroom on March 15⁴. If you bring this letter with you, we will give you a 15 percent discount on any fabric you purchase in March⁵.

Sincerely yours,

Shafiq Ahmed,

President

¹*Statement of Purpose*

²*Compliment*

³*Elaboration*

⁴*Summary*

⁵*Benefit*

4.8.3 Acknowledging a Complaint

This letter is used to acknowledge a complaint and offer a solution to the problem.

September 2, 2017

Mahmudul Hasan

House-46, Road-18

Uttara -7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Hasan:

Thank you for your letter of August 30 discussing our policy concerning payment for missed classes¹.

I have checked with our owner, Ms. Tariq Ahmed, for a clarification. In the past, our policy was that missed classes would still need to be paid for. Under the circumstances, however, she said that you will not have to pay for the classes your daughter missed because of her unfortunate accident on the way to class².

We hope this is a satisfactory solution for you and wish your daughter, Sara, a speedy recovery. We shall put a hold on your account until she is ready to return to her tap lessons³. Thank you once again for your concern.

Sincerely yours,

Md. Farhad,
Business Manager

¹*Acknowledgment of Complaint*

²*Solution*

³*Summary*

4.8.4 Acknowledging an Order —Explaining Shipment Procedures

Explain a shipping procedure to a customer while acknowledging that an order has been received.

August 13, 2017

Nadim Iqbal
K. Crafts
8, Lake Drive Road,
Uttara 7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Iqbal:

Thank you for your order of 25 authentic Cherokee headdresses on August 11, 2017. We will be sending those immediately¹.

Because of the fragile nature of our headdresses, we hand deliver to our customers within Dhaka². Our delivery day for Uttara is Friday, which means that your headdresses will arrive this coming Friday, August 17. If this is unsatisfactory, please call us so that we can arrange an alternative delivery date³.

Thank you for your business. I'm sure you will be most pleased with our headdresses, and we look forward to working with you in the future⁴.

Sincerely yours,

Tamim Hasan

¹*Acknowledgment of Order*

²*Explanation*

³*Action Plan*

⁴*Thank You*

4.8.5 Holiday Greetings

This letter is used to send holiday greetings to your customers. It is preferable to use personal stationery or a note card especially designed for the situation.

December 5, 2017

Mr. Arman Barun

Gentle Park,

11, Progoti Saroni,

Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Borun:

Sun Trading Co. would like to wish you and your employees the very best this holiday season. We hope that your establishment has been blessed with exceptional customers, as we have¹.

We are most fortunate to have customers like Gentle Park and hope that, during this coming New Year, we can continue our relationship. We know our prosperity depends on our customers².

Thank you for helping make Sum Trading Co. one of the leaders in Dhaka. Our fondest regards for all of you at Gentle Park³.

Happy Holidays,

Raisul Islam

President

¹*Greetings*

²*Elaboration (optional)*

³*Thank You*

4.8.6 Notification of Complaints

This letter asks for a solution to a complaint of faulty merchandise but ends on a business-as-usual note to maintain the professional contact.

April 18, 2017

East Delta Company,

47, Gulshan Avenue,

Gulshan-1, Dhaka.

Subject: Request for Credit in Account

Dear Sir:

The case of happy Holiday that I purchased from your company does not hop¹. I am, therefore, returning them to you and requesting that you credit my account for the amount charged plus shipping².

The happy Holiday that arrived at my store had faulty mechanisms which caused them to fall over instead of hop — as promised in your sales brochure. Because I plan on selling off my line of seasonal items within the next three weeks, I wish my account to be issued a credit instead of you replacing the faulty merchandise³. Please find enclosed the copies of your invoice, #112, in the amount of tk. 2350 and my invoice for shipping charges of tk.560⁴.

Your quality products have always sold well in my store, and I look forward to seeing your new line of fall items as soon as they are available⁵. In the meantime, your prompt attention to this matter is appreciated.

Moinuddin Ahmed

¹*Reason*

²*Request (specific)*

³*Details*

⁴*Enclosure*

⁵*Agreement*

Chapter 5: Internal Communications

5.1 Internal Communication Tools

We use some special correspondences for communication within the organization. These correspondences are memorandum or memo, office order, office circulars, office note.

5.2 Memorandums

Memo is a written message sent to someone working in the same organization. It is a short writing used by members of an organization for communication among themselves. Routine information is communicated through this inter office letter.

Parts of a Memo

Heading: Heading includes the company name with or without the word ‘memorandum’ either above or below the company name.

To line: To line is Inside address of the memo.

From Line: It is name of the person who is writing the memo.

Date line: The date of the issuing the memo.

Subject line: The subject line tells the reader what the topic is about. 'Re' (in reference to) may also be used in place of 'Subject'.

Body:

Signature: It is the signature of the issuer.

Example

University of Information Technology and Sciences (UITS)

Office Memo

To : All faculty Members

From : Registrar

Date : 23 May, 2017

Subject: Permission for Higher Studies

It is notified that faculty members pursuing higher studies in different educational institutions of Bangladesh are advised to obtain permission of the UITS authority through their respective Head of the department.

.....

Registrar

UITS

Copy to:

1. PS to the Chairman, Trustee Board
2. PS to VC
3. PA to Pro-VC

5.3 Office Orders

An office order is a message from higher to the subordinates with a tone of command. It is usually concerned with posting, transferring, promoting, demoting, suspending, and terminating, of an employee.

Delta Bank Limited

Khulna Branch, Khulna

Phone No.: 04-111111 Fax: 04-2222 E-mail: abc@gmail.com

Ref : DBL/ADMIN/2017/

Date : 12.5.17

Training Office Order / Release Order from Branch Office to Head Office
--

OFFICE ORDER

In terms of our Head Office Order No.DBL/HO/HRD/2017/126 dated 02.05.2017, **Mr. Rajib Hasan**, Executive Officer of our Branch is hereby released from the branch as at the close of business hour today the 12th May 2012 to attend in a “**Fundamental Training Course**” to be held at DBL Training Institute, Uttara, Dhaka from 16.05.2017 to 18.07.2017, every day at 10.00 a.m. He is advised to resume his duties at Khulna Branch immediately after completion of the training.

Altaf Hossain

AGM, Manager

C.C to :

01. The Vice President, Human Resources Division, DBL, Head Office, Dhaka.
02. The Vice President, Financial Administration Division, DBL, Head Office, Dhaka.
03. The AVP & Principal, DBL Training Institute, Uttara, Dhaka.
04. Personal file copy.
05. Office Copy.

5.4 Office Circulars

An office circular refers to the announcement of same message to a large number of employees. The information is not confidential; rather it is general in nature. It is generally put on the notice board.

University of Information Technology and Sciences (UITS)

Circular for No smoking

It is said at one side of the cigarette there is fire and on the other side there is fool's mouth. Our company doesn't intend to have any kind of fools in the organization. We as a responsible organization prohibit smoking in the office premises. Our company has a no smoking policy. All the employees' should take a note of the same. It is the moral duty of everyone at a common place to take care of the health and safety of the other people in an organization. All the employees are required to comply with the no smoking policy.

Whether it is the common areas like lifts, corridors, stairways, rest rooms, meeting rooms or the toilets, no one is allowed to smoke at any place. All the work areas and rest areas come in no smoking zones. The no smoking policy is formed to guarantee all employees the right to work in air free of tobacco smoke.

.....

Registrar

UITS

5.5 Office Notes

An office note is initiated by an officer for getting instruction or approval by the higher authority. It moves vertically as well as horizontally within the organization.

Example

Note

Printing of BBA Flyer

The flyer of BBA program contains the brief information about the courses, tuition fee, facilities etc. which is used for advertisement and information. The department of Business Administration wants to print the flyer due to shortage of existing printed flyer.

So, it is placed for your kind approval for printing the flyer.

Md. Khaled Hasan

Administrative Officer

Chapter 6: Social Communications

6.1 Goodwill Letters

This section has sample letters to help you write goodwill letters. The broad categories are Professional Recognition and Company Position. These letters identify special events, achievements and issues. Professional Recognition includes:

- Recognizing a Suggestion
- Appreciation
- Official Anniversary
- Speech
- Invitations
- Congratulations
- Thanks for Good Work: Outside Vendor
- Acknowledging an Accomplishment
- Follow-Up After a Sale Company

- Explaining Policy and Position
- Encouragement
- Announcing New Fringe Benefits
- Adjustment

6.1.1 Guidelines for development of Good will letters

These letters are designed to promote goodwill among clients and employees.

Step 1: The first part of the letter states your purpose. Depending on the reason for writing the letter, this may vary from complimenting an employee on an accomplishment to apologizing for being unable to attend a social event.

Step 2: The second part of the letter gives the details or background information for the first part. This may be anything from explaining to a client the action required to correct a problem to giving details about a social event.

Step 3: The last part of the letter acts as a summary, reminding the recipient of the general nature of the letter. It may be a thank you, or it may restate what has been said in the first part of the letter. For example, if the letter is congratulatory, the last part re-congratulates the recipient.

6.1.2 Appreciation

This letter expresses appreciation for something that was done. Quite often these letters are to employees of a company. Thank-you notes are meaningful rewards. The written word has power.

April 13, 2017

Abul Kalam

2, Gulshan

Dhaka

Dear Mr. Kalam:

On behalf of the staff at Seven Sisters, I want to express my appreciation for your help in our recent ad campaign. Your tireless efforts made the campaign one of the most successful we have ever had. Seven Sisters' success relies heavily on the commitment of its

employees. Devotion such as yours allows us to be leaders in the field of fashion merchandising in the Uttara area. Your efforts contribute to higher sales, and that, as you know, means increased profit-sharing for our employees. Thank you for all of your hard work. Seven Sisters is successful because of employees like you.

Sincerely,

Lovely Akter

President

6.1.3 Official Anniversary

This letter recognizes an official anniversary, such as the ordination of a priest or minister, an elected official taking office or an employee's work anniversary. It elevates morale.

April 8, 2017

Mr. Emdadul Hoque

46, 7 no. Sector, Uttara

Dhaka.

Dear Hoque:

All of us at Wood Hollow Cranberries wish to extend our sincerest congratulations on your 10th anniversary here at Wood Hollow. Your work, first as assistant plant manager and now as plant manager, has been exemplary. We are most pleased to have you on our management team and look forward to many more years of working with you.

Sincerely yours,

Golam Kibria

President

6.1.4 Invitation — Formal

This letter's formal language reflects the formality of the event. It requires a formal reply.

October 1, 2016

Md. Shariful Islam
45, Lake Drive Road
Uttara-7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Islam:

You are cordially invited to a formal dinner in honor of Samsul Hoque on October 21, 2017, at 8 p.m. at the Radison Blue. Mr. Hoque, as you are an associate of Mr. Habibur, we would like you to speak briefly about his work in the lumber industry. If this is possible, please let me know within the next week. Please note that this is a black-tie event. RSVP with the names of those attending by October 14.

Sincerely yours,

Jany Alam
Chairman, Social Committee

6.1.5 Congratulations

This is a goodwill letter on the part of the company or the salesperson to a client. It congratulates an internal client on an accomplishment.

May 7, 2017

Jahangir Alam,
District Manager
45, Khulshi, Chittagong.

Dear Mr. Alam:

Congratulations on being the top district manager for March and April. You can be proud of your hard work, and we're glad you work with us. Capital Life honors its high achievers with our Call to Excellence Award. Your achievement in sales will be recognized at the June Convention in Chittagong. We would like you and your agents to be our guests at a special banquet on June 5, 2017, at 7:30 p.m. in the Blue Room of the Hotel International, during which you will receive the award. Once again, congratulations! It is because of managers like you that Capital Life has achieved the success it enjoys.

Sincerely yours,

Jasim Halder,

Vice President

6.1.6 Follow-up after a Sale

This letter is a follow-up to an event. It maintains positive contact and encourages repeat business from the client.

October 31, 2017

Masum Billah,

Moon Trading Group,

110, Mascot Plaza,

Uttara, Dhaka.

Dear Billah:

It was such a pleasure to have a group like yours as our guest! Not only did we enjoy having The Moon Trading Group in our hotel, but also getting to work with you was an added benefit! You are so professional and organized that you make us look good. If there's anything I can ever do to help you, give me a call. Please stay in touch; the next time you're in Chittagong, we'll take some time and see the city!

Sincerely,

Faisal Faruquee

Director, Convention Services

6.2 Community Activities Letters

This section has sample letters dealing with community activities. The broad categories are as follows:

- Solicitation of Funds
- Acknowledgment and Request for Funds
- Appreciation and Fund-Raising Event

- Acknowledgment of Contribution
- Acknowledgment of Accomplishment
- Thank You
- Grant Request
- Invitation to Serve
- Membership Invitation
- Refusal of a Request
- Expression of Appreciation
- Appointment to Office
- Appointment to a Committee
- Compliment
- Invitation to Speak
- Complimenting a Speaker
- Letter to Legislator Showing Support
- Letter to Legislator Showing Concern

6.2.1 Guidelines

These letters address community activities that involve both individuals and corporations.

Step 1: The first part of the letter states your purpose. It may vary from asking a company to take part in a charity fund-raising drive to expressing appreciation for an employee's involvement in the community.

Step 2: The second part of the letter gives the details or background information for the first part. This may include giving a reason for declining a public office to indicating your company's policy about an employee's achievement.

Step 3: The last part of the letter acts as a summary, reminding the recipient of the general nature of the letter. It may include deadlines, a thank you, or a re-request.

6.2.2 Solicitation of Funds: This letter requests that a company contribute to a charity.

April 9, 2016

Mr. Maruful Hoque,
President,
Sun Trading Co.,
348 , Sonapath Jonopath Road,
Uttara, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Hoque:

The United Benefit for Community Improvement is starting its annual drive this Monday. We hope you will contribute to this worthy cause. In the past, Sun Trading Co. has been one of the leaders in the UBCI drive, with its employees giving an average of 2.5 percent of their income to the fund. Naturally, they recognize that the fund improves their lives as well as the lives of others in the area. May we count on your corporate support again? This year we are asking each corporation to match its employees'. Your contributions provide recreation scholarships to summer and after- contributions school programs for youth, home maintenance assistance for the elderly, AIDS education, a community pantry and kitchen, and other programs for community improvement. Please continue your leadership in community development through your support of UBCI. We are asking that all contributions, employee and corporate, be in the UBCI office, 5, Gulshan-1, by May 15. Thank you for your continued support.

Sincerely yours,

Sirajul Islam
Campaign Chairperson

6.2.3 Acknowledgment of Contribution: This letter acknowledges that a company has contributed to a charity.

April 25, 2017

Mr. Maruful Hoque,
President,
Sun Trading Co.,
348 , Sonapath Jonopath Road,
Uttara, Dhaka

Dear Mr. Hoque:

The United Benefit for Community Improvement would like to thank you and your employees for your generous contribution to this year's fund drive. Your contribution of tk.99751 is the largest corporate/employee contribution so far. Md. Farhad Hasan your

UBCI chairperson will let the employees of Sanders and Thoms know of their accomplishment. This year they gave an average of 2.75 percent of their income to the fund. Their contribution and yours will definitely help us meet our goal of \$2 million. All of you at Sun Trading Co. are to be commended for your generosity. Thank you again for your contribution.

Sincerely yours,

Sirajul Islam
Campaign Chairperson

6.2.4 Grant Request: Although most grant requests require a specific application form, you still need to send a cover letter with the form. This letter is a sample cover letter.

October 14, 2017

Abul Hasem
Director of Grants
Chittagong Area Grant Office
45 South Khulshi
Chittagong.

Dear Mr. Hasem:

We would like to request a tk.150000 grant for Chittagong Community College to improve access for the handicapped. I have enclosed our grant application. The majority of the buildings on the Chittagong Community College campus were built prior to 1953. Those built after 1945 are accessible to the handicapped. Unfortunately, Atkinson Auditorium, where we hold graduation, monthly convocations and other major events, was built in 1932 and is not accessible to the handicapped. The tk.15,0000 grant would allow us to install ramps at each entrance and remove a row of seats for wheelchairs, making the entire campus accessible to the handicapped. Thank you for your prompt action on this grant. We shall look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely yours,

Md. Emdadul Hoque
Director of Physical Facilities

6.2.5 Membership Invitation

Membership drives are common in volunteer organizations. Here is how you can hook your reader and catch a member.

September 14, 2016

Md.Masud Hasan
42, Lake Drive Road
Uttara-7, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Hasan:

As a new resident of Uttara, wouldn't you like to get to know the city and its people better? Then consider the service and networking opportunities Community Valor could provide you. We meet monthly to plan service projects that improve life in Uttara. You have already seen our trademark red vests on the job at the blood bank where you so generously gave of yourself last Friday. We are always looking for enthusiastic and empathetic people to participate in our organization. We think you meet the qualifications!

Some of our projects this past year have included establishing a food and toiletry pantry for people with AIDS, tutoring for people whose second or third language is English, and emergency aid to people suffering from disaster, disease or distress. Each project is funded by membership dues of tk. 1000 per year and special contributions from area businesses. Our annual membership drive began this week and runs through the end of September. We invite you to become part of the largest volunteer service organization in the state. May we

call upon you to ask any questions you may have about Community Valor and to encourage you to join our efforts? Please send the enclosed postcard to us now. We promise to serve your interests and find outlets for your talents in Community Valor.

Sincerely,

Abdul Halim

Membership Drive Co-chair

6.3 Personal Business Letters

There are times when you write on behalf of yourself rather than for the entire company. This chapter includes samples to help you write personal business letters. The broad categories are as follows:

- Congratulations
- Birthday Wishes
- Holiday Greetings
- Birth of a Child
- Marriage
- Illness — Hospital
- Thank You
- Apology
- Inquiry
- Request
- Refusal

6.3.1 Step-by-Step Guide

These letters are similar to goodwill letters. They are letters in which you promote goodwill toward your employees, their relatives and business associates.

Step 1: The first part of the letter states your purpose. Depending on the reason for writing the letter, this may vary from congratulating a business associate or employee to extending a holiday greeting.

Step 2: The second part of the letter gives the details or background information for the first part. This may include details about an employee's accomplishments or personal comments concerning the first part.

Step 3: The last part of the letter acts as a summary, reminding the recipient of the general nature of the letter. It may include deadlines, a thank-you note or a re-request. It is not necessary in many of the personal business letters to have a third part.

6.3.2 Congratulations

Congratulate an employee, relative of an employee or business associate on an accomplishment.

August 13, 2017

Dear Tamim:

Congratulations on your win in the Junior Division at the Dhaka. To be able to win at such a young age is quite an accomplishment. I understand that not only did you win the Junior Division hands-down, but you also came within points of the Senior Division winner. Congratulations once again!

Sincerely,

Kamrul Islam

President, Sun Moon Company

11, Lake Drive Road, Uttara-7, Dhaka.

6.3.3 Birthday Wishes

This brief letter wishes someone (employee, relative of an employee, friend of the company, business associate) a happy birthday.

May 25, 2017

Golam Kibria,
44, South Khulshi
Chittagong

Dear Kibria:

It's your birthday again! Where has the time gone? We hope your birthday is a happy one. We appreciate your work here at Ad Frame and hope that we enjoy many more birthdays together.

Sincerely,

Hafizullah Amin,
President, Ad Frame

6.3.4 Holiday Greetings

This short letter wishes an employee or business associate holiday greetings. This is particularly useful for those employees or business associates whose religion is not covered by the standard business greeting cards.

December 15, 2017

Jahidul Islam
38, Mirpur -11,
Dhaka.

Dear Islam:

This is warmest of holiday greeting to you and your family. We at Super Gems hope this holiday season brings you the best of everything. Regard to all of you.

Sincerely,

Tipu

Super Gems

6.3.5 Apology

This is a formal apology. Such letters usually deal with social events.

December 1, 2017

Dear Mr. Latif:

Please accept my apologies for missing your Thanks giving brunch on November 23. I hope my last-minute change of plans did not inconvenience you too much. As you know, I had planned on attending and was looking forward to it. However, my brother who lives in Dhaka had emergency bypass surgery, and his wife asked me to be with her. Had that not happened, naturally I would have been with you. Once again, I ask for your understanding in this matter and hope that my frantic, last-minute call to bow out was acceptable.

Sincerely,

Tamim Iqbal

6.3.6 Inquiry

This letter asks for information to be used by the company.

February 14, 2017

Md. Selim Morshed

34 , West Khulshi,

Chittagong

Dear Mr. Moshed:

We are trying to locate information on a breed of cat called the Suomi shorthair and understand that you are the leading expert on cats in Bangladesh. We have a client who is interested in buying a Suomi shorthair. She had seen one once at Dhaka Show but has been unable to locate one since. She came to our shop and requested that we help her. Since the breed originated in Bangladesh, we thought you might be able to give us some more information. We are most interested in the names of breeders that may have kittens for sale. We will call you within the next month to follow up on this inquiry. Thank you for all your trouble. We look forward to talking to you.

Sincerely,

Arif Hasan

Star “Cat” Pence

6.4 Letters of Condolence

Here are samples to help you write the most difficult of all letters to compose: condolence letters. The broad categories are as follows:

- On the Death of a Business Associate
- On the Death of a Mother
- On the Death of a Father
- On the Death of a Wife
- On the Death of a Husband
- On the Death of a Child
- On the Death of a Brother
- On the Death of a Sister

6.4.1 Step-by-Step Guide

Although sympathy cards are available, a letter of condolence is more personal. Letters of condolence should be written with a sincere tone. If at all possible, reflect on the person who has died.

Step 1: The first part of the letter offers your condolences.

Step 2: The second part of the letter, if possible, should reflect on the person who has died. If you knew the person well, personal recollections are appropriate. If you did not know the person well or at all, this part is optional; although, if you can relate this person’s life to your own in some way, you should include this part.

Step 3: The last part of the letter offers further condolences or support.

Remember: Condolence letters should always be handwritten. It is in very poor taste to type a letter of condolence.

6.4.2 Death of a Business Associate

October 6, 2017

Md. Loman Hossain,

Moon Light Co.

Dear Lokman:

I was shocked to hear of the death of your partner, Mr. Asif Ahmed. Although I knew he was ill, I was still taken by surprise by his sudden passing. Asif and I worked together at the Star Cramer's Store in Dhaka when we first arrived here in 1999. I will never forget his immense capacity for helping other people. I share your sorrow at this time. If there is any way that I can help, please let me know. Rest assured that your loss is all of Moon Light's loss.

Sincerely,

Abdur Rakib

6.4.3 On the Death of a Mother

December 11, 2017

Dear Mahin:

Please let me extend my deepest sympathy on behalf of all the staff here at Sun Trading ltd. on the passing of your mother. I know that you spoke many times of how difficult your mother's battle with cancer was. Though we are saddened by her death, I'm sure that we share your relief that she is now at peace. She was a brave woman. Please accept our sympathy. We have taken up a collection for a memorial contribution and have sent it to the Bangladesh Cancer Society in your mother's name.

Sincerely,

Glom Kibria

Vice President, Sales

6.5 Media Letters

Here are samples to help you write letters to the media (newspapers, television stations, magazines). The broad categories are as follows:

- Media Event Letter — Sales Campaign Kickoff

- Media Event Letter — Recently Published Book
- Media Event Letter — Anniversary
- Press Release — Anniversary
- Press Release — Speaking Engagement
- Press Release — Promotion
- Press Release — New Employee
- Response to Editorial — Positive
- Response to Editorial — Negative
- Letter Asking to Make a Speech
- Letter Asking for a Correction

6.5.1 Step-by-Step Guide

Media letters are used in business as a way to get the public's attention. Media exposure is free advertising, and the smart business person uses it to sell her business and its services or products. The letter in and of itself is a sales tool.

Step 1: The first part of the letter or press release states your purpose. This may be anything from announcing a new employee to responding to an editorial.

Step 2: The second part of the letter or press release explains the first part by giving details and examples about the first part. This part should include all pertinent information concerning the event or situation. If, for example, you are announcing a new employee, you would give the details about the employee in the second part. Always answer who, what, when, where, why and, if appropriate, how, in this section.

Step 3: The last part of the letter acts as a summary, reminding the recipient of the general nature of the letter. It may also be used as a thank you.

6.5.2 Media Event Letter — Anniversary

Use this letter to alert the media of your company's anniversary.

May 19, 2017

Md. Atiq Majumder,
The Daily News Letter
444, Palton, Dhaka-1000.

Dear Mr. Majumder:

Navana will be turning 50 years old on May 29, making us the oldest car dealership in Bangladesh. We will be staging a three-day celebration. On May 29, we will kick off our

anniversary with free hot air balloon rides and ascension at 6 p.m. On May 30, we will have the oldest race car driver, Jamal Ahmed, signing autographs from 2 to 4 p.m. On May 31, there is a picnic open to the public. During all three days, there will be displays of antique autos and carnival rides for the children. We think that our anniversary event would make a fine spot on your “Nationals” segment on the 6 o’clock news.

I have enclosed a flyer describing the complete festivities. Thank you for helping us celebrates our anniversary.

Sincerely,

Mia Azimul Hoque

President

6.5.3 Press Release — Anniversary

Use this press release to alert the media of a company’s anniversary.

January 19, 2017

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

On February 5, 2017, Fulkoli Cookies will celebrate its 50th anniversary, making us the oldest bakery in Bangladesh. Fulkoli Cookies was established on February 5, 1952, by Mr. Azam Khan. At first, Fulkoli employed only three people and was located on Front Street in Chittagong. After the independent war, Fulkoli moved to its present location on Dhaka and now employs 25 people full-time. Fulkoli’s specialties are cinnamon rolls, chocolate chip cookies and its patented double chocolate fudge bar. Fulkoli will host an open house on February 5 at its plant. We are expecting children from several local schools, residents from several nursing homes and group houses, as well as our regular patrons. Please stop by for free refreshments.

FOR MORE INFORMATION, CONTACT:

Rakib Khan,

President

02-5554441

6.5.4 Press Release — Promotion

Use this press release to notify the media of a promotion within your business.

August 30, 2017

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Sun Trading Co. announces the promotion of Mr. Haibur Rahman to Vice President, Accounting. He will replace Mr. Badiul Alam, who is retiring. Mr. Habibur Rahman joined Sun Trading Co. in March 1997 as an accountant and was promoted in 1997 to Department Head, Accounts Receivable. In 2015, he was promoted to Division Head, Customer Relations. He is a graduate of Dhaka University and is a Certified Public Accountant.

FOR MORE INFORMATION, CONTACT:

Palash Sarkar,
Human Resources Office
Sun Trading Co.

6.5.5 Press Release — New Employee

Use this press release to announce to the media that a new employee will be joining your firm.

October 17, 2017

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Sun Trading Co. announces that Mr. Abdul Bayes has been hired as our director of sales. He will start in her new position on November 1. Mr. Abdul Bayes is a native of Chittagong and was previously employed by Moontex in Dhaka as sales coordinator. He has a degree in interior design from the Design Institute in Dhaka. Mr. Bayes's design for *Home Lovely's* "Home Beautification Project" won first place last year in the prestigious competition.

FOR MORE INFORMATION, CONTACT:

Mr. Abdul Hamid

A black-and-white photo is enclosed.

Chapter 7: Team Communication and Meeting

7.1 Team Communication

A team is unit of two or more people who share a mission and the responsibility for working to achieve a common goal. Committee is a formal team that usually has a long life span and can become a permanent part of the organizational structure.

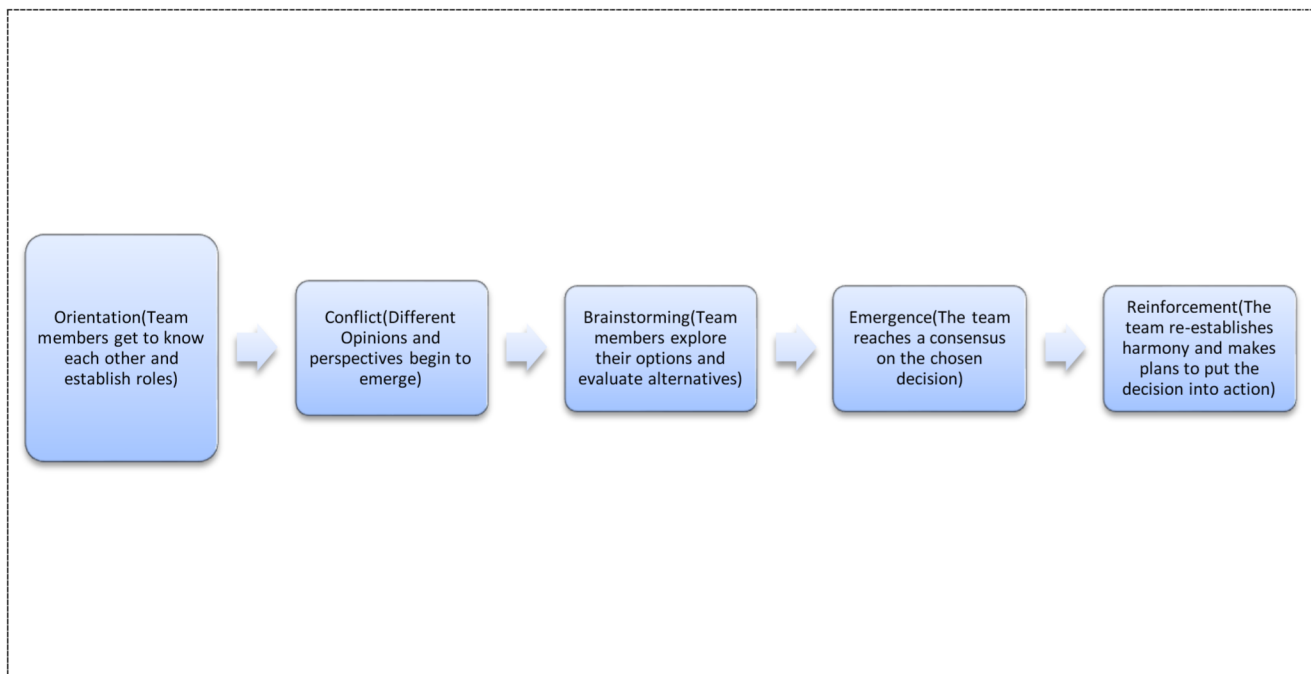
7.1.1 Team Roles

Members of a team can play various roles which fall into three categories:

Members who assume **self-oriented roles** are motivated mainly to fulfill personal needs, so they tend to be less productive than other members. Members who assume **Team maintenance roles** to help everyone work well together and those who assume **Task oriented roles** to help the team reach its goals.

7.1.2 Team Evolution

Teams typically evolve through a number of phases on their way to becoming productive.



Orientation: Team member socialize, establish their roles, and begin to define their task or purpose.

Conflict: Team members begin to discuss their positions and become more assertive in establishing their roles. Disagreements and uncertainties are natural in this phase.

Brainstorming: Team members air all the options and fully discuss the pros and cons. At the end of this phase, members begin to settle on a single solution to the problem.

Emergence: Consensus is reached when the team finds a solution that all members are willing to support.

Reinforcement: The team clarifies and summarizes the agreed –upon solution. Members receive their assignments for carrying out the group’s decision and they make arrangements for following up on those assignments.

7.1.3 Resolving Conflict

Conflict in team activities can arise for a number of reasons: competition for resources, disagreement over goal or responsibilities, poor communication, power struggle, or fundamental differences values, attitude and personalities.

The following seven measures can help team members successfully resolve conflict:

- Proactive behavior: deal with minor conflict before it becomes major conflict.
- Communication: get those directly involved in a conflict to participate in resolving it.
- Openness: Get feelings out in the open before dealing with the main issues.
- Research: Seek factual reasons for a problem before seeking solutions
- Flexibility: Do not let anyone lock into a position before considering other solutions
- Fair play: Insist on fair outcomes and donot let anyone avoid a fair solution by hiding behind the rules
- Alliance: Get opponents to fight together against an outside force instead of against each other

7.1.4 Overcoming Resistance

One particular type of conflict that can affect team progress is resistance to change. Sometimes this resistance is clearly irrational, such as when people resist any kind of change, whether it makes sense or not. Sometimes résistance is perfectly logical. If someone is resisting change, you can be persuasive with calm, reasonable communication.

- Express understanding: Help the other person relax and talk about his or her anxiety so that you have a chance to offer reassurance.
- Bring resistance out in to open: Deal directly with the resistance, without accusing.
- Evaluate others’ objections fairly: Use active listening to focus on what the other person is expressing, both the words and feeling.

7.1.5 Developing Business Etiquette

Etiquette is an essential element of the every aspect of business communication.

a. Business etiquette in workplace:

Personal Appearance: Your personal appearance in the workplace sends a strong signal to managers, colleagues, and customers. Pay attention to the style of dress where you work and adjust your style to match. Choose well-tailored clothing that's fits well. Keep buttons, zippers in good repair. Select shoes that are comfortable enough for long days but neither too casual nor too dressy for the office. Keep shoes clean and in good condition. Make sure the fabrics you wear are clean. Choose colors that flatter your height, weight, skin tone and style. Grooming is as important as attire. Pay close attention to cleanliness and avoid using products with powerful scents.

Mobile phone is a contentious point of etiquette in today's workplace.

General trips:

- Use frequent verbal responses that show you are listening: Oh, yes, I see.
- Increase your volume just slightly to convey your confidence.
- Do not speak in a monotone; vary your pitch and inflections so people know you are interested.
- Slow down when conversing with people whose native language is not the same as yours.
- Stay focused on the call on the call throughout.

Placing Call:

- Be ready before you call so that you do not waste the other personal time.
- Minimize the noise level in your environment.
- Identify yourself and your organization
- Briefly describe why you are calling
- Verify that you have called at a good time.
- Don't take up too much time
- Speak quickly and clearly
- Close in a friendly, positive, manner and double-check all vital information.

Receiving Calls

- Answer promptly and with a smile so that you sound friendly and positive
- Identify yourself and your company
- Establish the needs of your caller by asking 'How may I help you?'

- If you must forward a call or put some on hold, explain what you are doing first.

b. Business Etiquette in Social Setting

You represent your company when you are out in the public, so etiquette continues to be important.

c. Business Etiquette Online

Here are some guidelines to follow whenever, punctuation you are representing your company while using electronic media.

- Avoid personal attacks.
- Stay focused on the original topic.
- Do not present opinions as facts and support facts with evidence.
- Follow basic expectations of spelling, punctuation.
- Use virus protection and keep it up to date.
- Be careful of online commenting mechanisms.
- Don't use 'reply all' in email unless everyone can benefit from your reply.
- Never assume privacy.
- Don't waste others' time with sloppy, confusing, or incomplete message.
- Watch your language and keep your emotions under control.
- Use difficult to break password on email.

7.2 Meetings

Meetings are a primary communication venue for today's business, whether held in formal conference rooms, in informal settings or on the Internet as virtual meetings. Well-run meetings can help you solve problems, develop ideas, and identify opportunities. Much of your work place communication will occur in small-group meetings; therefore, your ability to contribute to the company and to be recognized for those contributions will depend on your meeting skills.

Unfortunately, many meetings are unproductive. In one study, senior and middle managers reported that only 56 percent of their meetings were actually productive and that 25 percent of them could have been replaced by a phone call or a memo. The three most frequently reported problems with meetings are getting off the subject, not having an agenda, and running too long. You can help ensure productive meetings by preparing carefully, conducting meetings efficiently, and using meeting technologies wisely.

7.2.1 Preparation of Meetings

Before you even begin preparing for a meeting, make sure it's truly necessary. Once you're sure, proceed with four preparation tasks:

- **Identify your purpose:** Although many meetings combine purpose, most focus on one of two types: *Informational meetings* involve sharing information and perhaps coordinating action. *Decision-making meetings* involve persuasion, analysis, and problem solving. Whatever your purpose, make sure it is clear and clearly communicated to all participants.
- **Select participants for the meeting:** If the session is purely informational and one person will do most of the talking, you can invite a large group. For problem-solving and decision-making meetings, invite only those people who are in a direct position to help the meeting reach its objective. The more participants, the more comments and confusion you're likely to get and the longer the meeting will take. However, make sure you invite all the key decision makers, or your meeting will fail to satisfy its purpose.
- **Choose the time and facility:** For working sessions, morning meetings are usually more productive than afternoon session. Also, consider the seating arrangements: Are rows of chairs suitable, or do you need a conference table or some other setting? Plus, give some attention to details such as room temperature, lighting, ventilation, acoustics, and refreshments; any of these seemingly minor details can make or break a meeting.
- **Set the agenda:** The success of any meeting depends on the preparation of the participants. Distribute a carefully written agenda to participants, giving them enough time to prepare as needed. A productive agenda answers three key questions: (1) What do we need to do in this meeting to accomplish our goals? (2) What issues will be of greatest importance to all participants? (3) What information must be available in order to discuss these issues?

7.2.2 Agenda

An agenda is an outline of the contents of a forthcoming meeting. It is list of items proposed to be discussed at a meeting. The members who will attend the meeting must be informed of it well before the meeting. The agenda may be mentioned in the notice itself if their member is small, otherwise they should be listed in a separate sheet and attached to the notice as an Annexure. When it is attached as an annexure or circulated separately, it contains: (i) the name of the organization, (ii) the day, date, time and place of the meeting,

(iii) the program of agenda (iv) the background papers of information and (v) signature of the secretary.

Example:

NOTICE

To: Members, Guest list and Invitation Committee, Convocation ceremony-2017

From: Convenor, Guest List and Invitation Committee

Date: 16.04.2017

Subject: Guest list and Invitation Committee Meeting, Convocation ceremony-2017

This is to inform that faculty members are cordially requested to attend in a meeting on 18.04.2017 at 11.30 A.M. in University Conference Room.

Agenda:

1. Preparing Plan of the Committee.

.....

Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam

Convenor,

Guest list and Invitation Committee,

Convocation ceremony-2017

Copy to:

4. PS to the Chairman, Trustee Board
5. PS to VC
6. PA to Pro-VC
7. Registrar
8. CFO
9. Convenor, Organizing Committee
10. Head of Logistics
11. Members, Guest list and Invitation Committee
12. Assistant Registrar
13. Office copy

7.2.3. Leading and Participating in Meetings

Planning for a meeting goes a long way toward ensuring its success. But to make the meeting successful, a manager as a leader has a great role to play during the meeting. The participants are also vital for extending good participation.

7.2.3.1 Conducting Meeting: Role of Chair

The way you would conduct a meeting is related to the formality of the meeting. For a formal meeting, you would usually follow generally accepted rules of conduct called a parliamentary procedure. The specific rules are too detailed for review here.

- **Starting the meeting:** When the chair (chairman/chairwomen) is satisfied that there is a quorum for the meeting, he/she will call the meeting to order. The chair will declare the meeting open, making the members present clear that the meeting has formally started and recording the exact time.
- **Discussion:** discussion takes place on a series of items outlined on the agenda. The chair briefly introduces the subject and terms of reference and invites the members to take part in discussion one by one. Discussion continues as per agenda. As a leader of the house, the chair would control the agenda. When one item has been covered, the chair brings up the next one. When you are presiding over a meeting, you should not allow a person to talk too much, unless he/she is contributing to the goal through his/her long discussion. You should tactfully control those who talk too much. If the meeting time is limited, you should control it by reminding the members throughout the meeting. Thus, do not allow one or two members to dominate the meeting. At the same time, you should encourage the shy types to take part in the discussion. You might encourage them by saying something like “Mr. Rahman, you have done a lot of work in this area. What do you think?” in this way, after each item has been discussed, decision is taken. At the end of the meeting, you should summarize for everyone what the meeting has accomplished.
- **Dealing with Conflict:** If two or more people are in conflict, do not take side. Remain impartial. The best approach is to encourage each of them to explain his/her position completely. Then the leader restates each position and asks the group members for group comment. On the basis of the group members’ comments, a consensus on a direction to follow is reached.
- **Ruling from the Chair:** A ruling is an official decision. In the case of a meeting it is the decision of the chair while presiding over a formal meeting. The chair of the meeting makes sure that the standing orders are followed. If there is any contravention of this order, he/she gives rulings on it. For example, if any member

behaves in a manner contrary to the standing orders, the chair in that case rules the matter *ultra vires* which means that the matter is beyond the committee's terms of reference. At this point, the discussion must cease. The chair's ruling is final and binding.

- **Closing the meeting:** After every item included on the agenda has been transacted, the meeting is declared closed. But if it is needed by the standing order of the organization to fix the date of the next meeting, the chair moves on to fix the date. When all the members agree over the date, the chair then declares the meeting closed with thanks to the members for attending the meeting and cooperating with the achievement of the meeting's goals.

7.2.3.2 Participating Meeting: Role of Members

As a participant in a meeting you should follow these guidelines:

- **Follow the agenda:** In a formal meeting, where discussion continues according to agenda, you should not bring up any item not on agenda for discussion.
- **Participate:** As you know the purpose of meetings is to get the input of everybody which can facilitate decision making. So you should participate in the discussion and thus your meaningful contribution can enrich the decision.
- **Do not talk too much:** Do not eat much time while you are speaking at the meeting. As a matter of etiquette, respect the rights and feelings of others.
- **Cooperate:** To make the meeting successful, cooperation from all the participants is very essential. So cooperate with all concerned- respect the leader, other participants, and work with them in every practical way.
- **Be Accommodative:** Do not oppose the other's opinion irrationally. This does not sound polite. Try to understand other's viewpoint. This will enhance your prestige.
- **Be Courteous:** You should be courteous. You can show your courtesy by respecting other's rights and opinions and also by permitting them to speak.
- **Point of Order:** Any point of discussion that raises a legal issue is known as a point of order. It is a question raised in a formal meeting as to whether proceedings are according to the rules. Any member can raise this question if he/she finds that the meeting has not been properly convened and constituted. For example, a member may allege that the quorum is not present. The chair will give his/her rulings at once. When a 'point of order' is settled, the discussion will be resumed.

- **Points of Information:** A point of information is a question raised by a member to know further details from the chair or any other member having the necessary data. A member willing to contribute any relevant information may also raise a point of information. If sufficient information is not available, a member may, in a point of information, propose to leave the topic in abeyance until further data are available.
- **Speaking through the chair:** When any member in the meeting wants to contribute to the discussion, he/she should tell it through the chair instead of addressing directly any member in the meeting. If any formal meeting, anybody desiring to do so, he should preface all comments with a direct address to 'Chair' or 'Mr. Chairman'. The word 'Chair' is now commonly used in place of chairman/chairwoman/chairperson because of its certain special merits such as it is short and it avoids the question of sexual stereotyping that somebody finds offensive.

7.2.4 Minutes of a Meeting

Minutes are summaries of proceedings of a meeting. They are brief but proper records of decision taken about the matters discussed in the meeting. Minutes generally contain the main points of discussion and the conclusion reached through discussion. The emotions and feelings if expressed by any member during the course of a meeting are not generally recorded. Thus, they are not the verbatim records of the proceedings of the meeting. Instead, they offer a clear, concise, an accurate and well-organized summary of the business transacted at the meeting. Minutes are more analogous to a précis than to a long narrative.

Minutes are generally written by the leader of the meeting or the secretary of the organizational unit. They become final only when they have been circulated among the members present at the next meeting or circulated beforehand and the chairman confirms them after ascertaining that the members have no objections to the proceedings. Once they are approved and signed by the chairman of the meeting, they become valid evidence.

Contents of Minutes

Minutes start by stating the time and place of the meeting and must have the following contents and requisites:

1. The name of the organization.
2. The name, date, time and place of the meeting held.
3. The name of the chairman of the meeting and members present.
4. The name of the secretary present.
5. Arranging the proceedings as per agenda serial-writing each decision against the concerned serial number of the agenda.
6. Heading of each proceeding.
7. Decision(s) taken at the meeting in toto.
8. Hand written signature of the chairman with date.

Example

University of Information Technology and Sciences (UITs) Convocation Ceremony -2014 Minutes of the Organizing Committee Meeting

The 3rd meeting of the Organizing Committee was held on 11th May at 11.30 am at the conference room of UITs. The meeting was chaired by Prof. Dr. Abul Kalam, Vice -Chancellor, UITs. The following members were present in the meeting:

Sl. No.	Name	Remark
1.	Dr.Abul Kalam, VC	Present
2.	Mr. Faisal , Registrar	Present
3.	Dr. Md. Abdul Kader, Professor	Present
4.	Mr. Nazrul Islam, CFO	Present
5.	Mr. M. Kamal Uddin, Associate Prof.	Present
6.	Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam, Associate Prof.	Present
7.	Mr. Mohammad Ali , Associate Prof.	Present
8.	Md. Shahed, Head of Logistics	Present
9.	Mr. Kazi Shafiqur , Asst. Prof	Present
10.	Mr. A.K.M. Shaiful Islam, Asst. Prof.	Present

Honorable Vice -Chancellor welcomed the members of the meeting and highlighted some important tasks which have to be started immediately. Later he opened the floor for all members. The following agenda were discussed and the decisions of the meeting have been condensed as beneath.

Agenda-1: Progress of Sub-committee

Decision: The Honorable Vice- Chancellor took the progress report of each sub-committee. It is decided that every sub- committee has to submit progress report to convenor at each weekend.

Agenda-2: Hall Booking

Decision: Discussion was held on time period of hall booking. It will be finalized by the BoT.

Agenda-3: Convocation Gown

Decision: The sub-committee will place the budget for gown on ‘purchasing’ and ‘renting’ for approval from authority.

Agenda-4: Ad collection

Decision: The subcommittee has to make a plan for ad collection with forecasted amount and has to take approval from BoT.

Agenda-5: Registration

Decision: Banner may be placed in front of the campus and cumdown days may be given to website at scrolling.

Agenda-6: Cultural Program

Decision: The sub-committee will place the name of the artists with budget for approval from authority.

Agenda-7: Participants (Students and their guest, Faculty and Staff, Guest)

Decision: The number of participants is forecasted about 3000. It need to be more specific and clear due to adjustment with accommodation.

Agenda-8: Souvenir

The name of the all graduates will be in the souvenir.

At the end, Vice- Chancellor thanked all the members and the meeting ended at 5.00 pm.

Dr. Md. Shahidul Islam

Member- Secretary,

Organizing Committee

Copy to:

Dr. Abdul Kader

Convenor,

Organizing Committee

14. PS to the Chairman, Trustee Board

15. PS to VC
16. PA to Pro-VC
17. Registrar
18. Dean, FATE
19. CFO
20. Controller of Exam
21. All Heads of the Departments
22. Head of Logistics
23. Librarian
24. All members of the organizing Committee
25. Office copy

7.2.5 Using Meetings Technologies

You can expect to use a variety of meeting-related technologies throughout your career. These technologies have spurred the emergence of **virtual teams**, whose members work in different locations and interact electronically through **virtual meetings**. At times, technology replaces meetings entirely, such as when team members use e-mail or instant messaging to interact over the course of several hours or days, rather than meeting online or over the phone at a specific time. One of the newest virtual tools is *online brainstorming*, in which companies conduct “idea campaigns” to generate new ideas from people across the organization. These range from small team meetings to huge events such as IBM’s giant innovation Jam, in which 100,000 IBM employees, family members, and customers from 160 countries were invited to brainstorm online for three days.

As with most new technologies, electronic meeting tools are evolving rapidly, and the lines separating these tools have become blurred. For example, instant messaging and video-conferencing are both stand-alone capabilities; both are also common features in **groupware**, an umbrella term for systems that let people communicate, share files, present materials, and work on documents simultaneously. **Shared workspaces** are “virtual offices” that give everyone on a team access to the same set of resources and information: databases, calendars, project plans, pertinent instant messaging and e-mail exchanges, shared reference materials, and team-created documents. Workspaces such as documented e-Room, Microsoft Share Point, and IBM Lotus Team Workspace create a seamless environment for collaboration.

Part 3: Recruitment Correspondences

Chapter 8: Job Application and Resume Writing

8.1 Cover Letter

Whenever you submit your resume, accompany it with a cover, or application, letter to let readers know what you are sending, why you are sending it, and how they can benefit from reading it. Always send your resume and application letter together, because each has a unique job to perform. The purpose of your resume is to get employers interested enough to contact you for an interview. The purpose of your application letter is to get employers interested enough to read your resume.

Solicited Cover Letters

A solicited cover letter is something you draft when you're applying for a posted job opening or responding to an employment ad. Start off the letter by introducing yourself and stating why you're writing. For example, "I'm writing in regard to the open marketing manager position posted on your website. In my enclosed resume, you'll see I have 10 years experience in marketing and communications, and I've worked in a variety of capacities for both large and medium-sized employers."

Unsolicited Cover Letters

Just because an employer hasn't asked you for your resume doesn't mean he won't be interested in seeing it -- you just have to make the first move. An unsolicited cover letter is used to pitch yourself to a potential employer, either for an existing job opening, or as a way of introducing yourself to a company you'd like to work with. The former is known as "prospecting," and is used to let an employer know who you are and what kind of job you're looking for. The letter should introduce you, highlight your skills and credentials, and provide a brief explanation of why you're writing. Note why you think you're a good fit for the company, either for an existing job or a future opening. "I've always admired your company's customer service levels, and I'm very interested in joining your stellar customer retention team."

8.2 Steps in Cover Letter

Three to five short paragraphs are all you need to create a dynamic cover letter. By making your cover letter as concise as possible, you demonstrate your ability to communicate clearly and effectively. Our guide takes you through each step of the letter-writing process.

Step 1 - The Salutation

- Address the letter to a name: "Dear Sir" If you can't obtain the information by calling the company, uses a title: "Dear Advertising Manager."

- Make sure the company address on your letter matches the one on your envelope.

Step 2 - Introductory Paragraph

- Open with a sentence that grabs the reader's attention. For example, explain how your skills uniquely qualify you for the job or that you are enthusiastic about the position or company.
- State what position you are applying for and where you learned about the job.

Step 3 - Why I'm the Perfect Person for the Job Paragraph

- Be specific without repeating everything that is on your resume.
- Briefly explain important career achievements.
- Define how you can contribute to the company's success. How do your skills make you stand out?

Step 4 - Additional Background and Skills Paragraph

- Talk about any additional skills that you have (be brief!).
- Show you have done research on the company by demonstrating how your background can help you meet current company objectives.
- State your practical work experience (as it pertains to the job; no one needs to know your entire teenage work history).
- Use bullet points to highlight your greatest strengths (if you have not already done so).

Step 5 - Executive Level Information Paragraph

- If you are applying to a higher-level or executive position (VP, Manager, etc.), you might want to include a fourth paragraph that gives more details of your achievements and background.
- For an entry-level job or non-executive position, you probably don't need another "background paragraph."

Step 6 - Closing Paragraph

- Don't ignore a request for salary requirements-but be cautious. Give a broad range or write "negotiable."
- Thank the employer for reviewing your materials.

Step 7 - Signature

- Remember to sign your letter in black or blue ink! Other colors don't look professional.
- List your phone number underneath your name. It makes it a lot easier to find.

8.3 Mistakes in Cover Letter

Make sure you don't commit any of the following errors. Some of these are obvious mistakes while others are easier to miss. But they all have one thing in common; you should avoid them at all costs!

- Forgetting to sign your cover letter.
- Including personal information that is not pertinent to the job you're seeking: "I haven't worked in eight months and I really need this job."
- Including personal statistics more suitable to a dating service than a job: "Single, Catholic, male, who enjoys jumping in my spare time."
- Confessed shortcomings ("I know I don't have the experience you're looking for...").
- Mismatching company information; you send the letter to Star Corporation but it makes reference to Moon Insurance.
- Food stains or grease marks on the paper or envelope.
- Incorrect spelling of names.
- Handwriting the cover letter instead of typing it. Unless you are requested to give handwriting cover letter.
- Failing to enclose your resume.
- Messy corrections.
- Stapling instead clipping the cover letter to the resume, which causes undue hassle.
- Ignoring a request for salary requirements when the ad specifically asks for it. You don't have to name an exact figure, but do include a range.

8.4 Checklist in Cover Letter

Go ahead and ask yourself the following 10 questions to make sure you haven't forgotten anything important.

- Have I proofread my letter at least twice for grammar, spelling and typographical errors?
- Is the letter addressed to a specific person? Did I include their correct title and have I spelled the person's name correctly?
- Have I signed the letter in blue or black ink?
- Is my letter confined to one page and no more than three to five short paragraphs?
- Have I highlighted my strengths in the second or third paragraph using bullet points?
- Does the cover letter focus on the needs of the employer and not on my own requirements, such as money or flexible hours?
- Do I have a copy of the cover letter for my own records?

- If salary information was specifically asked for, have I included it? (No need to mention salary if it was not requested.)
- Did I include my resume? Have I placed it behind the cover letter without staples and folded it neatly in thirds to fit into a standard size envelope?
- And because it's the number one thing people forget to do: Have I signed my name using blue or black ink?

8.5 Examples of Cover letter

8.5.1 Cover Letter-Entry Level

September 17, 2017

Human Resource Manager

Uro Cola Ltd.

42, Motijheel Commercial Area, Dhaka

Application for the position of 'Sales Executive'

Dear Sir,

In response to your job advertisement published in the Daily Star on 6th September- 2017, I would like to apply for the position of Sales Executive.

I understand from your advertisement that your organization needs young and dynamic people for working in the sales promotion team for your newly launched project. You will note from my enclosed CV that I my education background as well as the part time job assignments during last couple of years through which I have had exposure and hands on experience in market research and promotional techniques make me an ideal candidate for the position.

I have got my MBA (Marketing) from Dhaka University in 2015. Currently I am working as a part time research executive for a reputed market research firm.

I believe working in a reputed organization like your one will provide me excellent opportunity for my career growth in the area of direct marketing and sales promotion. I am confident that if provided the opportunity to serve your organization, I will prove myself to be an important asset for your company through my dedication, sincerity and highest level

of professionalism.

I would request for an interview at your convenience. For any query, you can reach me at my mobile 0173-1111 or phone (res) 22111111. You can also e-mail me at minhaz@yahoo.com.

Thank you.

Yours truly,

Minhazur Rahman

Encl:

- i. Curriculum Vita
- ii. Photograph
- iii. Experience Certificates

8.5.2 Cover Letter: Mid-Level Position

March 15, 2017,

Mr. Mosiur Rahman

Human Resources Manager

ABC Corporation, 23 Uttara, Dhaka

Bangladesh

Subject: Job application for the post of Sales Manager.

Dear Sir:

Referenced to your job advertisement at bdjobs.com I strongly believe my experience and education will make me the ideal candidate for the post. You stated in your ad that you were looking for an ambitious leader who will develop and manage accounts. Here is a snapshot of what I have done in the past and what I can bring to ABC Corporation:

- Identified target markets, developed product requirements, and effectively evaluated customer needs for a 30% increase in customer satisfaction.
- Developed strategic plans based on industry trending and customer analysis.
- Prepared sales forecasts, account status reports, and recommendations which enhanced account growth and revenue by 40%.

- Participated in contract negotiations with top executives.
- Built and led a motivated and skilled sales team of 20.

I'm confident in what I do and always go above and beyond to satisfy my clients while keeping company goals in mind. I have proven throughout my career that I can create new business, develop existing accounts and cultivate client loyalty. Let me do the same for your company.

I have no doubt that a few minutes of your time with me will convince you that I can be a great asset to ABC Corporation. Together, we can achieve results!

Sincerely,

Abdul Kader

Enclosure

- i. Curriculum Vita
- ii. Photograph
- iii. Experience Certificates

8.5.3 Cover Letter: Executive Careers

March 15, 2017

Mr. Mohammad M. Rahman
Human Resources Manager
Sun Corporation

22, Uttara, Dhaka
Bangladesh

Subject: Vice President of Marketing Position

Dear Sir:

While reading an article in Sales & Marketing Digest on leading marketing firms, I took an interest in the type of product focus your company is advancing towards. As shown below, my past accomplishments are an ideal match to your requirements for a Vice President of Marketing.

Your Requirements:

- Charismatic professional with top-level management experience.
- Proven record.
- Sales management experience.
- Product development experience.
- Communication and presentation skills.
- Master's degree.

My Qualifications:

- Former manager of a tk.125MM division of a Fortune 500 company. Served on the Board of Executives of two subsidiaries.
- Grew sales from tk.50 to tk.125MM in three years by internal growth and acquisition.
- Former Marketing Manager for a Fortune 500 company. Led sales team of 15.
- Delivered product-specific training and helped ensure consistent product messaging.
- Created technical marketing presentations and assisted in developing product demonstrations.
- MBA from the University of Texas.

These are only a few of my accomplishments. I look forward to speaking with you in more detail about my record, and I will follow up by phone the week of April 29.

Sincerely,

Mostofa Kamal

1. Enclosure:
 - a. Curriculum Vita
 - b. Photograph
 - c. Experience Certificates

8.5.4 Unsolicited Inquiry Letter

July 15, 2017

Mr. Mohammad Saidur Rahman
Human Resources Manager
Golden Corporation
21, Motijhil, Dhaka
Bangladesh

Dear Mr Rahman:

My name is Sk. Kamal. Like you, I have extensive experience in consumer product marketing. In the next few months, I will be relocating to the Indianapolis area. To assist me in my search for employment, I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to meet with you to discuss your observations about the major marketers in the Indianapolis region and to request the names and contact information of area marketing executives who you feel might be of assistance.

Enclosed you will find a resume that highlights my marketing and product development accomplishments over the past 15 years. As you can see, I have experience in designing and implementing product positioning campaigns that have increased market share within a few months. I take great pride in the success of these programs.

I will call you during the week of July 29 to set up an interview. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

8.6 Definition of Resume

A resume is a structured, written summary of a person's education, employment background and job qualifications. Your Curriculum Vitae (CV) is the primary medium of presenting yourself as a candidate for a job to a prospective employer. But many of the job seekers do not give proper attention and care in preparing their CVs accurately. As a result, many potential job seekers do not get calls for job interviews to get the opportunity to present and prove their potential.

8.7 Types of Resume

Make your resume Chronological, Functional or combination of the two. The right choice depends on your background and goals

- **Chronological Resume**

The work experience section dominates and is placed in the most prominent slot, immediately after the name and address and optional objectives. You develop this section by listing your jobs sequentially in reverse order, beginning with the most recent position and working backward toward earlier jobs. Under each listing describe your responsibilities and accomplishment giving the most space to the most recent position. If you are just graduating from college with limited professional experience you can vary this chronological approach by putting your educational qualification before your experiences, thereby focusing attention on your credential.

- **Functional Resume**

Sometimes called skilled résumé, emphasize your skills and capabilities, identifying employers and academic experience in subordinate sections. This pattern stresses individual areas of competence, so it is useful for people who are just entering the job market, want to redirect their careers or have little continuous career related experience.

- **Combination**

If you do not have a lot of work history to show, consider a combination resume to highlight your skills while still providing a chronological history of your employment.

8.8 Things to do before writing Resume

- Generally an employer does not give more than 30 seconds time in looking at a CV briefly. So a CV should be precise and clear. Unnecessary and irrelevant information should be avoided.
- A CV of a fresher or an inexperienced candidate should not be over one or two pages.
- Your CV is the way to promote yourself. Therefore, it should be attractive. But color papers or color print should not be used for this purpose. In case of highlighting any information, you can bold, italicize or underline it.
- Remember that any type of grammatical or spelling mistake in your CV will create a negative impact in the mind of the employer. It will give the impression that you cannot do any work correctly. So after preparing your CV, read it intensely and let it checked by somebody who knows correct English.
- When applying for a particular job announcement, try to customize your CV according to the job requirements. You need to read the job announcement carefully and make some research on it. For example, if you know the information that the employer can locate the job anywhere in Bangladesh, you may mention the places you have visited and stayed in Bangladesh. Again, when the employer is looking for an Organizer, you can mention the organizing activities you have done in your student life. It will create an additional value in your CV.
- It is very important that you should give true and correct information in your CV. You should not give any information that can appear as false the job interview.

8.9 Parts of a Resume

The following information is to be presented in a CV in an organized way:

- Title
- Career Summary – mostly applicable for the experienced persons.
- Career objective – mostly applicable for the fresh applicants.
- Experience
- Education
- Additional Information

- Personal Information
- Reference

Title

Your name will come first in the title. It should be in 'bold' format and in a larger font (avoid using your nick name). Then write your address (your present address where you can receive mails by post), phone number and email address. This portion will be on the center of the page to draw the attention.

Career Summary

This is mostly applicable for the persons having experience more than 4-5 years. State the sectors of your experience in maximum 6 to 7 lines. State in short the achievements of your career (if any).

Career Objective

This section is generally applicable for the fresh candidates or the candidates with little experience (1- 2 years). Mention the immediate goal of your career in this part. Also mention how your experience and potential match with the position you are applying for. Bring up your positive skills for the position. It is important to write your career objective according to the criteria mentioned in the job announcement. Give emphasis on the ways you can make contribution for the company and what is your expectation from the company.

Experience

For the experienced candidates, this section should come before the 'Educational Qualification' section.

Things that you should mention in your experience details are as follows:

- Organization name
- Designation
- Time Period – From & To
- Job Responsibility
- Special Achievement

If you have working experience in different positions in a same organization, mention it in different phases.

State your most recent experience first and then mention one by one your other experiences in the Resume following Chronological Order which is to end with your first experience. It is better not to mention experience of short and insignificant experience. Try not to have long gap of time between the jobs.

Education & Training

- Education & training part should come before experience part for a fresher. You will mention your degrees in education part with the following information.
- Name of degree (Such as SSC, HSC, B.Com)
- Duration of course
- Name of institutions and board.
- Year of Examination and date of publishing result (if necessary),
- Result and achievement (if any)

You should mention your most recent degree first like your experience part, then mention the other degrees by turn.

Remember that you should mention ‘appeared’ if the final result is not yet published. Please mention ‘ongoing’ if you are continuing any program. You need not to mention the result of any degree if any of the result is a very poor one. Remember that, it looks odd if you mention the result of one degree and avoid another.

If you participate in any particular training program that supports your work experience, you should mention it. Mention the training institution, topic and duration of training. You can place the list of training right after the education part.

Additional Information

The information that does not fall in the above mentioned parts but is related with the job must be shown in this part. For example:

- Professional Achievement
- Award
- Language Proficiency
- Computer skills
- License, government identity, publications and authorization.
- Voluntary work etc.

Personal information

You can mention your parent’s name, present and permanent address, religion, traveling places (Country) if any, hobby etc. in this section.

Reference

You should not mention the name of any close relative as referee in reference part. Referees should be the persons who have seen you closely in your student life or working life. You must mention the phone number, address and e-mail (if any) of your referee. It is better to

mention two or three persons as referees. It is important to inform your referee that you have mentioned his name as referee in your CV.

8.10 Resume Writing: Some Guidelines

When an employer looks at your resume, you've got about 30 seconds to make a good impression. That's the average amount of time most employers spend reading a resume. To capture the reader's attention, you need to be clear and to-the-point. And, that's not all. Keep in mind the following guidelines to create an effective resume:

Be Concise and Omit Irrelevant Information:

Employers don't want to read a long, drawn-out version of your life's accomplishments. They have stacks of resumes to read, and want to know quickly whether or not you would be a good fit for their company. So, be concise, and exhibit your skills and abilities. A resume should only include information that will help convince an employer to interview you. Descriptions of relevant skills and accomplishments should be concise and to the point. Including irrelevant experience and lengthy descriptions will bury the important information. Only include personal information where it demonstrates an important personal quality or qualification. A resume should represent what you can do on the job, not what you do in your personal life.

Don't Forget Your Objective:

Before diving into writing your resume, plan out your career objective. Make it clear and focused. Remember to keep the message consistent throughout your resume as you summarize your skills and accentuate your strengths.

Write a Powerful Opening Statement:

If you are a recent graduate or have limited experience in your career, you should include a Job Objective statement at the top of your resume, which will help focus the reader's attention and describe what type of position you are looking for.

If you have experience in your career field, you want a powerful Summary statement that illustrates your best qualifications for the position at the top of the resume. A well-crafted opening statement should convince an employer to keep reading.

Use Industry Jargon:

Use industry jargon and acronyms to reflect your familiarity with the employer's business, but not to the point where it makes your resume hard to read or understand. Spell out acronyms in parentheses if they are not obvious, such as TQM (Total Quality Management).

Customize It: Focus on Your Benefit to Employers:

Describe your experience in a way that relates to the skills the employer is seeking. Focus on highlighting accomplishments that will arouse the interest of employers who read your resume. Answer the question: "How can this candidate fulfill the role and make a positive impact?" If a company is looking for a candidate who has leadership ability, highlight your experience in training new employees or in managing projects. Remember that the goal is to get the interview.

Include Keywords:

Draw attention to your resume with keywords that describe your skills and experience. Inserting descriptive keywords in your resume is becoming more important as an increasing number of companies search for resumes in computer databases that find matches through keywords. These words should relate to the job you are applying for while highlighting your own skill set.

Use Action-Benefit statements: Avoid Boring List of Job Responsibilities:

The best resumes describe experience using Action-Benefit statements, which describe an action you took in response to a challenge or opportunity, and explain how your action had a positive benefit for your company. This method brings your experience statements to life and demonstrates how you can achieve success and produce results. An Action-Benefit statement might read "Analyzed declining sales and developed campaign that increased orders by 30% in less than one month." This statement describes the situation or challenges you faced (declining sales), the Action you took (developed a campaign), and the Benefit of your actions (a 30% increase in orders).

Quantify Your Achievements:

You need to give the reader an idea of what you have done throughout your career, but instead of focusing on the duties you were responsible for at your last jobs, list your accomplishments in action-benefit statements along with quantifiable facts to back up your claims. Use numbers, percentages and dollar amounts to show your success in achieving company goals. Instead of writing "Responsible for increasing sales in my territory," use "Increased sales in my territory 150% over 6 months."

Use Action Verbs:

Portray yourself as active, accomplished, intelligent, and capable of contributing. Examples: Managed, Launched, Created, Directed, Established, Organized, and Supervised. Never use the same action word repeatedly. Instead of using a word like 'directed' over and over, use synonyms such as controlled, supervised, guided, or managed. Utilize a thesaurus, career advice Web sites and other sources if you are having problems coming up with new

ways to say the same thing.

Be Professional, Not Personal:

You do not have much room in a resume, so why take up valuable space with information unrelated to the position you are seeking? Focus on your work experiences and never refer to personal information such as race, religion, marital status, age, political party, or even personal views. In all but a few instances, it would be illegal for the employer to consider such issues. Also, avoid the use of humor and clichés in resumes and forget about mentioning the fact that you enjoy horror movies and surfing in your spare time.

Personal Traits:

If you want to include personal traits in your resume, such as "Dependable, Highly-Organized, Self-Motivated, and Responsible," rather than just listing these traits, try demonstrating these characteristics using examples from your experience. For example, instead of writing "Dependable," write "Never missed an important deadline in five years as a project manager."

Keep a Positive Tone:

Your resume should present you in the best possible light. If you don't possess every skill an employer is seeking, do not emphasize your shortcomings. Focus on what you can offer.

Be Honest:

Lying or exaggerating about your skills and abilities will only come back to haunt you.

Be Organized and Logical:

In addition to reviewing your experience, employers also use the resume to sense whether you are organized, logical, and concise. Make sure your resume is balanced, neat, visually appealing, and flows consistently. Clearly separate sections and emphasize section titles.

Just Communicate:

Abandon the use of exorbitant, exquisite vocabulary. In other words, don't try to impress employers with the depth of your vocabulary. Use words everyone can understand.

Combine Sections When Possible:

Try to combine any short sections together to make your resume more compact. For example, if you only have one entry under training, consider placing it under your education instead and change the section title to "Education and Training."

Use Common Section Headings:

Use common section headings. Examples: Objective, Experience, Employment, Work History, Skills, Summary, Summary of Qualifications, Accomplishments, Achievements, Capabilities, Education, Professional Affiliations, Publications, Licenses and Certifications, and Honors.

Omit Salary Information:

Never refer to salary in your resume. Save this information for the interview.

Avoid Writing in First Person ("me" or "I"):

Your resume is not a personal correspondence, and should not include words such as "I," "my," or "me." Replace such personal pronouns with short action statements. Instead of saying, "I wrote several articles for the company newsletter," try, "Researched and wrote several articles for the company newsletter." Save the first person pronouns for your cover letter.

Placing Professional Titles:

There are several places where it would be appropriate to put your professional title. You can place your title next to your name in the format "Ahmed Abdullah, FCA." You can include it in your Summary, Education, or Licenses/Certifications sections. If your title is an important qualification in your job search, be sure it appears at the top of your resume.

Including References in Your Resume:

You do not have to include references on your resume. Most employers will assume you can provide references if they are requested.

8.11 Exteriors of Resume

Resume Length

A resume should be as long as needed to list your best and most relevant qualifications for the job you are seeking. For recent graduates or those with only a few years of experience, you should be able to put all your relevant experience on a single page. If you have extensive experience in your field, you may require a two-page resume to list all of your relevant experience. Instead of considering the length of your resume, make sure that it is clear and concise, and that the information is relevant to the position you are seeking. The most important consideration for a resume is not length, but whether it sufficiently describes your best qualifications for the job.

Paper Size

Use standard A4 or letter (8½" x 11") size offset paper. Recruiters handle hundreds of resumes; if yours is on a smaller sheet, it is likely to be lost in the pile, and if it is oversized, it may get crumpled and have trouble fitting in a company's file.

Paper Color

White and ivory are the only Paper colors considered acceptable for resumes and cover letters.

Computers & Word Processing

The most flexible way to type your resume is on a computer or word processor. This allows you to make changes almost instantly, and to store different drafts on disk. Word processing systems also give you many different options such as bold facing for emphasis, different fonts or typefaces and justified margins.

Printing Your Resume

Find the best quality offset printing process available and do not make your copies on a photocopier. Only the personnel office may see the resume you mail; everyone else may see a copy of it. Copies of copies quickly become illegible.

Proofreading is Essential

Mistakes on resumes can be embarrassing and no doubt you are the only one who will lose if there is a mistake. So proofread your resume as carefully as possible and then have a friend do it. Make sure your spelling and grammar are perfect. Don't rely entirely on computer or word-processors built-in spell-check programs, because not all typos are misspellings and a spelling checker is not a substitute for proofreading for your resume. Words spelled correctly can still be used improperly. Bear in mind that a spelling checker cannot flag errors such as "to" for "two" or "bills" for "skills."

Utilize Bullet-Points

Use bullet points in the body of your resume instead of long paragraphs. Resumes are read rather quickly and anything you can do to draw the reader in will bring you one step closer to landing an interview.

Consistent Formatting

Choose easy-to-read fonts and use consistent formatting for headings and bullet points. Also, make sure you leave enough space between each section with boldface or capital lettering. Use bold, italics, and underlining to highlight the most relevant information on your resume. In the same respect, steer clear of flashy formatting or overly creative resumes with unconventional fonts or graphics, unless you are seeking a highly creative position. Keep your resume simple, bold and professional.

Avoid Overuse of Highlighting: Bold / Italics / Underline

Drawing attention to everything is the same as drawing attention to nothing. Use highlighting such as bold, italics, and underline sparingly for maximum effect on specific areas you want to draw attention to and be consistent in your highlighting technique.

8.12 Examples of Resume

Experienced Level Resume

Resume of Dr. Md. Shafiqul Islam



1. Contract Address:

C/O, Dr. Enamul Hoque

Professor, Department of Chemistry, Jahangirnagar University, Savar, Dhaka.

Mobile phone: 0171111111, E-mail: s.islam@yahoo.com

2. Career Summary:

I served as a **Coordinator, School of Business (BBA & MBA)** in UITs, Chittagong. I also served as a **Chairman** (in charge) of Department of Business Administration, **Controller of Examination** (in charge) and **Assistant Professor** in BGC Trust University Bangladesh. I

have **thirteen years** teaching experience in private universities including **ten years** managerial experience. Moreover, I have **23 research articles** in various national and international journals.

3. Employment Record:

#	Name of Organization	Duration		Designation
		From	To	
1	University of Information Technology and Sciences(UTIS), Chittagong	01.04.2013	30.4.2016	Coordinator , School of Business
2	University of Information Technology and Sciences(UTIS), Chittagong	01.04.2009	30.4.2016	Assistant Professor & Coordinator, MBA Program
3	University of Information Technology and Sciences(UTIS), Dhaka	01.05.2016	Till today	Assistant Professor , School of Business(part time)
4	BGC Trust University Bangladesh	21.01.2008 09..08.2008	24.05.2008 & 11.10.2008	Chairman(in charge) , Department of Business Administration
5	BGC Trust University Bangladesh	01.12.2005	03.06.2007	Controller of Examination (in charge)
6	BGC Trust University Bangladesh	05.01.2008	31.03.2009	Assistant Professor
7	BGC Trust University Bangladesh	06.01.2004	04.01.2008	Lecturer
8	BGC Trust University Bangladesh	07.07.2003	05.01.2004	Teaching Assistant

4. Total length of experience:

13 years (including 10 years in administrative positions): (Controller of Examination, Chairman of DBA, Coordinator of MBA program , Coordinator of School of Business)

5. Academic Record:

PhD (Doctor of Philosophy):

Thesis Title: *Dividend Practices in Corporate Sector of Bangladesh: A Study on the Companies Listed with Dhaka Stock Exchange.*

Supervisor: Dr. M. Ahmed, Professor, Department of Finance, University of Dhaka.

University: Department of Finance, University of Dhaka.

#	Name of the Institution	Degree/ Level	Passing	Class/Division/
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			Year	Grade
1	Department of Finance, University of Dhaka	PhD (Doctor of Philosophy)	2016	
2	Institute of Business Administration(IBA), Jahangirnagar University	MBA(Master of Business Administration)- Major in Finance, Minor in Marketing	2003	CGPA-3.79(out of 4)
3	Institute of Business Administration(IBA), Jahangirnagar University	BBA(Bachelor of Business Administration)	2001	CGPA-3.65(out of 4)
4	Notre Dame College	H.S.C	1994	1 st Division, Science Group (Marks: 72.4%)
5	Kasiani G.C. Pilot High School, Gopalganj	S.S.C	1992	1 st Division, Science Group (Marks: 80 %)

6. Training Record:

#	Title/Subject of Training	Duration	Provided by	Location
1	Office Culture and Personal Development	10 days	Biman Bangladesh Airlines Training Centre	Dhaka
2	Training on ERP software	6 days	PHP technical team	Chittagong

7. Language skill:

#	Language	Writing				Speaking			
		Average	Good	Very Good	Excellent	Average	Good	Very Good	Excellent
1	Bangla				√			√	
2	English			√				√	

8. Computer skill: ☒ MS-Word ☒ MS-Excel ☒ MS-PowerPoint ☒ MS-Access ☒ SPSS ☒ AMOS ☒ STATA ☒ EVIEWS

9. Other relevant special skills:

- Worked **as a Member**, Academic committee, University of Information Technology and Sciences(UITs),Chittagong
- Worked **as a Convener**, Disciplinary committee, University of Information Technology and Sciences(UITs),Chittagong
- Worked **as a Member**, Library committee, BGC Trust University Bangladesh
- Worked **as a Member**, Academic committee, BGC Trust University Bangladesh
- Worked **as a Member**, Proctorial Body, BGC Trust University Bangladesh
- **Editor**, Syllabus of BBA Program, BGC Trust University, Bangladesh.
- Worked **as a Convener** of Cultural and Sports Committee, BGC Trust University Bangladesh.

10. List of publications (total number-23: International- 17, National -6)

International Trade related Research Papers

International Journals

- i. Islam, M.S. & Khanam, R.T.(2014).Trade Performance of Bangladesh with East: Evaluation, Justification and Strategy. *Asian Journal of Management Sciences & Education (AJMSE)*, Japan.
- ii. Islam, M.S. & Das, R.K. (2014). Bangladesh and BIMSTEC: Performance Evaluation and Development Strategies. *Al Barakat Institute of Management Studies Journal*, India.
- iii. Islam, M.S & Das, R.K.(2012).Bangladesh and its Economic Integrations: Evaluation, Development and Strategy. *World Journal of Social Sciences, Vol. 2. No. 5. August 2012 Special Issue*, 235 – 252.
- iv. Islam, M.S. & Alauddin,M.(2012).World Production of Jute: A Comparative Analysis of Bangladesh. *International Journal of Management and Business Studies, Vol. 2 (1)*, 014-022.
- v. Islam, M.S. & Chowdhury,I.A. (2012). An Evaluation of the Trade Relations of Bangladesh with ASEAN: Justification of Being a Future Member. *European Journal of Business and Management, UK, Vol 4, No.8*.

National Journals

- vi. Islam, M.S. & Das,R.K. (2014). Comparative Trade performance of Bangladesh: Evaluation and Justification of Look East Policy. *Presidency University Journal*, Dhaka.

- vii. Purohit, K.K & Islam, M. S. (2007).Trading Experience of Bangladesh with SAARC Countries: An Analysis of Pre and Post SAPTA. *Prime University Journal*, Prime University, Dhaka, vol.1, no.1, 11-28.

National Economy Related Research Papers

International Journals

- i. Islam, M.S. & Musa.M. (2015).The development of Agriculture sector in Bangladesh: A comparative analysis and strategies for growth. *Al Barakat Institute of Management Studies Journal*, India.vol. 6, no.2.
- ii. Islam, M.S.& Musa,M.(2012).The Comparative Growth of Service Sectors in Bangladesh. *Research Journal of Finance and Accounting*, [International Institute for Science, Technology and Education](#), UK,Vol 3, No 5.
- iii. Islam, M.S & Ahmed, S.K.(2012).The Impacts of Jute on Environment: An Analytical Review of Bangladesh. *Journal of Environment and Earth Science*, Vol 2, No.5.

Capital Market Related Research Papers

International Journals

- i. Islam, M.S. & et al. (2015). Security Prices Reaction to The Announcement Of Dividends Omission: Study On DSE. *Al Barakat Institute of Management Studies Journal*, India.vol.7.
- ii. Islam, M.S. & et al. (2015). Security Prices Reaction to the Announcement of Cash Dividends: Study on Good news. *IOSR Journal of Business and Management*, vol. 17, 1-6, India.
- iii. Jahur, M. S & Islam,M.S (2014).Growth and Development of Government Bond Market in Bangladesh: Analysis of Influencing Factors. *International Journal of Applied management Research*, North –Eastern Hill University, India.
- iv. Islam, M.S & Jahan, S.(2012).Analysis of Financial Products of Capital Market in Bangladesh: Present Status and Future Development. *International Journal of Marketing Studies*, Canada, Vol. 4, No. 5.

National Journals

- v. Jahur, M. S & Islam,M.S.(2014).Growth and Development of Bond Market in Bangladesh. *Business Studies Journal*. University of Chittagong, vol.24,45-60.

- vi. Purohit, K.K & Islam, M. S. (2008).The Relevance of Dividend Theories in the Capital Market of Bangladesh: Justification MM model vs. Gordon Model. *BGC Trust University Journal*, BGC Trust University Bangladesh, Chittagong, vol.1, no.1.
- vii. Purohit, K.K & Islam, M. S. (2007). Dividend Policy of Listed Companies in Bangladesh: An Analytical Review. *The Cost and Management*, ICMA, Dhaka, vol.35, no.3, 66-78.
- viii. Purohit, K.K & Islam, M. S. (2007).Capital Market of Bangladesh: Is Present Trends and Measures for Development. *Metropolitan University Journal*, Metropolitan University, vol.1, no.1, 68-81.

Others Papers

- i. Islam, M.S.& Kashem,M.A.(2012).Customer Satisfaction of Super Stores in Bangladesh- An Explorative Study. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, UK, Vol.3, No.7.
- ii. Islam, M.S. & Bayes, M A. (2012). An analysis of Bengali poet Nazrul's letters: His psychic revelation. *Asian Journal of Research in Social Sciences and Humanities*, Volume: 2, Issue: 11, India.
- iii. Islam, M.S. & et al. (2015).Factor Affecting Organizational Citizenship Behaviour of Corporate Sector in Bangladesh. *European Journal of Business and Management*, UK.

Accepted Papers (no. 2):

- i. Jahur, M. S & Islam,M.S (2016).Growth and Development of Corporate Bond Market in Bangladesh: Analysis of Impediment Factors. *Journal of Global Economics, Management and Business Research* (accepted).
- ii. Islam, M.S. & et al. (2016). Individual Perception toward Dividend: A Study on Dhaka Stock Exchange. *Al Barakat Institute of Management Studies Journal*, India.vol.9, India.

11. Personal Information:

1. Full name: Md. Saiful Islam	6. Nationality: Bangladeshi
2. Father's name: Abdur Rauf Mridha	7. Religion: Islam

3. Mother's name: Hasina Begum 4. Date of birth: January 01, 1978 5. Sex: Male	8. Marital Status: Double
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Address:

Permanent Address	Mailing Address
Vill: Kharhat Post: Kasiani P.S: Kasiani Dist: Gopalganj Mobile phone: 0171111111, E-mail: s.islam@yahoo.com	C/O, Dr. Enamul Hoque Professor, Department of Chemistry, Jahangirnagar University, Savar, Dhaka. Mobile phone: 0171111111, E-mail: s.islam@yahoo.com

12. References:

Referee 1	Referee 2
Dr. Md. Fashiul Alam Professor, Dept of Management Studies, CU Alam200@yahoo.com Cell: 0111134	Dr. Mohammad Saleh Jahur, Professor, Department of Finance University of Chittagong, Chittagong, Bangladesh E-account: sjahur2000@yahoo.com Cell:017111183

Signature:

Date: 05.11. 2016.....

Entry Level Resume

Curriculum Vitae

Of

Shaikh Tawhidul Islam



Contact Address:

75/1, 2 No. Navy Gate, Khalishpur, Khulna, GPO- 9000

Cell: 01715-684149, E-mail: thdlsim@gmail.com

Career Objective:

To pursue a challenging career in a dynamic organizations where I will have the opportunity to utilize my knowledge and prove my skills for professional career development and to share their successes while contributing for achieving their goal.

Academic Qualification:

Qualification	Major/Group	Institute/ University/Board	Year of Passing	Duration of Course	Result
Master of Business Studies(M.B.S)	Marketing	Azam Khan Govt. Commerce College, National University	2015	1 year	Second Class
Bachelor of Business Studies(B.B.S)	Marketing	Azam Khan Govt. Commerce College, National University	2014	4 years	Second Class
H.S.C	Business Studies	Govt. Sundarban Adarsha College, Khulna, Jessore Board	2007		GPA:4.30
S.S.C	Business Studies	Rotary School, Khulna, Jessore Board	2005		GPA:4.00

Training:

- Finished English language proficiency Course (foundation/spoken English/ all basic skills) from Bhuiyan Computers Ltd.

Computer Skill:

- Finished Office Application Course (Ms.word, Ms. Excel, Ms. Access, Ms. Power point, Advance Ms. Excel & Advance Ms. Access) from Bhuiyan Computers Ltd.
- Finished Graphics Course (Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Quark Xpress, and Macromedia Flash) from Bhuiyan Computers Ltd.

Other Skills:

- Strong business awareness.
- Strong leadership, ability to influence others and good decision-making skills.
- Good interpersonal and communication skills to build useful working relationships.
- Ability to work well in a team.
- The ability to achieve results while remaining calm under pressure.

Personal Information:

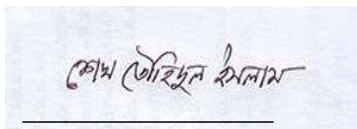
Father's Name : Late. Md. Abu Shahid
Mother's Name : Aklima Khanom
Date of Birth : 18th July, 1989
Contact Address : 75/1, 2 no Navy Gate, Khalishpur, Khulna, GPO- 9000
Contact Number : 01715-684149
E-mail Address : thdlsim@gmail.com
Permanent Address : 75/1, 2 no Navy gate, Khalishpur, Khulna, GPO- 9000
Nationality : Bangladeshi
Religion : Islam-Sunni
Marital Status : Married

References:

▪ Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam Head, Dept. of Business Administration, BGMEA University of Fashion &	▪ Begum Samsur Nahar Deputy Registrar, Law School, Khulna University
--	---

Technology (BUFT) Phone (Office): 02-8919986 Cell: +8801758075844 E-mail: shahidulislam28@yahoo.com	Contact No: +8801724599394
--	----------------------------

I, the undersigned, declare that to the best of my knowledge and belief, these data correctly described my qualifications and experience.



(Shaikh Tawhidul Islam)

Chapter 9: Job Interview and Job Correspondences

9.1.Introduction

The interview is when employers will get to know your personality, interests, goals, and objectives. You will no longer be a list of skills and experiences on a piece of paper; this is your opportunity to give specific examples and anecdotes and explain how these experiences make you the perfect candidate for the position. It is the perfect time to demonstrate your interest in the position and your knowledge about the company and the industry. This is the time for the employer to find out who you are, so be yourself.

9.2 Types of Interviews

A **structured interview** is controlled by the interviewer to gather facts. In an **open-ended interview**, the recruiter encourages you to speak freely. **Group interviews** help recruiters see how several candidates interact with one another. **Stress interview** help recruiters see how you handle yourself under pressure. In **situational interviews**, you're asked to explain how you would handle a specific set of circumstances. A **behavioral interview** asks candidates to describe real situation in the past and explain how they responded. **Working interview**, in which the candidate is asked to perform the actual work that he or she would be doing on the job.

9.3 Pre-Employment Testing

Pre-Employment tests attempt to provide objective, quantitative information about a candidate's skills, attitudes, and habits. Here is an overview of the most common types of tests:

Integrity tests: You might not think that a test could identify job candidates who are more likely to steal from their employers or commit other ethical or legal infractions, but employers have had some success in using integrity test.

Personality tests: Personality tests are used to assess either general character or suitability for the demands of a specific profession. The specific tests evaluate whether a candidate is suited to the emotional rigors of demanding positions, such as flight crews, air marshals, police and fire services, and nuclear power plant operators (in fact, federal law requires such tests for certain positions).

Job skills test: The most common types of pre-employment tests are those designed to assess the competency or specific abilities needed to perform a job.

Substance tests: Drug and alcohol testing is one of the most controversial issues in business today. Some employers believe such testing is absolutely necessary to maintain workplace safety, whereas others view it as an invasion of employee privacy and a sign of disrespect. Some companies test only applicants, but not employees.

Background checks: Although not a test in the usual sense, a background check also helps employers learn more about you. And while drug testing may be waning slightly, the use of background checks has been growing rapidly; 80 percent of U.S. employers now conduct criminal background checks, for instance.

9.4 Employer's Expectation

Interviews can be very stressful, but the best way to overcome this is to be prepared and know what employers are looking for:

- Job candidates with a definite idea of their goals, objectives, strengths, and skills.
- Candidates who are knowledgeable about the position they are interviewing for, the company and its products, and the industry overall.
- Candidates who can match their own skills and experiences with the needs of the company.
- Candidates who are confident in themselves and their ability to contribute to the company.

- Candidates who can discuss past experiences and give specific examples that demonstrate their skills and accomplishments.

9.5 Interview Guidelines

Here are a few suggestions on how to approach the interview process:

- **Research the company.** It is good to become familiar with the organization, the position and the person who may be your boss. Try to match your skills and experience to the position you are seeking.
- **Look good.** First impressions are lasting, so make it count. Projecting a confident and professional image is essential. Dress professionally, but don't overdo it with jewelry or excessive perfume or cologne.
- **Know the location of the interview.** Consider driving/ arriving at the location in advance. Rushing around trying to find the facility can add to your nervousness.
- **Know your resume.** Be prepared to discuss and defend every aspect of your education and career experience.
- **Focus more on the interview, less on the job.** There's time to evaluate the job and whether you want it after the interviewer has learned about you. For now, your goal is to get invited back for a second interview or an offer. Then you can decide if the job is just what you want.
- **Talk about your previous contributions.** Prospective employers are interested in knowing how you made a difference in your previous job. In a way, you need to convince the interviewer that you're the answer to the company's needs.
- **Look for ways to sell yourself.** Seize opportunities to tell the prospective employer how good you are. Be careful not to boast, but speak confidently about your skills.
- **Don't overdo it.** Choose your words carefully and don't talk too much. Most people only retain 20 percent of what they hear. Select your words, speak clearly and get to the point.
- **Avoid fear by visualizing the interview.** It's just an interview, not the gallows, so imagine the experience in advance. Try to visualize various things like your clothing, items to bring, physical presentation, eye contact, body language, etc.
- **Listen carefully.** Pause briefly after each question before you respond to be sure the interviewer has finished speaking. Answer questions directly and concisely. If you don't understand, ask for clarification.

- **Bring your questions.** You also are interviewing the company, too. Start with questions about the organization and move to career growth, working conditions, etc. Save benefits and compensation for last.
- **Write down important data.** Get the names and titles of the people with whom you interview. Be sure the spelling is correct, as you may need the information later.
- **Don't run away.** After the interview, don't just hop up and head down the hall. Try to leave a good final impression by letting the interviewer know you really want the job and that you're ready to move to the next step in the employment process. If that doesn't feel right, simply ask about the next step in the process.
- **Obtain resources.** Grab an annual report, product information or other data that will give you a better picture of the company and the kind of work you might be doing.
- **Don't become invisible.** Following the interview there is a way in which you can be contacted, even if you are out of town.

9.7 Common Questions' Answer

Here is a list of the repeated questions that relate to almost any type of job. Please note that an interviewer may also ask questions that relate to the specific position that you are applying for.

Tell something about yourself.

The most often asked question in interviews. You need to have a short statement prepared in your mind. Be careful that it does not sound rehearsed. Limit it to work-related items unless instructed otherwise. Talk about things you have done and jobs you have held that relate to the position you are interviewing for. Start with the item farthest back and work up to the present. Since this is often the opening question in an interview, be extra careful that you don't run off at the mouth. Keep your answer to a minute or two at most. Cover five topics including personal introduction, early years, education, work history, and recent career experience. Emphasize this last subject. Remember that this is likely to be a warm-up question. Don't waste your best points on it.

What is your greatest / best strength? Or, what is your strength?

For this question numerous answers are good, just stay positive. A few good examples may be a) Your ability to prioritize, b) Your problem-solving skills, c) Your ability to work under pressure, d) Your ability to focus on projects, e) your professional expertise, f) your leadership skills, g) your positive attitude towards works etc., in addition to your strong academic background.

Tell something about your weakness. Or what are your weaknesses?

The interviewer who asks this question is looking to see how honest you are with yourself, and how well you deal with your own shortcomings. Bit of a tricky question this, after all no one wants to show their weaknesses but we all have them. Don't pretend you don't have weaknesses, and don't avoid answering the question. This is your chance to show that you are honest and take responsibility for your actions. A good way to answer this question is to mention your weakness, then tell what you have done to overcome that weakness. If you have been disorganized in the past, you could say, "I used to be much disorganized, always forgetting assignments and birthdays. But I managed to work out a computerized system of to-do lists and reminders that keeps me on top of everything. "You could also say, I don't have straight way transport or bus service from my residence to the office. So, during the rainy days I had difficulties in finding a rickshaw to reach the bus stop and I would get late, occasionally. Now on the raining days, I get up earlier in the morning and rush out to my office to reach on time." The most comprehensive way of dealing with this question is to try and turn it into a "positive" from a "negative".

What do you know about this organization?

This question is one reason to do some research on the organization before the interview. Find out where they have been and where they are going. You should be able to discuss products or services, revenues, reputation, image, goals, problems, management style, people, history and philosophy. But don't act as if you know everything about the place. Let your answer show that you have taken the time to do some research, but don't try to overwhelm the interviewer, and make it clear that you wish to learn more. You might start your answer in this manner: "In my job search, I've investigated a number of companies. Yours is one of the few that interests me, for these reasons..." Give your answer a positive tone. Don't say, "Well, everyone tells me that you're in all sorts of trouble, and that's why I'm here", even if that is why you're there.

Why do you want to work for this organization?

This may take some thought and certainly, should be based on the research you have done on the organization. Sincerity is extremely important here and will easily be sensed. Relate it to your long-term career goals.

How do you handle stress and pressure?

A typical interview question, asked to get a sense of how you handle on-the-job stress, is 'How do you handle pressure?' Examples of good responses include:

- Stress is very important to me. With stress, I do the best possible job. The appropriate way to deal with stress is to make sure I have the correct balance between good stress and bad stress. I need good stress to stay motivated and productive.
- I react to situations, rather than to stress. That way, the situation is handled and doesn't become stressful.
- I actually work better under pressure and I've found that I enjoy working in a challenging environment.
- From a personal perspective, I manage stress by visiting the gym/ walking a mile every evening. It's a great stress reducer.
- Prioritizing my responsibilities so I have a clear idea of what needs to be done when has helped me effectively manage pressure on the job.
- If the people I am managing are contributing to my stress level, I discuss options for better handling difficult situations with them.

Why did you leave your last job?

Stay positive regardless of the circumstances. Never refer to a major problem with management and never speak ill of supervisors, co-workers or the organization. If you do, you will be the one looking bad. Keep smiling and talk about leaving for a positive reason such as an opportunity, a chance to do something special or other forward-looking reasons.

What experience do you have in this field?

Speak about specifics that relate to the position you are applying for. If you do not have specific experience, get as close as you can.

What kind of salary do you need?

A nasty little game that you will probably lose if you answer first. So, do not answer it. Instead, say something like, "that's a tough question. Can you tell me the range for this position?" In most cases, the interviewer, taken off guard, will tell you. If not, say that it can depend on the details of the job. Then give a wide range. If you are asked the question during an initial screening interview, you might say that you feel you need to know more about the position's responsibilities before you could give a meaningful answer to that question. Here, too, either by asking the interviewer or 'Executive Search firm' (if one is involved), or in research done as part of your homework, you can try to find out whether there is a salary grade attached to the job. If there is, and if you can live with it, say that the range seems right to you. But whenever possible, say as little as you can about salary until you reach the "final" stage of the interview process. At that point, you know that the

company is genuinely interested in you and that it is likely to be flexible in salary negotiations.

9.8 Questions to ask the Interviewer

- What are the job's major responsibilities?
- What qualities do you want in the person who fills this position?
- How do you measure success for someone in this position?
- What is the first problem that needs the attention of the person you hire?
- Would relocation be required now or in the future?
- Why is this job now vacant?
- What makes your organization different from others in the industry?
- How would you define your organization's managerial philosophy?
- What additional training does your organization provide?
- Do employees have an opportunity to continue their education with help from the organization?

9.9 Positive Impression in Job interviews

The Warm-Up

- Stay on your toes; even initial small talk is part of the interviewing process.
- Greet the interviewer by name, with a smile and direct eye contact.
- Offer a firm (not crushing) handshake if the interviewer extends a hand
- Take a seat only after the interviewer invites you to sit or has taken his or her own seat.
- Listen for cues about what the questions are trying to reveal about you and your qualifications.

The Question-and-Answer Stage

- Let the interviewer lead the conversation.
- Never answer a question before the interviewer finishes asking it.
- Listen carefully to the interviewer and watch for nonverbal signals.
- Don't limit yourself to simple yes or no answers; expand on the answer to show your knowledge of the company (but don't ramble on).
- If you encounter a potentially discriminatory question, decide how you want to respond before you say anything.
- When you have the opportunity, ask questions from the list you've prepared; remember that interviewers expect you to ask questions.

The Close

- Watch and listen for signs that the interview is about to end.
- Quickly evaluate how well you've done and correct any misperceptions the interviewer might have.
- If you receive an offer and aren't ready to decide, it's entirely appropriate to ask for time to think about it.
- Don't bring up salary, but be prepared to discuss it if the interviewer raises the subject.
- End with a warm smile and a handshake, and thank the interviewer for meeting with you.

9.10 Days before the Interview

Launch your preparation by finding out as much about the company as possible. Try to find the company's website (if any) which is likely to be full of background information, history and up-to-date news. Drop the information into conversation at your interview. Prepare your 60-second personal statement: Your answer to the, "Tell me about yourself," question. Write at least five success stories to answer behavioral interview questions. One way to do this is by mind mapping - write down a question that occurs to you and think about how you'd answer it positively. ("Tell me about a time when..." or "Give me an example of a time..."). List questions to ask the interviewer about the job, the company and the industry (Anything you want to know about us?)

9.11 Before You Go to the Interview

- Do you look professional? Check yourself in the mirror; part of your confidence will come from looking good.
- Carry these items to the interview:
 - Several copies of your resume on quality paper.
 - A copy of your references.
 - A pad of paper on which to take notes (notes are optional).

9.12 Upon Arrival

- **Arrive early**

Enter the building 10 minutes before your appointment. Start from your place with at least one hour in hand. Thanks to the terrible street jams of this city.
- **Review your prepared stories and answers**

The Recruitment Team's sole responsibility is to ensure that each interview serves a clearly defined and distinct purpose. A job-hunter has to face a testing of his intellectual capacity and management skills and personality. Think beforehand about the questions that are likely to come up.

- **Go to the restroom and check your appearance one last time.**
- **Announce yourself to the receptionist in a professional manner.**
- **Stand and greet your interviewer with a hearty -- not bone-crushing -- handshake.**
- **Smile and look into the interviewer's eyes.**

9.13 During the Interview

- Try to focus on the points you have prepared without sounding rehearsed or stiff.
- Relax and enjoy the conversation. Learn what you can about the company.
- Ask questions and listen; read between the lines.
- At the conclusion, thank the interviewer and determine the next steps.

9.14 The Close

Concluding Gracefully:

Conclude the interview with courtesy and enthusiasm.

Discussing Salary:

Research salary ranges in your job, industry, and geographic region before you try to negotiate salary.

Interview Notes:

Keep a written record of your job interviews, and keep them organized so that you can compare companies and opportunities.

9.15 After the Interview

So now what will you do? Silently weep with the feelings in your mind, "all are lost" or have confidence about the next call-up and keep on applying to other prospective vacancies. By the way don't forget to write a follow-up thank-you letter, reminding the interviewer of your qualities.

9.16 Follow up Message

A follow up message after an interview is more than a professional courtesy; it is another chance to promote yourself to an employer.

Thanks for Interview

Again, keep your name on a potential employer's desk and in her mind. Demonstrating manner is a persuasive tool for obtaining a job, too.

May 7, 2017

Md. Martoza

Human Resource Department

National Bank tld.

Dear Sir:

Thank you for the interview today. I appreciate your consideration of my qualifications and application for the job of escrow representative. I will check in with you next Monday to see if you have made a decision about the position. If I can answer any questions or concerns, please call me at 02-44468, mornings, if possible. Thank you again for your interest.

Sincerely,

Kamul Islam

Message of Inquiry

If you are not advised of the interview's decision by the promised date or within two weeks, you might make an inquiry. A message of inquiry is particularly appropriate if you have received a job offer from a second firm and do not want to accept it before you have an answer from the first.

Dear Sir:

When we talked on April 07 about the Fashion coordinator position in your Park Avenue showroom, you indicated that a decision would be made by May 1. I am still enthusiastic about the position and eager to know what conclusion you have reached.

To complicate matters, another firm has now offered me a position and has asked that I reply within the next two weeks.

Because, your company seems to offer a greater challenge, I would appreciate knowing about your decision by Thursday, May 12. If you need more information before then, please let me know.

Sincerely,

Md. Shahidul Islam

Request for Time Extension

If you receive a job offer while other interviews are still pending, you can ask the employer for a time extension. Open with a strong statement of your continued interest in the job, ask for a more time to consider the offer, provide specific reasons for request and assure the reader that you will respond by specific date.

Dear Sir:

The e-commerce director position at Lone Star Food is an exciting challenge and I am glad that you offered me the position. Because of another commitment, I would appreciate your giving me until January 25 to make a decision. Before your interview, I scheduled a follow up interview with another company. I am interested in your organization because of its commitment to quality and team based management style, but I do feel obligated to keep my appointment.

If you need my decision immediately, I certainly understand. However, if you can allow me the added time to fulfill this earlier commitment, I would be grateful. Please let me know at your earliest convenience.

Sincerely,

Tareq Hossain

9.17 Other Job Related Correspondences

Invitation for an Interview

Arrange appointment specifications for easy, quick visual access. This letter can set the tone for the actual interview.

March 5, 2017

Md. Reazul Islam,
43, Uttara -4, Dhaka.

Dear Mr. Islam:

Thank you for your application for the position of communications director. We are pleased to invite you to be interviewed for the position. Your interview has been scheduled as follows:

Date: March 17, 2017

Time: 11:15 a.m.

Location: Conference Room, level-4, 5, S. R. Tower, Uttara-7, Dhaka

You can expect to meet with the committee for 30 to 45 minutes. If you have any questions, please contact me at 02-542477. Again, thank you for your interest in the position.

Sincerely,

Md. Abdur Rakib

Head, HRD

Job Offers

These letters are used to offer a position to a potential employee and should be treated as a legal contract. Be clear that the offer is formal and official. It should outline all of the essential information the potential employee needs to make a decision. It is fine to make the informal offer by telephone and then follow up at once with a formal letter. Be sure to make the potential employee feel welcome.

Letter of Offer (Template)

REF NO: COMPANY NAME/DEPT/MMYY/OFFER NO>

DD MM YYYY

Candidate Full Name

Address

Sub: Job offer

Dear Mr/Ms<Candidate Last Name>

We are pleased to offer you the position of <**Designation**> in our < **Name of Function**> based at<**Location of Posting**>.

Your immediate supervisor will be<**Name of Reporting Manager**>. We trust that your knowledge, skills and experience will be among our most valuable assets.

As discussed and agreed with you, you will be eligible to receive the following beginning on your joining date:

- **Salary:** Annual gross starting salary of **Rs.< Annual CTC>**, subject to tax and other statutory deductions
- **Sales Incentive:** As per the prevailing company scheme < **Only Applicable for Sales personnel**>
- Business Travel allowance and reimbursements as per company policy.

This offer letter is valid till < Expected date of joining>. Please send a signed copy of this letter indicating your acceptance to join and resignation acceptance letter from your current employer to our HR.

Your Appointment Letter will be issued on the date of joining. The joining formalities and induction will be carried out in our <**Location**> **office**.

Please submit the following documents to HR at the time of your joining: (1) photocopies of your degree certificates, (2) certifications, if any, (3) experience/ relieving letters (4) two color passport-size photos, (5) latest salary slip from your previous organization and (6) proof of address.

We look forward to welcome you aboard.

Sincerely,

For <**Name of the Organization**>

<Designation>

Letter of Acceptance

Begin by accepting the position and expressing thanks. Identify the job you are accepting. Conclude by saying that you look forward to reporting for work. Be aware that a job offer and a written acceptance of that offer can constitute a legally binding contract for both you and the employer. Before you send an acceptance letter, be sure you want the job.

July 15, 2017

Mohammad Mominul Islam,
Human Resources Manager,
Sun Trading Corporation
22, Banani, Dhaka
Bangladesh.

Dear Sir:

With great pleasure, I officially accept your offer to join Sun Trading Co. Consulting as a Research Analyst. As stated during our telephone conversation on July 6, 2017, I understand the monthly salary will be Tk. 35000.

I will be reporting to work on July 24, 2017, at 8:30 a.m. as agreed upon in our last discussion. I look forward to working with you and your staff.

Sincerely,

Sk.Kamal

Letter declining a job offer

Use the technique for negative messages: open warmly, state the reasons for refusing the offer, decline the offer explicitly and close on a pleasant note, expressing gratitude. By taking the time to write a sincere, tactful letter, you have the door open for future contact.

July 15, 2007

Mohammad Mominul Islam,
Human Resources Manager,
Sun Trading Corporation
22, Banani, Dhaka
Bangladesh.

Dear Sir:

Thank you for offering me the PC Analyst position with your organization. After careful consideration, I have decided to accept another opportunity that will allow me to utilize my project management skills.

I truly appreciate the time you, as well as the members of your staff, set aside to meet with me. It appears that Sun Trading Co. is situated for potential growth in the industry. I wish you every success with your expansion plans.

Sincerely,

Md. Kamrul Islam

Appointment Letter-Permanent (Template)

<REF NO: COMPANY/DEPT/MMYY/APPT NO>

7thSeptember, 2012

<Title. Name of the Employee>

<Residential Address>

Subject: Letter of Appointment

Dear Mr.

This has reference to your application and subsequent interviews you have had with <company name>. We are pleased to appoint you as <Designation> in its <Name of Function> function based at <Location of Posting>. Your employment will be governed by the following terms and conditions:

1. Monthly Gross Salary

You will be paid a monthly gross salary of Tk.. _____/-(Taka _____Only) per month.

2. Working Hours

Your working hours will be 10 am to 6:30 pm as per the current company policy. The company observes a 6 day work week.

3. Date of Appointment

Your date of appointment as per company records is _____.

4. Salary Increase

Increase in your salary will be reviewed periodically as per the policy of the Company. Increments in the salary range will be on the basis of demonstrated results and effectiveness of performance during the period of review.

5. Probation Period

You will be on probation for a period of **six months** from the date of your appointment. On satisfactory completion of the probation period, you will be confirmed in service.

If not confirmed after six months, this order will continue to be in operation, and the probation period will stand extended automatically till further notice.

6. Leave

You will be governed by the current Leave Policy of the company for permanent employees

7. Travel

Whenever you are required to undertake travel on Company work, you will be reimbursed travel expenses as per Company rules.

8. Responsibilities

In view of your office, you must effectively perform to ensure results. Your performance would be reviewed as per the Company's Performance Management System.

9. Retirement Age

The normal retirement age for all employees is **60 years**.

10. Notice Period

While on probation, this appointment may be terminated by either side by giving **seven days notice**, or **seven days salary in lieu of notice period**.

On confirmation, this appointment may be terminated by either side by giving **one months'** notice or **one months'** salary in lieu of notice period.

Should you resign after confirmation, the Company will have the option to accept your resignation either with immediate effect, and pay you three months' salary in lieu of notice period or accept it effective any day up to the end of the notice period and pay you salary for the remaining period from the acceptance of resignation till the end of the notice period.

11. Transfer

You will be liable to be transferred to any other department or establishment or branch or subsidiary of the Company in India or abroad. In such a case, you will be governed by the terms and conditions of service as applicable to the new assignment.

12. Other work

Your position with the Company calls for whole time employment and you will devote yourself exclusively to the business of the Company. You will not take up any other work for remuneration (part time or otherwise) or work on advisory capacity or be interested directly or indirectly (except as shareholder or debenture holder) in any other trade or business during your employment with the Company, without written permission from the Company.

13. *Conflict of Interest*

You will not seek full time or part time job or be involved in any way with competitor's business activities either directly or indirectly during your employment with the Company, and for a period of 12 months in the event of cessation of your employment with the Company.

14. *Confidential Information*

You will not, at any time, without the consent of the Company disclose or divulge or make public except under legal obligation, any information regarding Company's affairs of administration or research carried out, whether the same may be confided to you or become known to you, in the course of your service or otherwise.

15. *Contract/Bond with Previous Employers.*

It will be your personal responsibility to discharge all obligations arising out of any contract or bond with previous employers.

16. *On termination*

On termination of this contract, you will immediately give up to the Company all correspondence, specifications, formulae, books, documents, market data, cost data, literature, drawings, effect or records, etc. belonging to the Company or relating to its business and shall not make or retain any copies of these items.

17. *General*

The above terms and conditions are based on Company Policy, Procedures and other Rules and Regulations currently applicable to the Company's employees and are subject to amendments and adjustments from time to time.

Please communicate your acceptance of this appointment by signing a copy of this letter and returning it to us.

We welcome you to the <company name> family and trust we will have a long and mutually rewarding association.

Yours faithfully,

Appointment Letter- Contract(Template)

<REF NO: COMPANY/DEPT/MMYY/APPT NO>

<MM/DD/YYYY>

<Title. Name of the Employee>

<Residential Address>

Subject: Consultancy Assignment

Dear <first name>,

This has reference to your application and subsequent interviews you have had with us. We are pleased to offer you a Consultancy assignment in our <Company Name> based at <site name>, with effect from <MM/DD/YYYY>, on the following terms and conditions.

The Company undertakes <describe nature of projects / assignments> at various locations and you are being engaged for the <name of customer and project>, based at <location>, on the following terms & conditions:

Scope of Work

You will be responsible for:

<Key Responsibility Area 1, Area 2 etc>

Management reserves the right of changing the scope of your work or your posting based on business exigencies.

A. Terms

1. This contract will be valid for <define tenure> with effect from <DD/MM/YYYY> or on completion of <describe site duration>, whichever is earlier.
2. You would be paid monthly consultancy fees of Tk.. ____/- (taka in words) per month subject to TDS.
3. Inland Travel: You will be entitled for <define travel fare limit> or <upper limit of travel fare> or equivalent for Business travels. You would stay at company transit houses wherever available. You would be paid a daily boarding allowance of Tk.. ____/- from which expenses towards meals would be deducted. If you stay with relatives or friends you would be paid an additional amount of Tk. ____/- per day. If required to stay in hotel the daily limit for reimbursement would be Tk. ____/-
4. You would be reimbursed the cost of any official long distance calls made by you upon submission of bills.

5. You are expected to work for _____ days in a year and you should inform your non availability in advance.
6. During the course of your employment with <Company Name>, you will be required to abide by <Company Name>, code of conduct as detailed out in Annexure A. Non-compliance to the code of conduct will lead to termination without notice and the management may (depending on the nature of violation) proceed with legal lawsuit.

The contract may be terminated with one month's notice from either side or on payment of one month's salary. **< The period will be 3 months for senior personnel like sales Head, Operations Head, Factory Manager>**

B. Confidentiality of Information

1. You will not divulge information about the company, customer, and progress of the project to any outsider without prior approval from your supervising manager.
2. You will not undertake similar assignments from competitors of the <Company Name>, during the course of this contract.

You will take utmost care during the course of this contract in handling business information of sensitive nature to maintain its secrecy.

C. Reporting

You are required to inform the progress of your work to <Name & Designation of reporting supervisor>

Kindly communicate your acceptance of this contract by signing a copy of this letter and returning it to us.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely

For <Company Name>

Managing Director

CC: Accounts Manager

Accepted by :<name of candidate>

Signature of the Candidate :<signature>

Date:

Location:

Joining Letter

March 16, 2017,

The Chairman,

Board of Trustee,

BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology (BUFT),

Dhaka.

Subject: Joining as an Associate Professor (Business Studies)

Dear Sir:

I have the honor to inform you that I am joining as an Associate Professor (Business Studies) from today (March 16, 2017) in respect to your appointment letter dated March 12, 2017, Ref. no. BUFT/Faculty-1/17/633.

I hope that you would be kind enough to accept my joining letter. Thank you for your confidence in me. I will do my best to surpass the challenge presented by BUFT's phenomenal growth.

Sincerely,

.....

Dr. Mohammad Shahidul Islam

Confirmation Letter(Template)

<REF NO: COMPANY NAME/DEPT/MMYYYY/EMPLOYEE NO>

MM DD,YYYY

<Name of the employee>

<Location>

Dear <Employee Name>

Consequent to your probation review for the period _____ to _____, we are pleased to confirm your services in the organization w.e.f _____.

You will now be entitled for <mention benefits / allowances if any>. All other terms and conditions as detailed in your appointment letter remain unchanged.

We look forward to your valuable contributions and wish you all the very best for a rewarding career with<Company Name>

Note: Please sign the duplicate copy of this letter as a token of acceptance of the same.

For,

<Name of the Company>

<Name of authorized signatory><Designation>

Character Reference

Similar to the letter of recommendation, the character reference refers only to the character of the person. You should include your relationship with the person and how long you have known her.

May 29, 2017

Star Employment Agency

22 Uttara-7,

Dhaka-1230.

Dear Sir :

I am most pleased to write a character reference for Abdur Rakib. I have known Abdur Rakib since I first moved to Dhaka. As a Councilor of Uttara, I have been able to watch Abdur Rakib mature into the fine young boy he is today. He is a tireless worker, having given the most volunteer hours of any of our young adults in the parish. He is always cheerful and dependable. I am sure that whoever hires him will find him to be a good worker as well as a pleasant person. He is truly a gem.

Sincerely,

Md. Ariful Islam

Councilor, Uttara-7,

Dhaka.

Letter of Recommendation

Letters of recommendation emphasize how a person worked on a previous job and her expertise. They should also include the relationship between the one seeking the job and the

person writing the recommendation, and the length of the acquaintance. Don't hesitate to be enthusiastic, but be sure the candidate can live up to your comments.

January 16, 2017

Helal Uddin,
Principal, Holy Child High School
78, Uttara-4, Dhaka-1213.

Dear Mr. Uddin:

It is with great pleasure that I recommend Motiur Rahman for the physics position at Holy Child School. Mr. Motiur taught at Sun Light High School from 1999 to 2005, during which time I was principal. His primary teaching responsibilities were physics, chemistry and ninth-grade general science. He was one of the best teachers we have ever had in the area of science, and we were deeply saddened when he and his family moved to Dhaka. I can assure you that if I had a teaching position open in science, I would hire him. He is creative, deeply conscientious, professional and hard-working.

I strongly recommend him and am sure you will be more than satisfied with his performance in the classroom.

Sincerely,

Mijanur Rahman,
Principal

Experience Letter

October 02, 2017

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that **Mr. Rabiul Islam** was in employment with us from January 01, 2012 **to December 31, 2014**. During this period, he was working as a section officer and I have found him to be sincere and hardworking with high integrity.

I wish him all the best for his future endeavors.

Dr. Md. Shahidul Islam

Head, School of Business

Letter of Resignation

Letter of resignation should always be written in a gracious and professional style that avoids criticism of your employer or your colleagues.

July 15, 2017

Mr. Md. Abul Kalam

Human Resources Manager

Sun Trading Co.

22, Banani, Dhaka

Bangladesh

Dear Sir:

This letter serves as official notification of my resignation from Sun Trading Co., effective from today. Thank you for your guidance and support while working as your Marketing Manager; I appreciate the Sum Trading Co. has made in my career over the past five years.

I have accepted an offer with another company and plan on starting my new position in two weeks. As a result, my last day of employment with Sun Trading will be July 26, 2017. I came to this decision because I want to pursue opportunities in e-commerce, which I believe will advance my career.

I will work with you to turn over my responsibilities as soon as possible. Once again, I would like to thank you for your support and the fine years I spent with your organization. I wish you continued success.

Sincerely,

Md. Hasan Imam

Positive Resignation: When you must “move on” to accept new opportunities, use this sample to guide the draft of your resignation. It can be very brief, basically providing a formal notice for documentation purposes. Or, it may provide an explanation. Employers appreciate understanding the situation.

February 2, 2017

Mr. Md. Abul Kalam
Human Resources Manager
Sun Trading Co.
22, Banani, Dhaka
Bangladesh

Dear Sir:

With deep regret and with some excitement, I must resign as night shift supervisor, effective March 1, 2017. My family will be relocating to Chittagong this spring so my wife can pursue a lucrative offer in a law firm. This is an opportunity we cannot overlook. I will be glad to assist in the training of my replacement. Our night shift has a couple of competent workers who would make excellent shift supervisors. Your encouragement during the past nine years has allowed me to grow in my responsibilities and capabilities. Thank you for these successful years. I will miss you as well as all my other friends at Sun Trading Co. Your leadership provides me with many fond memories. I wish you continued success.

Sincerely,

Jony Ray

Negative Resignation: When you must leave a position under duress or stress, keep your explanation short, honest and positive. Never write a resignation letter when you're angry. Remember the adage: “Don't burn bridges.” The goal is to state any serious conflict calmly, rationally and gracefully. Despite your differences, you may need a reference from this employer in the future.

July 14, 2016

Md. Abul Kalam
Human Resources Manager,

Sun Trading Co.
22, Banani, Dhaka
Bangladesh

Dear Sir:

I am resigning my position as special accounts representative, effective July 30, 2016. Recent circumstances incompatible with my personal values require that I change my employment. Thank you for the chance to work and learn at Sun Trading.

Sincerely,

Md. Kamrul Islam

Relieving Letter

REF NO: COMPANY NAME/DEPT/MMYYYY/EMPLOYEE NO>

October 18, 2017

Masud Hasan
Lecturer,
Department of English

Sub: Relieving Letter

Dear Hasan:

We are in receipt of your resignation dated October 1, 2017. We have accepted your resignation and as per company policy you will be relieved with effect from October 30, 2017. We wish you all the best for your future endeavors.

Thanking you,

Registrar,
UITS, Dhaka

Part 4: Proposal and Report Development & Communications

Chapter 10: Report and Proposal Writing

10.1 Report Writing

Report is written accounts that objectively communicate information about some aspect of the business. Informational reports offer data, facts, feedback and other types of information, without analysis or recommendations. Analytical reports offer both information and analysis and they can also include recommendations. The purpose of conducting a research is to come out with inferences and suggestions.

10.2 Report Format:

I. Prefatory part

- a. Cover page
- b. Title fly
- c. Title page
- d. Student's Declaration
- e. Letter of Transmittal
- f. Official Certification
- g. Internship Certificate from Industry Supervisor
- h. Acknowledgements
- i. Table of Contents
- j. List of Illustrations
- k. Abbreviation and Connotation
- l. Executive Summary

II. Text

- a. Introduction
- b. Methodology
- c. Overview of the Organization
- d. Results and Discussions
- e. Commendations
- f. Conclusion

III. Supplementary part

- a. Appendix
- b. Bibliography/Reference

I. Prefatory part:

Prefatory parts are front-end materials that provide key preliminary information so that readers can decide whether and how to read the report

Cover page

- Title
- Submitted to: Name , Designation, Address
- Submitted by: Name Designation, Address
- Date of Submission
- Institution

**Dividend Practices in Corporate Sector of
Bangladesh: A Study on the Companies Listed
with Dhaka Stock Exchange**

*Submitted in accordance with the requirement for the degree
of Master of Business Administration*

Under the Supervision of

Professor Dr. M. Farid Ahmed

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka

&

Professor Dr. H.M. Mosarof Hossain

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka

By

Mohammad Shahidul Islam

Registration No. 34, Session: 2011-12

December 6, 2015

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka
Dhaka, Bangladesh

Title fly: The title fly is a single sheet of paper with only the title of the report on it.

Dividend Practices in Corporate Sector of Bangladesh: A Study on the Companies Listed with Dhaka Stock Exchange

Title page: The title page includes the five blocks for information.

-title

-prepared for or submitted to(name, designation, address)

-Prepared by or submitted by(name, designation, address)

-Date of Submission

-Institution

Master Thesis

ON

Dividend Practices in Corporate Sector of Bangladesh: A Study on the Companies Listed with Dhaka Stock Exchange

Supervised by:

Professor Dr. M. Farid Ahmed

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka

Supervisor

&

Professor Dr. H.M. Mosarof Hossain

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka

Co-Supervisor

Submitted By:

Mohammad Shahidul Islam

Registration No. 34, Session: 2011-12

December 6, 2015

Department of Finance, University of Dhaka

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Letter of Authorization (optional)-is a document requesting that a report be prepared. If you received written authorization to prepare the report, you may want to

include that letter or memo in your report. This letter of authorization is a document you received, asking or directing you to prepare the report.

Student's Declaration: Student has to confess the report as an original one.

Student's Declaration

I, Md....., a student of MBA in Apparel Merchandising of 122 batch, ID:..... at the Department of Business Administration, BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology (BUFT), do hereby declare that the internship report on is a work done under the supervision of Dr....., Professor, Department of of BUFT. I also declare that this report is an original work and no part of this report has been copied from elsewhere. Furthermore, this report has not been published or submitted for being awarded any degree, diploma or recognition earlier.

Md.....

Program:

ID:

Batch:

Section:

Department of Business Administration

BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology (BUFT)

Official Certification: The supervisor has to accept the report with this official certification.

Official Certification

This is to certify that Md....., Program: MBA, Batch: 122, ID:..... has completed his/her internship report on under my supervision as a part of partial fulfillment of the requirements for the Degree of Master of Business Administration (MBA) in Apparel Merchandising in the Department of Business Administration of BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology. This report can be accepted for evaluation.

Dr.....

Professor/ Assistant Professor/ Lecturer

Department of Business Administration

BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology (BUFT)

Internship Certificate from Industry Supervisor: Student has to enclose the certificate of industry supervisor. Industry supervisor has to certify his presence and performance at the time of internship period.

Letter of Transmittal- Submission of the report

The letter of Transmittal, a specialized form of a cover letter, introduces your report to your audience. The letter of transmittal says what you had say if you were handing the report directly to the person who authorized it, so the style is often less formal than the rest of the report. In the body of the transmittal letter, you may also highlight important points or sections of the report, make comments on side issues, give suggestions for follow- up studies, and offer any details that will help readers understand and use the report. You may also want to acknowledge help given by others. The conclusion of the transmittal letter often includes a note of thanks for having been given the report assignment, an expression of willingness to discuss the report, and an offer to assist with future projects. If the report does not have a synopsis, the letter of transmittal may summarize the major findings, conclusion and recommendations.

Letter of Transmittal

April 10, 2016

Mr.Dr.....

Professor

Department of

BGMEA University of Fashion and Technology(BUFT)

Dhaka-1230

Subject: Letter of Transmittal.

Dear Sir,

With due respect, I want to state that I am submitting the attached report entitled..... as a partial requirement of the MBA/BBA degree.

This report is on In this report.....are discussed.

I pray and hope that you will kindly accept the report. I also hope that you will find this report as satisfactory.

Md.....

Program:

ID:

Batch:

Section:

Department of Business Administration

BGMEA University of Fashion & Technology (BUFT)

Table of Content

The table of contents indicates in outline from the coverage, sequence and relative importance of the information in the report. The headings used in the text of the report are the basis for the table of contents. Depending on the length and complexity of the report, you may need to decide how many levels of headings to show in the contents. The contents will begin from acknowledgments.

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List of Illustrations: You have to include the title and page number of the tables and figures.

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Abbreviation &Notation

Abbreviations

AR= Abnormal Return
 AGE= Age of the firm
 AGM=Annual General Meeting
 MPS= Market price per share
 OWN(Sponsor)=Sponsor Ownership
 OWN(INST)=Institutional Ownership
 OWN(INDV)=Individual Ownership
 OLS= Ordinary least square
 PE=Price earnings ratio

Notations

R^2 = Co-efficient of multiple determination

t= t- test

F=F test

Acknowledgement

In the process of carrying out any research, the researcher would have received help from different persons, and organizations. So, all those helps should be acknowledged under this heading. A list of people who are to be acknowledged is as follows:

Research Supervisor, Organizational head, Colleagues, The executive of different organizations who provided data and literature for the research, The typesetting personnel

Acknowledgements

I would like to gratefully and sincerely thank all the great people who have supported me during my journey of Master Thesis, to only some of whom it is possible to give particular mention here.

I am most grateful to my supervisors, **Professor Dr. M Farid Ahmed and Professor Dr. H.M. Mosarof Hossain**, who have been a steady influence throughout my thesis, for their kindness, patience, and most importantly, their persistent support. Their high academic standards, hard work, and great achievements have set an example to me. This doctoral thesis would not have been possible without their exceptional guidance and inspiration. They have always been encouraging me at times of innovative ideas and challenging issues. In particular, they went through several drafts, corrected errors, and provided numerous constructive comments relating to the style and the substance of my thesis. For any errors or inadequacies that may remain in this work, of course, the responsibility is entirely my own.

I also thank the Department of Finance for providing me with the opportunity to complete my doctoral research. I would like to acknowledge officers of DSE who provided me with help and assistance from time to time with smiles on their faces.

I must present my greatest thanks to my wife Sarah Islam, who is the most important person in my life, for her changeless love, quiet patience and unwavering support during the past years. She told me to trust myself and not to give up when sometimes I was in a fragile state. I persisted because I knew she awaited me ahead with our dear son in her arms. My motivation also comes from all the rest of my family members, my parents, who make me feel warm all the times.

Executive Summary

Whereas a synopsis is a prose table of contents that outlines the main points of the report, an executive summary is a fully developed mini version of the report itself. Executive summaries are more comprehensive than a synopsis. Executive summary is intended for readers who lack the time or motivation to study the complete text. As a general rule, keep the length of an executive summary proportionate to the length of the report. A brief business report may have only a one page executive summary. Longer business reports may have a two or three page summary. It includes the brief description of the following issues:

- Problem statement, Objectives, Methodology, Results, and Recommendations

Example of Executive Summary:

**Growth and Development of Corporate Bond Market in Bangladesh:
Impediment Factors Analysis**

The Development of bond market is a precondition for the development of stock market. The Corporate bond market is insignificant share in the bond market of Bangladesh. The present study has been undertaken in order to identify the impeding factors of growth and development of Corporate bond market by employing sophisticated multivariate technique-Varimax Rotated Factor Analytical Technique. The study has collected and used only primary data, secondary data, and consulted available literature for designing the questionnaire. It has been found from the analysis the average market capital of corporate bond and debenture is tk. 1475128929. The share of corporate bond and debenture to total market capitalization is 0.29%. The growth in share of corporate bond to total market capital has been decreasing over the study period. The study has identified factors impede the development of corporate bond market in Bangladesh: Financial institutions and Interest rate Factor, Macroeconomic Environment Factor, Market oriented Factor, Informational Factor, Regulatory and Policy formation Factor, Bench mark bond factor.. The study has suggested some policy like introducing bench mark bond for investment, reducing dominance of banking system, flotation cost, political instability, making regulatory reform for development of corporate bond market.

II. Text

A. Introduction

a. Prelude: The origin and the development of the report concept along with the most significant contributions in the past are summarized.

b. Problem Statement: This section of the report gives the background to the problem, highlights the discussions with the decision makers. Problem statement focuses on the key

aspects of the problem and provides clear guidelines on how to proceed further. It describes the importance of the topic and what is to be done.

c. Objectives:

Based on the direction of the previous studies and problem statement, it should be clearly spell out the objectives of the report.

d. Scope: Scope represents the boundaries and beneficiaries of the report.

e. Limitations: The student has to mention the limitations while preparing report.

B. Methodology:

The section on research design should specify the details of how the research was conducted. This should include the nature of the research design adopted, information needed, data collection from secondary and primary sources, scaling techniques, questionnaire development and pretesting, sampling techniques.

- **Type of report :**(i.e. descriptive, analytical)
- **Types of data:** Primary data and Secondary data
- **Sources of Data:** It represents the data collection method and name of the sources.
- **Measurement and scaling:** The assignment of numbers or other symbols to characteristics of objects according to certain pre-specified (measurement).The generation of a continuum upon which measured objects are located(scaling)
- **Sample Design:** What was the target population? What sampling frame was used? What sample units were used? How were they selected?
- **Analysis of Data:** It describes the plan for data analysis. This section includes statistical tools and techniques.

C. Literature Review (for thesis or project):

This helps the researcher avoid reinventing past contributions and results. This focuses on the past literature in the field of research and its classification under different angles. The critique comparison of the past literatures will narrow down the research topic and provide a base for selecting a research topic which will have more payoffs. The outcome of the literature review gives a direction for future research.

D. Overview of the Organization: The following issues are included in this chapter:

Historical Background, Mission and Vision, Orgranogram, Features, Functions, Capital of the Organization, Departments etc.

E. Results and Discussions

It consists of the major sections or chapter with various headings that present, analyze and interpret the findings gathered as a part of your investigation. These chapters contain the ‘proof’ and the detailed information necessary to support your conclusion and recommendation. It is written with fulfillment of each objective.

F. Recommendations: On the basis of the findings, it is own recommendations of the researcher.

G. Conclusion: This chapter includes summarized research findings, contribution of the study, limitation of the study, and scope for the future research.

III. Supplementary Part

a. Reference

To fulfill your ethical and logical obligation to credit other people for their work and to assist readers who may want to research your topic further, include a bibliography, a list of secondary sources you consulted when preparing your report. Each and every work is based on a set of literatures which forms the foundation for the research theme. So, bibliography is an alphabetical catalogue of different literatures which are used in the research. The reference can be classified into journal books, magazine, newspaper, research studied.

Mainly there are two format of writing reference:

APA- American Psychological Association

MLA –Modern Language Association

The Chicago Manual of Style

b. Appendix: If there is any material whose absence within that chapter itself does not affect the follow of reading and grasp of the content, then it can be presented at the end of the report under the heading Appendices. The types of materials which are to be placed under appendices as listed below:

The format of a questionnaire, Original data, Some micro level chart and figures, Long Table, Organizational details, statistical formulas, financial statements and spread sheet. Each of the above items should be referred in the respective chapters.

10.3 Instructions

a. Size and Margin:

Paper: A4 size, one side print, **Font size-** Times new roman and 12 size in text, **Margins:** The left margin and the right margin of the report should be 1.5 inch and 1 inch respectively. Top margin -2 inch for special part and 1 inch for other. Bottom – 1 inch.

Heading:

Part title- All Capital, Larger-16/18 size, Pyramid style, bold

First level sub heading – all caps/16/14,bold

Second level –Initial cap-12/14 ,bold

Third level -12 bold

b. Spacing:

Spacing between lines: Single space- Table of content, Executive summary, Long quotation, Table, Reference list and Double/1.5 Spacing- other place.

Spacing within a sentence: The detailed of spacing within a sentence are summarized as follows:

<u>Description of item</u>	<u>Number of Spaces</u>
Between words	1
After a semicolon	1
After a colon	1
After a full stop	1
Before the first parenthesis or bracket	1
Between the first quotation mark and the very next word	0
Before and after a hyphen	0
Before and after a slash	0

c. Page Number:

Pagination: Acknowledgement to Executive Summary –Roman letter and Introduction to end – numeric. It may be in top right, or below middle or right (better).

There are three numbered sections in the thesis/dissertation:

1st Section: No page numbers - blank cover page and the approved by page

2nd Section: Lower case Roman numerals (i, ii, x) - All preliminary pages, including

- Title page (this is the first counted page, number not printed)
- A blank page or the Copyright page
- Abstract (not to exceed 350 words)
- Optional preface, dedication, acknowledgements, and (if applicable) permissions to quote from unpublished materials.
- Table of Contents
- List of graphs, charges, tables.
- List of illustrations.

3rd Section: Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3) - main section, including text composed of:

- Introduction
- Main body
- Back matter, composed of appendix, endnotes, glossary, and bibliography or References

d. Table and Figure:

Table is numbered and title at the top of the table and provided the sources below the table. Figure is numbered and title below the figures.

e. Foot notes and End notes:

Footnote and end note are a reference which is below of the page and end of the chapter given respectively. You have to place number or symbol as a superscript form at the line and explain it at footnote.

Footnote method: The traditional method of acknowledging a source is by foot noting the references at the bottom of the page on which the referenced text appears. This bibliographic footnote provides the complete reference. References are keyed with the text material by superscripts. Place the superscript number at the end of the borrowed material after punctuation. But write the superscript number at the beginning of writing a foot note without punctuation. The numbering sequence of the superscripts is consecutive by page, by chapter, or by whole work. The footnotes are single spaced and intended or blocked just as the text is formatted.

¹ Carson, N.R. (1998). *Psychology of behaviour*. London: Allyn & Bacon.

End note Method:

This method uses superscript numbers to locate secondary sources in the text then lists the citations at the end of the chapter or report.

¹ Hogg, M.A. & Vaughan G.M. (2008). *Social psychology*. Harlow: Prentice Hall.

f. Header and Footer:

In header, you can write the name of the chapter with right alignment and in footer you can write page numbering or any other instruction.

g. Numbering:

Materials are presented in the outline being divided into separate units of thought. The relationship among these units is shown by using a single numbering scheme throughout the

outline as well as in the report. Most commonly used schemes for this purpose are conventional or letter numbers and decimals.

Example:

- I. Introduction
 - A. Purpose
 - B. Procedures
 - II. Findings
 - A. Bond Market
 - 1. Government Bond
 - 2. Corporate Bond
- or

- 1. Introduction
 - 1.1 Purpose
 - 1.2 Procedures
- 2. Findings
 - 2.1 Bond Market
 - 2.1.1 Government Bond
 - 2.1.2 Corporate Bond

10.4 Proposal Writing

10.4.1 Definition

A proposal is an offer or a suggestion to perform some service or to do research. It is a document that presents information about plans to do something or suggests methods to solve the problem. Request for proposals (RFP) are the vehicles through which proposals are invited from a number of sources.

10.4.2 Classification of Proposal

Business proposals can be classified in three ways:

Administrative or Internal proposals: An administrative proposal is a document usually written within a business. This proposal persuades top management to spend money for solving some problems within the business so as to improve the conditions of the business.

Sales Proposals: Sales proposals seek to sell a company's goods or services to potential buyers for profit.

Research Proposals: A research proposal is a type of proposal that requests time and money to conduct research with a view to benefiting the business.

10.4.3 Components of a Formal Academic Research Proposal

TITLE Page

1.1 Background of the Study:

1.2 Problem Statement

1.3 Research Question

1.4 Theoretical Background: Previous Studies

1.5 Objectives

1.6 Hypotheses

1.7 Theoretical Model

1.8 Methodology

1.8.1 Source of data

1.8.2 Sample criteria and sample size, sample design, data collection procedure

1.8.2 Models and Variables

1.8.3 Methods

1.9 Significance of the study

1.10. Potential Implication of the Research

1.11 Potential Limitations of the Study

1.12 Conclusion

Reference

10.5 References

Academic writing requires the author to support their arguments with reference to other published work or experimental results/findings. A reference system will perform three essential tasks:

- Enable you to acknowledge other authors ideas and thereby avoid plagiarism.
- Enable a reader to quickly locate the source of the material you refer to so they can consult it if they wish.
- Indicate to the reader the scope and depth of your research.

The American Psychological Association (APA) style is a widely used referencing system to help you achieve these objectives.

The APA style involves two tasks:

- How you refer to other authors in the body of your text (in text citation).
- How you compile a list of reference sources at the end of your text (reference list).

Below is a list of some common citation types along with examples of how they are laid out within the APA referencing style guidelines.

Notation guide

REF = reference list

ITC = in text citation

Book with one author

REF: Author Last name, Initials (Year). *Title*. Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Carson, N.R. (1998). *Psychology of behaviour*. London: Allyn & Bacon.

ITC:

- Author Last name (year, page no)
- (Author Last name, year, page no.)

Example:

- Carson (1998, p.54) argues
- Another approach (Carson, 1998, p.54) highlighted....

Book with more than one author

REF: Author Last name, Initials & second author Last name, Initials. (Year). *Title*. Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Hogg, M.A. & Vaughan G.M. (2008). *Social psychology*. Harlow: Prentice Hall.

ITC:

- (First author Last name and second author Last name, year, page no)
- First author Last name and second author's Last name (year, page no)

Example:

- Hogg and Vaughan (2008, p.32) argue....

- As argued elsewhere (Hogg and Vaughan, 2008, p.32)....

N.B. If there are seven or more authors you may use the first author's Last name and et al. (e.g. Hogg et al., 1981) for an in text citation but you must list all authors in the reference list.

Book with a corporate author

REF: Name of corporate author (Year). *Title*. Place of publication: Publisher

Example: Economic and Social Research Institute. (2008). *ESRI research strategy 2008-2013: research for a changing Ireland*. Dublin: ESRI.

ITC:

- Name of corporate author (year)
- (Name of corporate author, year)

Example

- Economic and Social Research Institute (2008) highlight research....
- Research (Economic and Social Research Institute, 2008) highlighting other trends...

Book with an Editor

REF: Editor(s) Last name, Initials (Ed.). (Year). *Title*. Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Booth, D. (Ed.). (1994). *Rethinking social development: Theory, research and practice*. Essex: Longman.

ITC

- Editor(s) last name (year, page no)
- (Editor(s) Last name, year, page no)

Example

- Among the proposals in Booth (1994)
- Others (Booth, 1994) also proposed...

Chapter in an edited book

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Year) Title of chapter. In authors Initials, Last name (Ed.), *Title of book* (pages of chapter). Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Beiner, R.A., (2000). Arendt and Nationalism. In D.A. Villa (Ed.) *The Cambridge Companion to Hannah Arendt* (pp. 44- 64). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year, page no)
- (Author(s) Last name year, page no)

Example

- Villa (2000, p.46) argues....
- Another view (Villa, 2000, p.46) points out....

Print Journal article

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Year). Article title. *Journal title, volume number*, page numbers.

Example: Eisenberg, N. (2000). Emotion, regulation and moral development. *Journal of Asian Studies*, 55, 51-80.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year, page no)
- (Author(s) Last name year, page no)

Example

- Eisenberg (2000, p.60) took a different approach
- Another approach (Eisenberg, 2000, p.60) shows

E-journal article

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Year). Article title. [Electronic version] *Journal title, Volume*, Page numbers.

Example: Borsari, B., Carey, K. B. (2000) Effects of a Brief Motivational Intervention with College Student Drinkers. [Electronic version] *Journal of Consulting and Clinical Psychology*, 68 (4) 728-733.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year, page no)
- (Author(s) Last name year, page no)

Example

- Bosari and Carey (2000, p.730) show
- A different approach (Bosari and Carey, 2000, p.730) shows....

Print Newspaper article

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Year Month Day of publication). Article title. *Newspaper title*, Volume and/or Issue number (if applicable), pp. page numbers.

Example: Dempsey, A. (2003, August 19). A shoulder to lean on in the lonely crowd: Feet on the street, a new project by the Samaritans. *The Irish Times*, pp. 11.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year)
- (Author(s) Last name, year)

Example

- Dempsey (2003) wrote that
- An article (Dempsey, 2003) appeared at the time....

Online Newspaper article

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Year Month Day of publication). Article title.
Newspaper title. Retrieved from URL

Example: Kelly, M. (2010, May 22). Burden of Irish debt could yet eclipse that of Greece.
The Irish Times. Retrieved from

<http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/opinion/2010/0522/1224270888132.html>.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year)
- (Author(s) Last name, year)

Example

- Kelly (2010) wrote that....
- An article (Kelly, 2010) appeared at the time....

Website/ page on a website

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials. (Date published if available; n.d.--no date-- if not)

Title of article. *Title of web site*. Retrieved date. From URL.

Example: Gambill, G (April 6th 2011). Assad's survival strategy. *Foreign Policy*. Retrieved April 18th, 2011, from

http://www.foreignpolicy.com/articles/2011/04/06/assads_survival_strategy.

ITC

- Author(s) Last name (year)
- (Author(s) Last name, year)

Example

- Gambill (2011) argues....
- Another approach (Gambill, 2011) suggests....

Blogs

REF: Include the title of the message and the URL. Please note that titles for items in online communities (e.g. blogs, newsgroups, forums) are not italicized. If the author's name is not available, provide the screen name.

Example: J Dean. (2008, May 7). When the self emerges: Is that me in the mirror?
Retrieved from <http://www.spring.org.uk/the1sttransport>. (2004, September 26).

ITC

- Author(s) Last name (year)
- (Author(s) Last name, year)

Example:

- Dean (2008) showed that
- In another post (Dean, 2008) it was argued....

Interviews, email, and other personal communication

No personal communication is included in your reference list. Instead cite in the main text only:

- communicator's name
- phrase "personal communication,
- date of the communication.

Example: (P. Jones, personal communication, March 4, 2010).

Government agency or other organization publication

REF: Name of agency. (Year). *Title*. (Series information). Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Department of the Environment, Ireland. (1994). *Agricultural & Farm Development: The Planning Issues* (PL 6). Dublin: Department of the Environment.

ITC:

- Name of agency (year)
- (Name of agency, year)

Example

- According to the Department of Environment (1994)
- Official figures released (Department of Environment, 1994) show that....

Parliamentary and legal material

REF: Title, source and section number if applicable, (year of publication).

Example: Human Rights Commission Act, Government of Ireland, (2000).

ITC

- Name of the act (year)

- (Name of the act, year)

Example

- The Human Rights Commission Act (2000)
- Legislation (Human Rights Commission Act, 2000) covering the area....

EU publications

REF: European Union, Name of EU agency. (Year), *Title of publication*. Retrieved from/Place of publication.

Example: European Union, European Commission for the Environment. (2009). *Adapting to climate change: Towards a European framework for action* (White Paper 52009DC0147).

Retrieved from <http://eur-lex.europa.eu/>

LexUriServ/LexUriServ.do?uri=CELEX:52009DC0147:EN:NOT

ITC:

- Name of institution (year)
- (Name of institution, year)

Example

- European commission for the Environment statistics released at the time (2009)
- An EU white paper (European Commission for the Environment, 2009)....

Conferences

REF: Author(s) Last name, Initials (Year). Title of paper. In Editor(s) Initial, Last name (Ed.) *Title of conference proceedings* (Page numbers). Place of publication: Publisher.

Example: Jones, M.K., (2010) Distance learning in Dublin. In M. Forrester (Ed.) *Proceedings of a One-Day International Conference Dealing with Distance Learning in Ireland* (pp. 210 - 258). Dublin: Collins Press.

ITC:

- Author(s) Last name (year)
- (Author(s) Last name, year)

Example

- Jones (2010) argued....
- Another participant (Jones, 2010) argued....

Theses

REF: Author Last name, Initials (Year). *Title of dissertation*. (Unpublished doctoral dissertation). Name of Institution, Location. Example: Moore, N.A. (2001). *The Celtic*

Tiger and the Welsh Dragon: Urban Redevelopment in Dublin Docklands and Cardiff Bay, 1987-2000 (Unpublished doctoral dissertation). University College Dublin, Dublin.

ITC

- Author Last name (year)
- (Author Last name, year)

Example

- Moore (2001) argues....
- Another approach (Moore, 2001) argues....

Audio-visual material

REF: Producer(s) Last name, Initials (Producer) & Director(s) Last name Initials. (Year)
Title [Motion picture]. Place of production: Production company.

Example: Bender, L.A. (Producer) & Tarantino, Q. A (Director). (1994). *Pulp fiction* [Motion picture]. United States: Miramax Films.

ITC: (Director's surname, year)

Example: In this film (Tarantino, 1994) he sought to....

Software: End Note is a software application that allows researchers store and manage all references in one place. It is available via Software for U and the Library runs regular introductory and advanced training sessions.

- Users can record, store and manage references in hundreds of citation styles.
- Users can add references manually or search and download directly from online databases and library catalogues.
- End Note Cite While You Write features allows users to insert citations easily and creates bibliographies automatically in Microsoft Word.

Chapter11: Presentation and Visual Communications

11.1 Planning Presentation

Planning presentations is much like planning any other business message: You analyze the situation, gather information, select the right medium, and organize the information. Gathering information for oral presentations is essentially the same as it is for written communication projects. The other three planning tasks have some special applications when it comes to oral presentations; they are covered in the following sections.

Plan	Write	Complete
Analyze the Situation: Define your purpose and	Adapt to Your Audience: Be sensitive to audience	Revise the Message: Evaluate your content and

develop a profile of your audience, including their emotional states and language preferences. Gather Information: Determine audience needs and obtain the information necessary to satisfy those needs. Select the Right Medium: Choose the best medium or combination of media for delivering your presentation, including handouts and other support materials. Organize the Information: Define your main idea, limit your scope and verify timing, select a direct or an indirect approach, and outline your content.	needs and expectations with a you ‘attitude, politeness, positive emphasis, and bias-free language’. Build a strong relationship with your audience by establishing your credibility and projecting your company’s image. Adjust your delivery style to fit the situation, from casual to formal. Compose Your presentation: Outline an effective introduction, body, and close. Prepare supporting visuals and speaking notes.	speaking notes. Master Your Delivery: Choose your delivery mode and practice your presentation. Prepare to Speak: Verify facilities and equipment, including online connections and software setups. Hire an interpreter if necessary. Overcome Anxiety: Take steps to feel more confident and appear more confident on stage.
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11.2 Preparation of Presentation Outline

A presentation outline performs the same function as an outline for a written document: helping you organize the message in a way that maximizes its impact on your audience. However, a presentation outline can also serve as the foundation of your speaking notes, so as you write your outline, start thinking about the words you’ll want to use when you deliver your presentation. To ensure effective organization, prepare your outline in several stages:

- **State your purpose and main idea:** As you develop your outline, check frequently to be sure that the points, organization, connections, and title relate to your purpose and main idea.

- **Organize your major points and sub points:** Express each major point as a single complete sentence to help you keep track of the one specific idea you want to convey in that point. Then look at the order of points to make sure their arrangement is logical and effective.
- **Identify your introduction, body, and close:** Start with the body, numbering each major point and sub point according to its level in your outline. Then lay out the points for your introduction and close.
- Show your connections. Write out in sentence form the transitions you plan to use to move from one part to the next. Remember to include additional transitions between major points in the body of your speech.
- **Show your sources:** Prepare your bibliography, making sure that it reads easily, follows a consistent format, and includes all the details needed to identify your various sources. As needed, be prepared to mention key sources during your talk.
- **Choose a title:** Not all presentations or speeches have a title. However, a title can be useful if your presentation will be publicized ahead of time or introduced by someone else. The title sets everyone's expectations, so make it compelling and audience-centered.
- **Follow the planning outline:** Follow the same format as you used for your planning outline so it will be familiar as you talk. However, strip away anything you don't plan to say to your audience.
- **Condense points and transitions to keywords:** Choose words that will prompt you to remember what each point is about so that you can speak fluently. Be sure to write out statistics, quotations, and other specifics so that you don't stumble over them. You may also want to write complete sentences for transitions that connect main points or for critical points in your introduction or your close.
- **Add delivery cues:** During rehearsals, note the places in your outline where you plan to pause for emphasis, speak more slowly, use a visual, and so on.
- **Arrange your notes:** Make sure your note cards are legible and numbered so that you can keep them in order before and during your presentation.

If you plan to use Power Point or other presentation software, you can also use the 'notes' field on each slide for speaking notes.

11.3 Presentation Delivery Methods

Memorizing: It is better to avoid memorizing an entire speech. However, memorizing a quotation, an opening paragraph, or a few concluding remarks can bolster your confidence and strengthen your delivery. Other methods are Reading, Speaking from Notes, Impromptu Speaking.

11.4 Before Presentation

Public speaking is both an art and a skill. Careful planning and practicing are essential to develop speaking skills. The following guidelines may be helpful to make the effective presentation of speeches:

- **Prepare Thoroughly:** Analyze your audience, research your topic diligently, organize your thoughts, prepare Visual aids, practice your opener and close. These preparations will boost your confidence.
- **Rehearse Repeatedly:** Rehearse your presentation repeatedly. You may use transitional sentence to help you move to the next topic. Record the rehearsal on audio or video tape, play backs them and evaluates your effectiveness.
- **Time Yourself:** As the audience feel bore and restless in longer talks. Try to complete in shorter time (in no more than 20 minutes). With the help of a timer during rehearsal, measure your speaking time and adjust accordingly.
- **Lectern:** A lectern or high desk is helpful for beginning speakers. It serves as a note holder from which to deliver presentations. If you need a lectern, request it.
- **Room Checking:** Before start your presentation, check the room and make sure that everything needed (such as sound equipment, seating arrangement) in the room is appropriately available.
- **Light Meal:** If the time of your presentation is after a meal, eat lightly avoiding heavy sauces and alcoholic beverages.
- **Stress Reduction:** If you feel tension and fear just before your presentation, take deep breathing.

11.5 During Presentation

During the presentation, if you can apply the following techniques, you can make a good impression:

- **Do not Rush the Opening:** When you are being introduced for delivering the speech, take several deep breaths to clear your mind, walk slowly to the speaker's podium.
- **Being with a Pause:** When you first approach the audience, take a moment to adjust your notes and make yourself comfortable, stand up straight, look slowly around

you, establish eye contact with several members of the audience, adjust the microphone (normally the microphone should be 4 to 6 inches from your mouth) and then start your presentation in a loud but clear voice.

- **Begin from Memory:** Present the first sentence from your memory. Memorizing the opening remark, will help you immediately establish rapport through eye contact. These in turn help you appear confident and knowledgeable.
- **Maintain Eye Contact:** Once you have started your speech, be particularly careful to maintain your eye contact with the audience, throughout the speech. Pick out several people from the audience positioned in the room and shift your gaze from one to another. Maintaining eye contact will help you perceive the impression you are creating.
- **Control Voice:** While you are speaking before the audience, control your voice. This means speak in moderate conversational tones but loud enough so that everyone in the audience can hear you. Also vary your pitch and speaking rate to add emphasis.
- **Avoid Annoying Speech Habits:** Clearing your throat or uttering a soft cough frequently is likely to shift audience attention from the speech to the speaker. Avoid these habits which may annoy the audience. Additionally avoid the following meaningless filler words and phrases like well, you know, um, okay, and the like. It is better to remain silent than to use meaningless fillers. While you are speaking, speak clearly articulating all the syllables.
- **Put the Brakes On:** Do not talk rapidly like the novice speakers. Talking rapidly makes it difficult for audience members to understand what the speaker is saying. So slow down your speaking and thus make it easy to listen.
- **Use Gestures and Facial Expressions Effectively:** To make the messages clearly understandable and impressive, sometimes body motions are resorted to. Try to be conscious of overusing your hands and arms. Use your hands to emphasize any remarks with appropriate gestures. Also vary your facial expression at the same time to make the message more dynamic.
- **Use Visual Aids:** Use visual aids to maintain and revive audience interest. Use a pointer if necessary.
- **Use your Posture Appropriately:** Your posture is important in projecting the right image. Stand tall and avoid gripping the podium.

- **Watch Your Audience:** While you are delivering your message, you will find that the audience will tell you how you are doing and whether you should shorten the speech. Particularly be attentive to negative feedback in the form of talking, laughing, moving chairs and other signs of discomfort.
- **Dress Comfortably:** Clothing conveys many messages to the audience. So dress carefully and tastefully in comfortable and businesslike attire. To show respect to your audience, try to dress just slightly better than the average member of the audience.
- **Use Jokes or Humour Appropriately:** The audience members are likely to lose concentration to hear a long speech. To make the audience attentive use jokes or humours. But if you cannot tell jokes well, do not do this or you may be joke! Of course humours or jokes must be related to your speech content. Do not use any humour that may reflect negatively on race, religion, opposite sex, colour, age and nationality.
- **Summarize Main Points:** Closing remarks are very important. A good closing serves to leave the audience in a good mood. In the concluding remarks, a good speaker will reiterate the main points and emphasize, what the speaker wants the audience to do or think. Once the conclusion is announced the speaker should not irritate the audience by talking for extra times-5 or 10 more minutes.

11.6 After Presentation

Most presentations involve interactions with the audience at the end of the delivery. Although the question-and-answer session starts at the end of your presentation, you should announce at the beginning that you would be happy to answer any questions at the end of your speech. This prior announcement prevents you from being interrupted and losing your train of thought or possibly running out of time. The following techniques can help you to handle this important segment of your presentation effectively:

- **Distribute Handouts:** After you have finished the presentation, distribute the handouts which you prepared earlier to meet the need of the audience.
- **Encourage Questions:** If situation permits a question-and-answer period, ask the audiences for questions. Fix up a time limit for this session.
- **Repeat Questions:** Listen carefully to the question; then repeat it loudly to confirm your understanding and to make sure that the entire audience has heard it.

- **Ask for Clarification:** If the question is vague or confusing, ask the questioners for clarification.
- **Answer the Question:** Look at the entire audience when you answer the question. Give a simple and direct answer. Keep your answer short but to the point to avoid a lengthy debate or additional questions. In case of giving an adequate answer if you think that it may take much time, you simply say, “I am sorry that we don’t have that much time right now to get into the issue; but if you will see me after the session, I will be happy to discuss the matter with you”.
- **Admit Your Unknowing:** If you do not know the answer to a question, do not pretend that you know. Rather you freely admit the fact and ensure the audience to have the answer within a specific time period.
- **Handle Politely:** Treat each questioner politely. Even if the question is antagonistic, be firm, but fair and polite.
- **Keep Control:** Do not allow one or two individuals to monopolize the question period. Try to keep the entire audience involved in participating. If the same person goes on raising questions, control him/her by saying something like several others have questions; “I will get back to you if time permits”.
- **Prepare the audience for End:** When you are nearing the end of the question-and-answer session, prepare your audience for the end by saying. “Our time is almost up. Let’s have one more question”.
- **Close the Session:** After you have replied the last question, summarize the main ideas of the presentation and thank the audience for the opportunity to talk to them. Conclude the session by looking around the room and making eye contact as done, when you opened. And finally gather your notes and then leave the podium.

11.7 Visual Aids Format

Visual aids are tools that help the listeners hear and understand the spoken words. The speakers hit the audience with double impact through the eyes and ears. They are used to emphasize points not to substitute for the speech. An ancient Chinese proverb says, “Tell me, I’ll forget. Show me, I may remember. But involve me, I’ll understand”.

There are various types of visual devices that can be used to enhance oral reporting. Let us examine here some of the most common visuals that are available to a speaker.

Handouts: Handouts are pieces of paper with information. These papers i.e. printed copies of notes, tables or illustrations are given to people who are attending a meeting, lesson, etc. Printed handouts are the dominant type of presentation materials used and they are

especially useful in small working groups particularly for presenting complex information such as detailed statistical tables. In order to refer to their speech, many speakers handout printed materials such as agendas, reports, letters, etc.

Flip Charts and Posters: Flip charts are the most common display visuals. These charts consist of a pad of paper with sheets of 2 feet X 3 feet that are fastened at the top and mounted on an easel so that you can turn (flip) the pages you speak. By using markers of various colours, you can highlight ideas as you go along. On the other hand, posters are prepared on single sheets of posters board of various sizes and colours. They are also displayed on an easel. So when you want to choose these media, be sure that an easel is available in the presentation room. These media are effective when presenting information to small interactive groups.

Chalkboards and Whiteboards: This medium is useful for preparing informal visuals to small groups. If the visuals are sizable or complex, you may find them helpful to place on the board.

Overhead Projections: Transparencies for overhead projections are probably the most popular presentation media. These media allow an image to be projected without darkening the room and without losing touch with audience. This means you may face the audience while an image is projected. Transparencies can be prepared of anything from freehand drawings to printed pages by simply running the original copy through a copying machine. You can also write on transparencies with specially designed pens. Thus a blank transparency serves the same purpose as a chalkboard or whiteboard does.

Videotapes: Videotapes can be used to illustrate major points. A video has the advantage of recording and instant playback. In today's visual age, many speakers are now showing video clips with sounds to small groups viz. CD-ROM attachments on their computers. Videotapes can be sent to potential customers/clients and employees in remote places.

Computers: With a public projector you can turn on your personal computer into a large screen. When you are discussing financial projections, you can show how a change in sales forecasts will affect by typing a new number.

11.8 Developing Visual Aids

To increase the impact of presentations, you are advised to follow these guidelines for preparing and using visual aids:

- Select the appropriate visual aid (base on the purpose of the speech, size of the audience, needs of the occasion and your skill and experience to use the medium).

- Limit the number of visuals in a single presentation (because too many visuals can bore and tire the audience).
- Include only one major idea on a single visual.
- Stop after the main points and allow the audience to scan the information projected on the visual.
- Keep the design simple and clean. Do not clutter the page with too many colours, fonts and graphics.
- Maintain eye contact throughout the presentation.
- Make sure that the visual is clearly seen by everybody in the audience.
- Paraphrase the visual rather than it line for line.
- Work on your timing. Never display a visual before talking about it and remove the visual after you have finished the thought.

11.9 Presentations in Online

Online presentations give you a way to reach more people in less time, but they require special preparation and skills. You often cannot rely on nonverbal signals to sense audience confusion or disagreement, so check in with your listeners frequently to see if they have questions.

Keep the following guidelines:

- Consider sending preview study materials ahead of time.
- Rehearse using the system live, if at all possible.
- Keep your presentation as simple as possible.
- Ask for feedback frequently.
- Consider the viewing experience from the audience members' point of view.
- Allow plenty of time for everyone to get connected and familiar with the screen they are viewing

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